

LS Secretariat joint director found dead; note mentions ₹70 lakh debt

Wife found him unresponsive at Noida Sector 82 residence; probe underway

DIPIKA KIROLA

NOIDA: A 40-year-old Joint Director with the Lok Sabha Secretariat was allegedly found dead by suicide at his residence in Kendriya Vihar-2 Society in Sector 82, Noida, with police saying a 15-page handwritten note recovered from the house indicated that he had been under severe financial stress due to debts of nearly Rs 70 lakh.

The incident came to light on Sunday evening after the official's wife, who had been staying at her parents' home in Delhi for the previous two days, was unable to contact him despite making repeated phone calls. Worried by the lack of response, she returned to Noida. After receiving no response despite repeatedly knocking on the door, she sought help from the society's

TAKEAWAYS

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on the door, she sought help from the society's security staff. The door was subsequently forced

open, and the official was found hanging from a ceiling fan inside flat

» Deceased was serving as a Joint Director in the Reporting Branch of the Lok Sabha Secretariat. Police said the couple's eight-year-old son was staying with his mother at the time of incident

» Police said no evidence of foul play has been found so far. Further investigation is underway

dence. Additional Deputy Commissioner of Police (Central Noida) Swatantra Singh said the note did not hold any individual responsible for the death.

Instead, it referred to financial liabilities of nearly Rs 70 lakh that had accumulated over the years and described the stress caused by the debt.

According to the officer, the note also contained deeply personal reflections. The official reportedly wrote that he had failed to be a good husband and father and apologised to his wife for not listening to her advice. Investigators are examining the note as part of the ongoing probe.

Police said no evidence of foul play has been found so far. Further investigation is underway to complete the necessary legal formalities and verify all aspects of the case.

STABBED 27 TIMES IN FBD SCHOOL

'Teacher murder pre-planned, knife bought two months ago'

OUR CORRESPONDENT

FARIDABAD: Twenty-one-year-old Amit, accused of stabbing to death a teacher at a private school here, had planned the murder nearly two months in advance and bought the knife specially for the crime, police said on Wednesday.

During interrogation, the accused told police he had been waiting for an opportunity to kill 28-year-old Sandhya Sharma. Sharma was stabbed in the neck and chest more than 27 times in quick succession, resulting in her death at the spot on Monday. A video of the purported incident went viral on social media.

Police said Amit had feelings for Sharma, but she did not reciprocate. She had earlier lodged a molestation complaint against him, following which he apologised. Investigators said he was resentful after she changed both her school and residence.

According to police, Amit



reached the school in Sikrona village around 9.30 am and called out of her classroom by invoking her husband's name. As she stepped outside, he allegedly grabbed her by the hair and repeatedly stabbed her, killing her on the spot.

Police arrested Amit, a resident of Kot village, within two hours of the attack. A city court remanded him to three days' police custody on Tuesday.

During questioning, the accused said he had initially considered attacking Sharma while she was travelling to or from school but abandoned the plan fearing he would be caught. He then decided to

enter the school and carry out the attack there, police said.

"The accused was so enraged that he continued attacking even after the knife bent," a senior police officer said, adding that the murder weapon has been seized. Efforts are underway to recover the accused's motorcycle and clothes. The attack was captured on the school's CCTV cameras. Police said the accused also threatened a school staffer who tried to intervene.

Sharma's husband, Vicky Gurjar, said his wife used to teach at a school in Sirahi village, where she met Amit. He said stricter police action after the earlier molestation complaint could have prevented the murder. "If the police had acted strictly then, Sandhya might have been alive today," he said.

Sharma and Gurjar had a love marriage and two children. Amit, the youngest of three brothers, is unemployed and rears buffaloes, selling milk.

'No voter deletion in SIR over missing 2002 electoral roll information'

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The office of the Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) of Delhi clarified on Wednesday that no voter's name will be automatically deleted during the ongoing Special Intensive Revision (SIR) because their name was not listed in the voter rolls from the previous SIR conducted in 2002.

The only reasons for exclusion from the draft electoral rolls are failure to submit completed enumeration forms by the deadline of August 17 or not being eligible to vote, it said in a post on X.

The draft electoral rolls for Delhi, following door-to-door voter verification and the digitisation of enumeration forms, will be published on August 24.

This clarification came in response to senior AAP leader Somnath Bharti's concerns that he could not find his name on the 2002 voter list, despite having graduated from IIT in 1997 and studying law in Delhi.

Bharti had expressed worries about rumours that the names of 20 to 30 lakh voters could be removed in Delhi.

The CEO's office added that if a voter cannot find their name in the last SIR, they can provide the details of their relatives, such as their parents or grandparents, both paternal and maternal.

Additionally, if any voter is unable to locate their relatives' names in the 2002 SIR, they can submit enumeration forms with the details they have to the Booth Level Officers (BLOs) for digitisation, and "his/her name will appear in the draft roll", it said.

Voters missing from the 2002 SIR rolls will receive notices between August 24 and September 23 and must submit documents before October 27.

Police arrest proclaimed offender linked to Rohit Choudhary gang after 700-km chase

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A proclaimed offender allegedly linked to the Rohit Choudhary gang and wanted in an attempt-to-murder case inside Tihar Jail has been arrested after a 700-kilometre interstate pursuit, an official said on Wednesday.

Accused Rahul Rawat (28) was arrested by the Special Cell from Udaipur on July 18.

"Rawat had been declared a proclaimed offender in four criminal cases, including robbery and attempt to murder, after repeatedly evading arrest and failing to appear before courts," a senior police officer said. According to the police, Rawat was wanted in connection with a May 2023 case registered at Hari Nagar Police Station in which a group of inmates allegedly attacked



another prisoner inside Tihar Jail using improvised pointed weapons. Jail staff intervened in time, preventing the victim from being killed.

The victim was allegedly associated with the Randeep Bhati gang and later joined the Himanshu alias Bhau gang after his release from jail. Police said he was killed in an encounter with the Uttar Pradesh STF in Agra in February.

"After securing bail in the

Rawat was wanted in connection with a May 2023 case registered at Hari Nagar Police Station in which a group of inmates allegedly attacked another prisoner inside Tihar Jail using improvised pointed weapons

Tihar Jail case, Rawat allegedly went underground, frequently changed hideouts and avoided court proceedings in several other criminal cases, leading to his being declared a proclaimed offender," the officer said.

Acting on inputs received during surveillance on absconding gang members, the team traced Rawat's presence to a residential colony in Udaipur, nearly 700 kilometres from Delhi. He was appre-

hended on July 18 and brought to Delhi for further investigation, police said.

Police said that Rawat was a habitual offender with multiple criminal cases registered against him since 2016. His alleged involvement includes carjacking, kidnapping, robbery, criminal intimidation, possession of an illegal firearm and threatening a witness in a criminal trial. Further investigation is underway.

Bawana-Bali gang associate nabbed, accomplice escapes

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A suspected associate of the Neeraj Bawana and Naveen Bali gangs was apprehended after an exchange of fire with police in Delhi's Kangerhawa area, while his alleged accomplice managed to escape after firing at the personnel, an officer said on Wednesday.

Five firearms, including Jigana and Glock pistols, along with 18 live cartridges were recovered during the operation, he said.

According to the police, the Special Task Force (STF) had received specific information that Rahul Dabas alias RDX and Rahul Sehrawat would assemble near Anand Vatika in Ladpur village while carrying illegal weapons, allegedly to

'During exchange of fire, Sehrawat was overpowered and nabbed at the spot'

commit a crime.

"Acting on the tip-off, the police team laid a trap near the location. On spotting the police, both suspects opened fire, following which the police took cover behind their vehicle and retaliated in self-defence," Joint Commissioner of Police (Northern Range) Vijay Singh said.

During the exchange of fire, Rahul Sehrawat was overpowered and apprehended at the spot, while Rahul Dabas escaped after allegedly firing at the police party, the offi-

cers said. One bullet fired by the accused struck the police vehicle, while two others hit a parked car. The police team fired one round in self-defence. No police personnel or either of the accused sustained any injury in the incident, he said.

The recovered weapons include one Jigana pistol, one Glock pistol, one .32 bore pistol and two country-made pistols. Eight 9 mm cartridges and 10 cartridges of .30 bore were also seized from the spot, police said.

Police said Sehrawat has two previous cases, while absconding accused Dabas faces 11. Both allegedly have links to jailed gangsters Neeraj Bawana and Naveen Bali; efforts are underway to arrest Dabas.

Ghaziabad: Three Kanwariyas killed as bike rams into vehicle

DIPIKA KIROLA

GHAZIABAD: Three Kanwariyas, including a 17-year-old boy, were killed after their motorcycle rammed into the rear of an unidentified vehicle on the Delhi-Meerut Expressway in the early hours of Wednesday. Police suspect the rider was speeding and lost control before crashing into the vehicle ahead.

The accident occurred around 4.30 am near Kalchhina village under the Bhojpur police station limits. A passerby alerted emergency services after spotting three injured men and a badly damaged motorcycle on the expressway. Police reached the spot and rushed the victims to a nearby hospital, where doctors declared all three dead.



The deceased were identified as Gyan Prakash, 29, Rajkumar, 25, and Pradeep Singh, 17, all residents of Aligarh district. Gyan Prakash worked at a shoe manufacturing unit in Haryana. The trio had left Haryana on Tuesday night for the Kanwar pilgrimage and were travelling towards Haridwar to collect holy Ganga water.

Assistant Commissioner of Police (Modinagar) Bhaskar Verma said preliminary findings suggested the motorcycle was travelling at high speed when the rider lost balance and collided with the vehicle. None of the three was wearing a helmet.

Police also recovered a liquor bottle from their belongings and are investigating whether alcohol consumption contributed to the crash. The exact cause will be established after post-mortem and forensic examination.

An FIR has been registered against the unidentified driver under Sections 281 and 106(1) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita. Police are examining CCTV footage from the expressway and nearby toll plazas to identify the vehicle.

DU announces 1st round of admissions for 1-yr PG programmes

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi University has announced the first round of admissions for its one-year postgraduate programmes for the 2026-27 academic session, with seat allocation already declared and candidates required to accept their allotted seats by August 6.

According to a public notice issued by the university's Admission Branch, the admission process covers 28 one-year postgraduate programmes across science, humanities and language disciplines.

The programmes include M.Sc. courses in Anthropology, Biochemistry, Biomedical Sciences, Botany, Chemistry, Computer Science, Environmental Sciences, Mathematics, Microbiology, Physics, Statistics and Zoology, among others. The list also includes M.A. programmes in Arabic, Bengali, French, German, Hispanic, Italian, Punjabi, Persian and Hindi Journalism.

As per the admission schedule, the first round of allocations were released on Tuesday and candidates can accept their allotted seats till 11:59 pm on Thursday. Departments and centres will verify and approve online applications by 11:59 pm on August 8.

The last date for payment of the admission fee by candidates whose applications are approved is 11:59 pm on August 9.

The university said admissions for the remaining programmes will be announced separately and advised candidates to regularly check the admission portal for updates.

I-Day: Police holds inter-state meeting

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

NEW DELHI: Ahead of Independence Day celebrations, Delhi Police on Wednesday held an inter-state coordination meeting with senior police and intelligence officials from neighbouring states and central agencies to strengthen security, intelligence sharing and coordination for incident-free festivities in the national capital.

The meeting, chaired by Delhi Police Commissioner Anurag Kumar at Police Headquarters, was attended by senior officials from Haryana, Punjab, Uttar Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh, Himachal Pradesh, Jharkhand, Uttarakhand, Bihar, Rajasthan, Jammu and

Kashmir and Chandigarh, besides intelligence and central agencies.

Discussions focused on anti-terror measures, including border sealing, checking suspicious persons, monitoring drones, paragliders and other flying objects, social media surveillance, and sharing intelligence inputs.

Officials also reviewed threats from interstate criminal gangs, illegal arms and drug trafficking, unauthorised entry and traffic management.

Senior officials from Delhi Police's Law and Order, Special Cell, Traffic, Crime, Intelligence, Security, IGI Airport, Railways and Metro wings also attended.

12,640 prohibited cigarettes seized

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police arrested three men and seized 12,640 prohibited imported cigarettes allegedly meant for illegal sale in northeast Delhi, an officer said on Wednesday.

Acting on a tip-off, police intercepted the accused near Nala Road in Karawal Nagar on Tuesday evening. The three, identified as Ankit, 35, Vishal, 28, and Rahul, 36, were allegedly carrying 79 cartons of cigarettes manufactured in Indonesia.

Police said the packets lacked mandatory health warnings under the Cigarettes and Other Tobacco Products Act, making them prohibited for sale in India. An FIR was registered under Sections 7 and 20 of the Act. Police are tracing the source and other members.

MP05T

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi High Court on Wednesday asked the city police to install sanitary pad vending machines at all police stations in the capital for women personnel and also provide them with exclusive washrooms.

A bench of Chief Justice D K Upadhyaya and Justice Tejas Karia asked the Commissioner of Police to survey all police stations within six weeks to ascertain the availability of exclusive washrooms and sanitary pads, and then take appropriate steps.

"Based on the report of the survey, appropriate steps shall



be taken by the police to provide each police station with the facility of a sanitary pad vending machine and also an exclusive washroom for women personnel," said the bench.

"We require the Commissioner of Police to get a survey conducted of all police stations in Delhi... The survey shall

be conducted in six weeks," it ordered.

Listing the matter for hearing on September 23, the court sought an affidavit from the police detailing the steps taken pursuant to the directions.

The court passed the order while issuing notice to the Centre, Delhi government and the police on a public interest litigation (PIL) for securing female police personnel's right to access to basic menstrual hygiene and sanitation facilities at the workplace.

The PIL by NGO Justice for Rights Foundation said ensuring such essential infrastructure for women police personnel was indispensable

to the constitutional mandate embodied in Article 21 of the Constitution, as they are an indispensable facet of the right to live with dignity, health, privacy and humane conditions at work.

The PIL, citing RTI data, alleged inadequate menstrual hygiene facilities for Delhi's female police personnel, with pad vending machines available at only a few stations and no dedicated budget or policy. It sought functional vending machines, sanitary incinerators and clean, private, well-equipped washrooms for women personnel across all Delhi Police establishments.

MONSOON SESSION FROM AUGUST 7 TO 11

Action-packed: Govt to table 2 CAG reports, introduce 3 Bills

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Assembly's Monsoon Session is set to begin with a packed legislative agenda, with the Rekha Gupta government preparing to table two Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG) reports and introduce three key Bills that could bring changes to public service delivery, urban shelter administration and the regulation of bed-and-breakfast establishments in the national capital.

The five-day session, scheduled from August 7 to August 11, will also see the tabling of amendments related to Delhi's electricity regulations. The legislative business was finalised on Wednesday at a meeting of the Business Advisory Committee (BAC) chaired by Assembly Speaker Vijender Gupta.

Speaking after the meeting, Gupta said, "Two C&AG reports and three key Bills will be taken up during the Monsoon Session." He said the committee unanimously approved the business to be transacted during the session.

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, who also holds the Finance portfolio, will table two reports of the Comptroller and Auditor General. These include the audit report relating to the Govern-



ment of NCT of Delhi for the financial year ending March 31, 2023, and the State Finance Report for 2024-25. The reports are expected to be among the major documents placed before the House during the session.

Power Minister Ashish Sood will also lay before the Assembly the notification and corrigendum relating to the Delhi Electricity Regulatory Commission (Terms and Conditions for Open Access) (Second Amendment) Regulations, 2026.

The government is also expected to introduce three Bills during the session. Among the legislative proposals, the govern-

ment will introduce The Delhi (Right of Citizen to Time Bound Delivery of Services) Bill, 2026, which seeks to repeal the existing Delhi (Right of Citizens to Time Bound Services) Act, 2011 and replace it with a new legal framework for the delivery of government services within prescribed timelines.

Another Bill proposes amendments to the Delhi Urban Shelter Improvement Board Act, 2010, including changes to provisions that have been amended through subsequent legislations in 2015 and 2020. The proposed amendments are aimed at revising the legal framework govern-

ing the functioning of the urban shelter board.

The third Bill seeks to repeal the Delhi (Incredible India) Bed and Breakfast Establishments (Registration and Regulation) Act, 2007, along with the amendment Acts passed in 2010 and 2021. The move is part of the government's broader exercise to review and streamline existing laws.

The Monsoon Session is expected to be politically significant as it will be the first Assembly sitting after the government announced a series of policy initiatives, including welfare schemes, governance reforms

HIGHLIGHTS

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» The legislative business was finalised on Wednesday at a meeting of the Business Advisory Committee (BAC) chaired by Assembly Speaker

and administrative measures. Besides the listed legislative business, members are likely to raise issues concerning public services, civic infrastructure and other matters affecting the national capital.

The Business Advisory Committee meeting was attended by Deputy Speaker Mohan Singh Bisht, Chief Whip Abhay Verma, and MLAs Om Prakash Sharma, Som Dutt, Jitender Mahajan and Suriender Kumar. According to the Assembly Secretariat, the committee unanimously finalised the legislative programme for the upcoming session.



JAN SEVA SADAN: CM says, fix it fast

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Wednesday directed officials to ensure time-bound resolution of citizens' grievances after hearing complaints related to pensions, healthcare, education, Ayushman Bharat, property disputes and regularisation during a public hearing at Jan Seva Sadan.

Reviewing cases from residents across the city, the Chief Minister instructed departments concerned to take prompt action and ensure that eligible beneficiaries receive the benefits of government welfare schemes without delay. Taking serious note of complaints related to pensions, she asked officials to examine each case individually and ensure timely disbursement to eligible beneficiaries. A large number of women also attended the public hearing and thanked the Chief Minister for the Delhi Laxmi Yojana, describing it as a significant initiative for women's financial empowerment. They said the scheme had strengthened women's dignity, self-reliance and economic security.

Responding to them, Gupta reiterated her government's commitment to women's welfare and empowerment.

Addressing the gather-

ing, the Chief Minister said, "The public hearing is not just a forum for registering complaints but a strong bridge of trust between the people and the Government." She added that the Delhi government's objective is to ensure that every citizen's grievance is heard with sensitivity, transparency and resolved within a defined timeframe.

Emphasising the importance of responsive governance, Gupta said, "Serving the people of Delhi remains the Government's highest priority." She added that the administration is committed to providing citizens with a system that is "respectful, transparent and accountable" while continuing to strengthen the public hearing mechanism for prompt grievance redressal.

According to the Chief Minister's Office, the Jan Seva Sadan public hearing covered a wide range of civic and welfare-related issues, with officials from the concerned departments directed to prioritise pending cases and ensure effective implementation of government schemes. The exercise, the government said, is aimed at improving service delivery while reinforcing public trust in the administration through regular interaction with citizens.

Govt moves to simplify business

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi government has proposed sweeping changes to simplify the process of setting up and running businesses in the Capital, with the draft Delhi Ease of Doing Business Bill, 2026 introducing measures such as a single-window clearance system, deemed approvals, self-certification for low-risk units and a three-year exemption from routine inspections. The draft Bill was deliberated by the Delhi Cabinet chaired by Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Tuesday. If cleared by the Lieutenant Governor, it will be forwarded to the Union Ministry of Home Affairs for further approval.

Addressing the proposed reforms, Gupta said, "Our goal is to ensure entrepreneurs spend their time growing their businesses, not running from one government office to another."

Under the proposal, approvals, registrations, licences, No Objection Certificates (NOCs) and utility connections will be routed through a single online



portal managed by the Delhi State Industrial and Infrastructure Development Corporation (DSIIDC), which will act as the nodal agency coordinating with different departments.

The Bill introduces a provision for deemed approval, under which applications pending beyond the prescribed timeline will be treated as approved. It also proposes self-certification for specified low-risk activities, including fire safety, building plan approvals, pollution-related permissions and low-tension electricity connections.

Businesses already registered under GST, FSSAI, the MSMED Act or Labour Codes would not be required to obtain sepa-

“Our goal is to ensure entrepreneurs spend their time growing their businesses, not running from one govt office to another — CM

rate trade licences or Shops and Establishments registrations, reducing multiple compliance requirements.

Another key proposal is a three-year exemption from routine inspections after registration. Inspections would be conducted only in cases involving serious complaints. The Bill also seeks to adopt a Negative List approach, allowing businesses to undertake any activity unless it is specifically prohibited.

The government has also proposed relaxing development control norms in notified industrial areas by easing restrictions on floor area ratio (FAR), setbacks and building height.

Rain rules Delhi

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Widespread rainfall lashed Delhi on Wednesday, leading to traffic snarls and waterlogging in many areas, while the weather office issued yellow and orange alerts for various parts of the city, warning of moderate rainfall accompanied by thunderstorm activity.

According to the India Meteorological Department (IMD), between 8.30 am and 11.30 am on Wednesday, Safdarjung, the city's base station, recorded 15.4 mm of rainfall, while Lodhi Road received 26 mm. Ridge recorded trace rainfall during the period.

Areas including Vijay Chowk, Jantar Mantar, Kartavya Path, ITO, Mathura Road, Sangam Vihar, C R Park, Lodhi Road and several other localities recorded heavy rainfall.

Many commuters took to social media to complain about waterlogging in areas such as CR Park, Sangam Vihar, Lodhi Road and several other localities following the rain.

Traffic congestion was reported from several parts of the city, including the ITO-Mathura Road stretch, Safdarjung Enclave and the Nizamuddin-Ashram corridor, following the rain.

L-G chairs meet to boost art, heritage and tourism

SHIVANGI SHUKLA

NEW DELHI: Delhi Lieutenant Governor Sardar TS Sandhu on Wednesday chaired a meeting with the Vice Chairman, DDA, and Secretary, Tourism, to explore ways to showcase the Capital's rich heritage, art and design traditions to its citizens as well as visitors from India and abroad.

The L-G directed the DDA to explore how its existing spaces across the Capital could be utilised for cultural and creative activities, including art installations, performances and heritage-linked programming.

He also pitched for developing Delhi's own iconic global cultural events through public-private partnerships, bringing together institutional expertise and private investment. Such events, he said, could become recurring fixtures on the city's calendar, drawing sustained attention and footfall while showcasing Delhi's artistic and cultural strengths globally. L-G also called for a dedicated focus on strengthening Delhi's night economy, noting that a vibrant after-dark cultural and commercial life could further support local artists, performers and small businesses. During the meeting, the L-G emphasised the need to promote nation-building activities, boost the Capital's creative economy and inculcate a strong sense of civic pride among citizens. He said culture and heritage were not merely matters of preservation but powerful instruments for building a shared civic identity.

He highlighted the potential of Delhi's creative economy, spanning art, design, crafts and performance traditions, to generate livelihoods while strengthening the city's cultural fabric. He stressed the need to build on proven practices and create inclusive platforms that empower citizens, artists and youth to contribute meaningfully to preserving and promoting Delhi's cultural legacy. The L-G said Delhi should draw on best practices from other cities while remaining rooted in its distinct character. Describing the Capital as a melting pot of cultures from across India, he called for promoting heritage walks and similar citizen-facing initiatives.



Govt puts Chandni cable plan on hold

Delhi plans wider utility corridor

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: The Delhi government's ambitious plan to move overhead electricity and telecom cables underground in Chandni Chowk has been put on hold after detailed surveys revealed a far more complex web of underground utilities than initially anticipated. Authorities are now preparing a revised execution plan that includes a wider multi-utility duct and a coordination mechanism involving all civic and utility agencies before work begins.

The pilot project, covering More Sarai Road and Esplanade Road, was originally scheduled for completion by the end of July. However, officials said work has not commenced due to the need for redesigning the project and resolving coordination issues among multiple departments.

Power Minister Ashish Sood said a high-level committee would be constituted within the next few days to oversee the project. Headed by the Additional Chief Secretary (Power), the panel will include representatives from the Municipal Corporation of Delhi, Public Works Department, Delhi Jal Board, Indraprastha Gas Limited, power distribution companies, telecom operators and other agencies with utility infrastructure in the area.

"The objective is to ensure that every agency plans and executes its work together. Instead of different departments repeatedly digging up the same road, we want a coordinated approach that creates long-term infrastructure for Chandni Chowk," Sood said.

Officials said field surveys found a dense network of electricity cables, optical fibre lines, water pipelines, sewer networks, gas pipelines and communication infrastructure beneath the narrow roads of the Walled City. The findings prompted the government to reconsider the original design.

A senior official said the revised proposal would include a broader underground utility duct capable of accommodating existing services as well as future infrastructure requirements. "The initial plan was limited to shifting overhead wires below the ground. During the survey, it became clear that this would only solve the problem temporarily. The revised design aims to create a common utility corridor that can minimise future road cutting and simplify maintenance," the official said.

The government is also exploring the use of trenchless technology in stretches where conventional excavation is not feasible because of narrow lanes and heavy commercial activity.

Officials said the original detailed project report estimated the pilot phase at around Rs.8 crore, but the redesigned project is expected to cost more. Fresh financial estimates are being prepared before work orders are issued.

The underground cabling initiative forms part of the Delhi government's larger plan to modernise infrastructure in the Walled City. Announced earlier this year, the overall project envisages shifting around 52.5 km of overhead wiring across 26 roads in Chandni Chowk at an estimated cost of Rs 160 crore. It also included installation of nearly 500 feeder pillars, decorative streetlights and digital monitoring systems to improve network reliability.

Officials said the revised plan is intended not only to remove overhead wires but also to create a permanent underground utility network that can accommodate multiple services, reduce repeated excavation and improve safety in one of the capital's busiest commercial areas. Work on the pilot stretches is expected to begin after the committee finalises the revised design and implementation schedule.

New DTC link flagged off

ANAMTA FATIMA

NEW DELHI: A new Delhi Transport Corporation (DTC) bus service connecting the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) headquarters at Dr S.P.M. Civic Centre with Bakner Village was flagged off by MCD Leader of the House Jai Bhagwan Yadav and Standing Committee chairperson Satya Sharma.

The new service, operating under Route No. 131, is aimed at improving public transport connectivity for residents and daily commuters along the corridor.

According to the MCD, buses will leave Bakner Village for the MCD headquarters at 8 a.m. and 8.30 a.m. The return services from the Civic Centre



will operate at 5.45 p.m. and 6.30 p.m. The route will pass through Rajghat, ISBT, Mukarba Chowk and Shani Mandir before reaching Bakner Village.

Yadav said the service would benefit students, women, senior citizens, government employees and other daily commuters by improving access to public transport. He also thanked

Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta for facilitating the launch.

Sharma said strengthening public transport could help reduce dependence on private vehicles and ease congestion.

Vice-chairman of the Narela Ward Committee Dinesh Bhardwaj, councillor Rajpal Rana and other officials were present at the flag-off ceremony.

ACTIVISTS DEMAND ACCOUNTABILITY

Nearly 500 sewer deaths, yet no manual scavenging fatalities

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: Even as nearly 500 sanitation workers have lost their lives while cleaning sewers and septic tanks across the country since 2019, the Union government has maintained that no death due to manual scavenging has been reported during the period, drawing attention to the legal distinction between manual scavenging and hazardous sewer cleaning.

Data placed before the Lok Sabha by Minister of State for

Social Justice and Empowerment Ramdas Athawale, in response to a question by Congress MP Rahul Gandhi, shows that 498 workers died while cleaning sewers and septic tanks between January 1, 2019, and June 30, 2026.

The highest number of fatalities was recorded in 2019, with 132 deaths. This was followed by 34 deaths in 2020, 62 in 2021, 88 in 2022, 65 in 2023, 54 in 2024, 47 in 2025 and 16 during the first half of 2026.

The government clarified

that these fatalities were categorised as deaths during hazardous sewer and septic tank cleaning rather than manual scavenging. Under existing law, manual scavenging refers to manually handling human excreta from insanitary toilets, open drains, railway tracks or similar locations before it decomposes, whereas hazardous cleaning relates to entering sewers or septic tanks without prescribed safety equipment and protective measures.

The reply also stated that a

nationwide survey conducted during 2024-25 did not identify any manual scavengers, following which all districts declared themselves free of the practice. This marks a sharp contrast with earlier surveys conducted in 2013 and 2018, which had identified more than 58,000 manual scavengers across 17 states.

The government said compensation for families of victims has been enhanced from Rs 10 lakh to Rs 30 lakh following a Supreme Court judgment in October 2023. Of the

498 deaths, full compensation of Rs 10 lakh was paid in 345 cases and Rs 30 lakh in 75 cases. However, records showed partial payment in 22 cases, while compensation status could not be confirmed in 56 others.

The Centre also informed Parliament that 89,915 sewer and septic tank workers have been profiled under the National Action for Mechanised Sanitation Ecosystem (NAMASTE) scheme, which provides safety gear, training, insurance and financial assistance for mechanised cleaning.

However, no timeline was announced for complete mechanisation of sewer cleaning operations.

Meanwhile, members of the Safai Karamchari Andolan (SKA), sanitation workers and families of victims staged a protest at Jantar Mantar on Tuesday, demanding strict enforcement of the Prohibition of Employment as Manual Scavengers and their Rehabilitation Act, 2013, and accountability for deaths during sewer cleaning.

At the protest site, several

families who had lost relatives while cleaning sewers and septic tanks demanded stricter enforcement of safety norms and accountability from authorities.

Kamla Devi, whose husband died during a sewer cleaning operation in outer Delhi several years ago, said the loss had left her family struggling financially and emotionally. "No family should have to lose a loved one because someone was sent into a sewer without proper equipment. We have waited years for

justice, but nothing changes," she said. Ramesh Kumar, a sanitation worker from north-west Delhi, said many workers continue to enter septic tanks because refusing the job could cost them their livelihood. "People assume we have a choice, but most of us don't. Until every sewer is cleaned by machines, workers will continue to put their lives at risk," he said.

Social activists, who joined the demonstration, said every sewer death reflected a failure to implement existing laws.

From Page 1

Govt revives

The proposal also envisages increasing the number of seats in state and Union Territory assemblies to provide 33 per cent reservation for women.

The government's earlier delimitation proposal had faced resistance from southern states, which feared that a larger increase in seats in the north could allow parties sweeping those states to secure a majority at the Centre, weakening the political influence of the south.

Sources said efforts are being made to reintroduce the Bill, with some changes to address the concerns of southern states, during the remaining four working days of the Monsoon session before it concludes on August 13.

The last attempt came during a three-day special sitting of Parliament from April 16 to 18, when the Constitution (131st Amendment) Bill was introduced. It was the first Bill under the Modi government to be defeated in Parliament.

During the debate in April, Union Home Minister Amit Shah said a false narrative had been created that southern states would be disadvantaged during delimitation because they had controlled population growth more effectively than northern states.

The government is considering adding a provision to the revised Bill stating that the existing Lok Sabha seats in every state would be increased by 50 per cent, irrespective of population.

A government functionary said that if the Bill is to be reintroduced, it will be done during the ongoing session, ruling out a special session after the Independence Day weekend.

Sources said Rijiju did not discuss extending the current session or convening a special session during his meeting with Gandhi. Instead, he sought the Congress leader's views on the Opposition's stand on delimitation.

Rijiju met Gandhi in his office in the Parliament complex. Congress MP Priyanka Gandhi Vadra was present, while Lok Sabha Deputy Leader Gaurav Gogoi and party general secretary K.C. Venugopal joined the meeting later.

Gandhi told Rijiju that a statement by the Home Minister on police action against students protesting over the NEET paper leak and a discussion on the alleged theft of donations at the Ram Temple in Ayodhya were non-negotiable for the House to function, sources said. It was Rijiju's second meeting with Gandhi in the past 10 days.

The Bill had earlier fallen short of the required two-thirds majority in the Lok Sabha, with 298 members voting in favour and 230 against. The government's numbers have improved marginally since then.

The NDA's strength in the Lok Sabha now stands at 299 after seven Shiv Sena (UBT) MPs merged with the Eknath Shinde-led Shiv Sena.

Among the 20 NCPI MPs, three Muslim members have remained non-committal about supporting the NDA. If all 20 back the Bill, the government would have the assured support of 319 MPs.

However, that remains well short of the 360 votes required to pass a constitutional amendment based on the current effective strength of the House.

The DMK is no longer part of the INDIA bloc after the Congress joined the TVK government in Tamil Nadu. With 22 Lok Sabha MPs, it is now the third-largest opposition party in the House. In the Rajya Sabha, its eight members make it the second-largest opposition party.

Its support could prove crucial for the passage of the Bill linked to the implementation of women's reservation.

Since the Monsoon session began on July 20, protests by opposition parties have repeatedly disrupted proceedings in the Lok Sabha, preventing the House from completing Question Hour. Five Bills have been passed without discussion amid repeated disruptions.

The Opposition has been protesting over the NEET paper leak and the alleged theft of donations at the Ayodhya Ram Temple. It has been demanding a discussion on police action against students protesting over the paper leak and insisting on the presence of Prime Minister Narendra Modi and the Home Minister.

Proceedings were adjourned again on Wednesday as Opposi-

tion MPs continued raising slogans over several issues, including police action against students. Soon after the House assembled, Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla appealed to members to return to their seats and allow Question Hour to function.

"Sloganeering, whether inside or outside the House, is not good for democracy. By displaying placards and raising slogans, you are lowering the dignity of the House," Birla said.

Addressing the Lok Sabha, Rijiju criticised the Opposition over its protests concerning the alleged misappropriation of donations made to the Ram Temple in Ayodhya.

Listen to protesting

Referring to a recent law and order incident in Rajasthan, he argued that governments should not "bend backwards" to accommodate protesters if violence had occurred.

He said, "Stone pelters can not be let off," adding that similar incidents could be repeated in other states if criminal cases were withdrawn.

The counsel further contended that the July 20 march had allegedly been held without permission and that organisers had violated 22 conditions governing the event. He questioned how participants were allowed to march towards Parliament, describing it as the "temple of democracy", and argued that authorities could not have known whether anyone among the crowd was carrying weapons or explosives.

Responding to these submissions, the bench said the larger objective should be to ensure peaceful democratic protests while preventing further violence through dialogue.

The Chief Justice observed that even if some "misguided elements" engaged in stone-pelting, young people should first be counselled and pacified instead of facing an aggressive response from the State.

"They need advice and counselling. Any aggressive approach from the side of the mighty State may socially aggravate the situation and precipitate further violence. That needs to be avoided," the bench said.

The court added that police also have an important responsibility during demonstrations.

"What is important is to promote a peaceful march. If some incident takes place, the police also need to exercise a great deal of restraint to ensure that the situation does not go out of hand," the bench observed.

It further remarked that the "most powerful force is listening," saying authorities should hear young protesters and understand the reasons behind their grievances instead of immediately resorting to confrontation.

"We need to tread carefully, so that these youngsters do not indulge in violence. The better course is to counsel them and pacify them. Listen to them and understand why they are shouting," the bench said.

At the same time, the judges said operational decisions on maintaining law and order should remain with police authorities.

"Let us leave it to the wisdom of the law enforcement agencies. They know better than you, and they know better than us, how to deal with this kind of situation," the bench remarked, while noting that it remained open to hearing all viewpoints and allowing the government to respond.

RBI keeps

It raised the GDP growth forecast for the current financial year to 6.7 per cent from the earlier estimate of 6.6 per cent announced in June. The inflation forecast was lowered to 5 per cent from 5.1 per cent.

The RBI said India's economy continues to show resilience despite uncertainty arising from the West Asia conflict and global trade tensions. It attributed the steady growth to strong domestic demand, healthy manufacturing and services activity, and robust exports. However, it cautioned that risks linked to the southwest monsoon, possible El Nino conditions, geopolitical tensions and global trade policies could affect the outlook.

"Global economic conditions and sentiments continue to remain hostage to the rapidly oscillating developments, both in scale and intensity, of the West Asia conflict," Malhotra said. He added that India's stronger mac-

roeconomic fundamentals are helping the country navigate these challenges. "We shall continue to implement policies that further fortify our economy... we will do whatever it takes" to preserve price stability, financial stability, currency stability and sustainable growth, he said.

The RBI noted that banking system liquidity remains in surplus and said it would continue two-way liquidity operations to ensure adequate funds and keep the weighted average call rate aligned with the repo rate.

On the Foreign Currency Non-Resident (Bank) deposit scheme, Malhotra said inflows have been "robust" and are expected to remain healthy until the limited-period scheme ends. He ruled out any proposal to close the scheme ahead of schedule despite the associated costs. On the rupee, he said the currency could strengthen further if geopolitical tensions ease, while assuring that the RBI would ensure an orderly exchange rate movement.

The central bank also announced plans to introduce long-lasting polymer currency notes from the beginning of the next financial year. Malhotra said the notes, which have remained in use for over 30 years in some countries, would be particularly useful for lower-denomination currency that changes hands frequently. In addition, the RBI proposed a uniform regulatory framework for interest rates on advances across all regulated entities to improve transparency and strengthen consumer protection.

Meta apologises

On that basis, the government argued that Meta would not be entitled to the safe harbour protections available to intermediaries, which shield platforms from liability for user-generated content subject to compliance with the law.

The sources said the issue was conveyed to the company's global leadership as part of the government's broader push for greater platform accountability.

The government also questioned Meta over child sexual abuse material, deepfakes, safeguards for verified and prominent accounts, algorithmic bias and compliance with Indian law.

Meta had separately come under regulatory scrutiny after receiving a government notice last month over alleged child sexual abuse material in paid advertisements on Instagram.

narrated their ordeal.

He asserted that complaining about the education system, which is flawed, collapsing and useless, is not a crime.

"If anything, the system needs to be changed, it needs to be corrected and that is all they (the students) were asking for. They were not indulging in violence, they were not being aggressive or nasty. They were beaten, assaulted and threatened," Gandhi alleged.

"Forcing them, sending 'goondas' and forcibly taking their apology, taking apology from a 15-year-old and accepting that apology is nonsense and unacceptable to us," he said.

Gandhi called for an education system that works, an end to exam leaks, and respect and protection of the students' future.

"The person who had pellet gun fired at this young lady, the person who had a pellet gun fired at that young man whom I brought before the press a few days ago, the person who has turned the police force against this young lady, is Amit Shah and he is the home minister of India," Gandhi said.

"He (Shah) does not have the decency to come to Parliament. He does not have the decency or the courage to comment on what has happened.

"There are two possibilities -- he did not know that violence was carried out on children, in which case he is incompetent; or he ordered that the pellet gun be fired and violence unleashed against youngsters, which means he is culpable. Either way, he is responsible," the former Congress chief said.

Later, Gandhi posted on Instagram pictures from his meeting with the students. "Look at India's future—young, fearless, outspoken, and patriotic. And the Prime Minister and Home Minister? Neither the courage to come to Parliament nor the guts to provide answers," he said in his post.

The students, including Riya Ahir from Mumbai and activists Nutan Topo, Farha Naz, Bharat

and Muskan Sharma, gave firsthand accounts of being beaten, thrashed, humiliated and fired upon with pellet guns during the peaceful demonstration.

It was model Rhiya Ahir, whose picture blocking a police van during student protests in Mumbai had gone viral. She has approached police alleging online harassment.

Speaking with reporters with Gandhi by his side, Ahir said she had stopped 20 children from being unlawfully arrested, and she was being harassed online.

She asserted that what she is facing is not trolling but a crime. A woman who was allegedly hit by a pellet gun during the Jantar Mantar protest on July 20 also spoke at the presser.

Accompanied by the students, Gandhi said he was "proud" of them for defending India's Constitution and democracy. He sharply criticised Home Minister Amit Shah, holding him squarely responsible for the police violence and demanding he display the same courage as the students by facing the press.

Highlighting what he called the students' exceptional courage, Gandhi contrasted their willingness to face media scrutiny with the silence of Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Shah. He noted that unlike the young people who spoke "fearlessly and eloquently", the senior ministers lacked the "decency or courage" to appear before the press.

Gandhi pressed the charge against Shah, saying the Home Minister was either incapable of controlling police violence and thus unfit for office or had ordered it himself, making him culpable. "He is responsible either way," Gandhi said, categorically blaming Shah for the July 20 violence.

News organisations

A bench headed by Chief Justice Surya Kant said the restriction applies only to the use of audio and video recordings in news reports and should not be read as a complete ban on media coverage of court proceedings.

"It appears, however, that some confusion persists in respect of paragraph 11 of the earlier order, which this court deems necessary to clarify. The said paragraph makes it clear that the order is not to be construed as imposing a blanket prohibition on the reporting of court proceedings by recognised news outlets," the bench said in its July 31 order.

The court said recognised news organisations can continue reporting on hearings and keep the public informed about legal developments and judicial decisions. However, they cannot use audio or video clips of court proceedings while doing so.

"In sum, while news outlets may continue to report on the court proceedings, they shall nonetheless remain bound by the restrictions set out in paragraph 10," the bench added.

Under paragraph 10 of the July 24 order, "there shall be no extraction, modification, dissemination, monetisation, posting, reposting and uploading of audio-video recordings of judicial proceedings on social media or other digital platforms without prior permission of the secretary general of this court or the registrar general of the jurisdictional high courts."

The Supreme Court had earlier issued notices to the Centre and other respondents, including several social media platforms, seeking their replies to a petition filed by journalist Harshita Grover.

Appearing for the petitioner, senior advocate Vikas Singh told the court that the issue raised in the plea was of significant importance.

CM Soren

Social activist Sonam Wangchuk, who recently observed a 26-day hunger strike in Delhi over the NEET paper leak issue, urged Mahto over the phone to at least drink water. Mahto accepted the request and continued his protest after ending his complete fast.

Jpsc-JSSC Reforms Manch spokesperson Jivan Kumar said the protesters had intensified the agitation after repeated appeals to the government failed to produce concrete action. One of the fasting protesters, Sabita Kumari, said students had been left with no alternative. Another protester, Habiba, appealed to Soren, saying, "We want action and justice, not just assurances."

The protesters also organised a Tiranga Yatra to draw public

attention to the alleged recruitment irregularities.

The administration initiated talks as Ranchi Sub-Divisional Officer Kumar Rajat and Additional District Magistrate (Law and Order) Dhananjay Kumar visited the protest site and invited a five-member student delegation to meet the chief minister. Rajat said the students had sought time to consider the proposal.

In a post on X, Soren said recruitment paper leaks were "not merely a Jharkhand issue but a major national problem affecting the youth across the country." He said investigating agencies were working round the clock and those responsible were being sent to jail. "Our objective is not just to investigate but to provide a permanent solution to students' concerns," he said, adding that the government remained open to suggestions and would announce a concrete solution after examining every issue.

Earlier, Soren briefed Governor Santosh Kumar Gangwar on the protests and the progress of the investigation. According to Raj Bhavan, the Governor said recruitment bodies must function with complete transparency and credibility, while the chief minister assured him that no injustice would be allowed against students.

The issue also drew political reactions. BJP leader Babul Marandi reiterated the party's demand for cancellation of the examination and a CBI probe, alleging the ongoing CID investigation was an attempt to shield those responsible. Congress, an ally in the ruling coalition, also backed the protesters. Jharkhand Congress in-charge K. Raju said he would raise the issue with the chief minister, while senior leader Ajoy Kumar had earlier sought a judicial inquiry, dismissal of Jpsc officials and cancellation of recent examination results.

The CID has arrested 14 people so far, questioned former Jpsc chairman L. Khiantge four times since July 28 and conducted raids at 18 locations across Ranchi, Palamu, Hazaribagh, Bokaro and Dhanbad. Amid mounting pressure, the Jpsc had earlier postponed the Combined Civil Services Mains Examination, scheduled from July 25 to 27, citing "unavoidable circumstances".

India, Myanmar

are yet to be settled" and discussions on those sectors were continuing through bilateral channels. Jaiswal was responding to questions on reports that India was exploring an exchange of territory with Myanmar to complete border demarcation in Manipur. He did not confirm the reported proposal but said efforts were underway to settle the remaining unresolved stretches of the boundary.

His remarks came weeks after US-based magazine The Diplomat reported that India was examining a proposal to complete demarcation between boundary pillars 65 and 68 by exchanging around 1.4 square miles of territory. The proposed stretch covers about 2.8 km in Manipur's Chandel district, adjoining Myanmar's Kabaw Valley in the Sagaing Region.

According to the report, which cited an official document dated May 26, 2026, the demarcation exercise was expected to be completed within three months. The government, however, has not officially confirmed that any land exchange has been agreed upon.

India and Myanmar share a border running through Arunachal Pradesh, Nagaland, Manipur and Mizoram before entering Myanmar's Sagaing Region and Chin State. Much of the frontier is mountainous, forested and porous, making surveillance difficult while allowing long-standing ethnic communities to live across both sides.

The Ministry of Home Affairs says about 1,472 km of the border has already been demarcated, while nearly 171 km remains unsettled, mainly in Arunachal Pradesh's Lohit sector and Manipur's Kabaw Valley.

The reported proposal comes as India continues to strengthen border security. In February 2024, the Centre announced plans to fence the entire India-Myanmar border and build a patrol track to improve surveillance. It also decided to end the Free Movement Regime, introduced in 2018, under which tribal communities living near the border could travel up to 16 km into each other's territory with a border pass.

The current boundary is based on a 1967 bilateral agreement, with unresolved sections being addressed through bilateral mechanisms. India has maintained that

there is no wider territorial dispute with Myanmar and that only a limited number of boundary pillars remain to be settled.

The reported proposal has drawn opposition in Manipur. The Coordinating Committee on Manipur Integrity (COCOMI) warned that it would strongly oppose any move to cede even a small part of the state's territory. The organisation described Manipur's territorial integrity as non-negotiable and said any decision affecting its boundaries without the consent of its people would be unacceptable. It also cautioned the Centre against "playing with fire" over the issue.

Territorial exchanges are not new for India. In 2015, India and Bangladesh implemented the Land Boundary Agreement, exchanging enclaves and ending a 41-year-old border dispute. AGENCY

While fuel

Concerns that Iran could disrupt shipping through the Strait of Hormuz, one of the significant routes for shipping oil, triggered an increase in Brent Crude oil prices. At the peak of the conflict, crude briefly climbed to around \$126 a barrel before easing later in June.

Biggest winners of the quarter Saudi Arabia's state-owned Aramco posted the highest quarterly earnings, reporting net income of more than \$33 billion, a 34 per cent increase from a year earlier.

Among US energy giants, ExxonMobil reported \$14.5 billion in profit, while Chevron posted net income of \$12.2 billion. Shell recorded its second-highest quarterly profit at \$9.84 billion. TotalEnergies reported adjusted net income of \$6.03 billion, BP earned \$5.73 billion, Equinor reported \$3.2 billion and Italy's Eni posted adjusted net profit of \$2.16 billion.

The scale of the profits prompted Trump to criticise the industry, saying the biggest US oil companies were "making too much money".

Industry defends earnings

Oil industry representatives argued that companies do not control market prices and said higher earnings are essential for future investment.

"This industry is a price taker, not a price maker," said Mike Sommers, president of the American Petroleum Institute, reported Mint.

"Because the Strait of Hormuz has been shut down for basically five months, we are, of course, going to be dealing with higher prices at the pump."

While defending the industry's position, Sommers also praised Trump for constructing the environment that benefited the industry. At the same time, the drastic fluctuations of crude prices due to the war have once more shown that the geopolitical issues can impact the world energy markets and the prices for fuel in no time.

India's prisons

Jammu and Kashmir recorded 5,383 inmates against a capacity of 3,629, taking occupancy to 148.3 per cent. Madhya Pradesh housed 45,092 prisoners in jails with a capacity of 30,644, while Maharashtra had 39,003 inmates against 27,110 sanctioned seats, recording occupancy rates of 147.1 per cent and 143.9 per cent, respectively.

Kerala reported 10,307 inmates against a capacity of 7,823, translating to 131.8 per cent occupancy. Punjab had 30,663 prisoners in jails built for 26,543 inmates, with occupancy at 115.5 per cent. Uttar Pradesh, which has the country's largest prison capacity of 76,162, housed 86,762 inmates, taking occupancy to 113.9 per cent.

Responding to another question on undertrial prisoners, Kumar informed the House that India had 3,71,440 undertrial prisoners as on December 31, 2024. Of them, 968 undertrial prisoners were found eligible for release under Section 479 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS) or Section 436A of the Code of Criminal Procedure. During the year, 627 eligible undertrial prisoners were released.

Kumar said no specific reasons for the delay in releasing the remaining eligible undertrial prisoners had been reported by states and Union territories to the Ministry of Home Affairs.

He told the House that prison administration and management fall under the State List of the Constitution, making states and Union territories responsible for expanding prison infrastruc-

ture, reducing overcrowding and ensuring the timely release of eligible undertrial prisoners.

The minister said the Centre has released Rs 608.6 crore to states and Union territories over the last five financial years under the Modernisation of Prisons project. The funds have been provided for constructing high-security prisons, strengthening prison security infrastructure and improving correctional administration through inmate skilling and rehabilitation initiatives.

On concerns related to overcrowding and its effect on prisoners' rights, healthcare, legal aid and rehabilitation, the government said these issues primarily fall within the jurisdiction of states and Union territories. It added that the Ministry of Home Affairs has circulated the UN Standard Minimum Rules for the Treatment of Prisoners and the Model Prison Manual, 2016, to all states and Union territories to promote humane prison conditions and improve prison administration, including medical care, legal aid, after-care and rehabilitation measures.

Centre extends

In a separate order, the ACC approved a one-year extension for Home Secretary Govind Mohan beyond August 22, 2026. He will continue in the post until August 22, 2027. The order said the extension was granted by relaxing the provisions of Fundamental Rule 56(d) and Rule 16(1A) of the All India Services (Death-cum-Retirement Benefits) Rules, 1958.

Under the existing rules, the government can extend the service of key officials beyond the retirement age of 60 years. These include the cabinet secretary, home secretary, defence secretary, foreign secretary, director of the Intelligence Bureau, secretary of the Research and Analysis Wing, and certain other senior positions.

Mohan is a 1989 batch IAS officer of the Sikkim cadre and was appointed Home Secretary in August 2024.

PM: J&K, Ladakh witnessed wide-ranging transformation since Art 370 abrogation

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Wednesday said since the abrogation of Article 370 in 2019, the lives of people in Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh have witnessed wide-ranging transformation, with expansion of infrastructure and growth in opportunities in education, healthcare, entrepreneurship and sports sectors.

On the seventh anniversary of the abrogation of Article 370, Modi said the Centre remains committed to the development of Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh and to ensuring that every citizen has the opportunity to "dream big, achieve and contribute" to the making of a Viksit Bharat.

He said infrastructure in the two Union Territories has expanded, while opportunities in areas such as education, healthcare, entrepreneurship and sports have grown.

Be it women or marginalised communities, those who were denied their basic constitutional rights for decades have been empowered thanks to the full application of the Constitution of India, Modi added.

In a post on X, the prime minister said, "Seven years ago, on this day, Articles 370 and 35(A) became history, marking a decisive new chapter in the journey of Jammu and Kashmir as well as Ladakh..."

On August 5, 2019, the BJP-led Centre abrogated Article 370, which gave special status to Jammu and Kashmir, and the erstwhile state was bifurcated into two union territories -- Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh.

"We reaffirm our commitment to the progress of Jammu and Kashmir as well as Ladakh and to ensure that every citizen has the opportunity to dream big, achieve and contribute to the making of a Viksit Bharat," he added.

PM Modi said "August 5 this year assumes even greater significance as this is the year the nation commemorates the 125th birth anniversary of Syama Prasad Mukerjee".

GOVT CITES PENDENCY CONCERNS

Rajya Sabha passes Bill to expand Apex Court judges’ strength to 37

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Rajya Sabha on Wednesday passed a Bill to increase the number of judges of the Supreme Court from the present 33 to 37 (excluding the Chief Justice) with a voice vote with Union Minister Arjun Ram Meghwal asserting that the government is committed to independence of the judiciary.

The Supreme Court (Number of Judges) Amendment Bill, 2026, was passed by a voice vote after a brief discussion in the Upper House, while Opposition members staged a walkout.

The Bill, which will replace an ordinance, has already been approved by the Lok Sabha on August 3. Being a Money Bill, the Upper House returned it to the Lok Sabha.

Replying to the debate, Meghwal, who is the Minister of State for Law and Justice, said the increase in the sanc-



Arjun Ram Meghwal speaks in the Rajya Sabha during the Monsoon session of Parliament, in New Delhi

PTI

Highlights

- » He said the judiciary has witnessed a steady rise in case filings, necessitating an expansion in judicial capacity
- » Meghwal, who is the Minister of State for Law and Justice, said the increase in the sanctioned strength is part of the government’s judicial reforms aimed at improving access to justice and reducing the backlog of cases

tioned strength is part of the government’s judicial reforms aimed at improving access to justice and reducing the backlog of cases.

He said the judiciary has witnessed a steady rise in case filings, necessitating an expansion in judicial capacity.

“A structural shift is needed to be adopted in the Supreme Court, where a need is felt to

establish at least one permanent constitutional bench and two or three dedicated three-judge benches,” he said.

Meghwal said questions are raised on the government for going through the ordinance route to expand the number of judges at the apex court. Replying to that, the minister said the Chief Justice, through a letter, informed the Prime Minister

on May 11 about the rise in the number of daily case filings.

“He (CJI) said there is a gap of 10,000 cases per year. He said that 75,410 cases were filed and a fresh 46,988 cases were instituted. It has become necessary to have a higher daily disposal rate at the admission stage. This will only be possible when the number of judges in the Supreme Court increases,”

said Meghwal.

CJI had also mentioned that when the constitutional benches are established, for example, the case of Sabarimala is being heard by a nine-judge bench, the number of judges is reduced in the regular benches.

“Due to the establishment of the constitutional benches, the number of judges is reduced in the regular cases,” he said adding, “the long sitting of larger benches leads to reduction in the strength of regular benches, which contributes to pendency. Therefore, increasing the number of judges has become necessary.”

Meghwal said over the years, governments have taken steps to increase the number of judges. When the Supreme Court started functioning in 1950 it had eight judges, including the Chief Justice. Its strength has been increased from time to time in line with the growing workload.

NEW DELHI: Opposition MPs took out a protest march in Parliament House complex on Wednesday, demanding Home Minister Amit Shah’s statement on alleged police excesses against students, discussion on “misappropriation” of Ram temple donations and statehood for Jammu and Kashmir.

Carrying placards and raising slogans against the government, the Opposition MPs, including Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge, Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi and Congress general secretary Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, marched from the statue of Mahatma Gandhi at Prerna Sthal to Makar Dwar.

Kharge demanded accountability from the government.

Taking a swipe at Shah, Kharge asked why hasn’t he been coming to the House.

“They are disrespecting Parliament. It has been



Opposition leaders during the protest

PTI

so many days but they don’t want to step inside the House. What is the issue in coming to the House and giving a statement?” Kharge told reporters.

Later, in a post on X, Kharge said, “INDIA demands answers - Why is the Home Minister shying away from making a statement in the Parliament on the atrocities perpetrated against our youth? Isn’t the PM responsible for ‘chanda-chadhawa chori’ in Shree Ram Mandir?”

Gandhi also slammed Shah and sought answers over the

alleged police brutality against students during the July 20 protest over the paper leak issue.

“Amit Shah ji, do not hide; answer the nation’s question in Parliament - who ordered the attack on the students?” Gandhi said in his Facebook post.

The MPs carried placards slamming the government and demanded a statement by Shah in both Houses of Parliament on the alleged “atrocities” committed by police and other forces on students during protests over the paper leak issue last month.

E20 burdened middle class, only ethanol producers benefitted: Cong

NEW DELHI: Attacking the government over the rollout of E20 petrol, the Congress on Wednesday alleged that it has deprived middle class Indians of choice, saddled them with an inflated fuel bill, and damaged the vehicle they saved for years to purchase.

Ethanol producers are the only class to have benefitted from E20, the opposition party said. In a post on X, Congress general secretary Jairam Ramesh said regular petrol pumps have effectively supplied only E20 petrol since March 2025.

“The Modi Government’s Transport Minister (Nitin Gadkari) had claimed that ethanol blending would bring diesel costs down to Rs. 50 per litre

‘The government could have reduced the retail price of E20’

and provide a petrol alternative at Rs. 55 per litre. No such reduction has materialised,” Ramesh said.

Instead, an independent analysis estimates that between April 2023 and March 2026, consumers collectively spent nearly Rs 88,234 crore extra just to offset the reduced mileage of ethanol-blended fuel, he claimed.

Ramesh said citizens are effectively now paying more for E20 than they previously paid for regular petrol.

The Modi government could have reduced the retail price of E20 to offset this loss in mileage, he argued.

The NITI Aayog’s ethanol roadmap recommended fiscal and tax incentives on E10 and E20 fuels to compensate consumers, he pointed out.

Instead, the Modi government has approved more than Rs 4,000 crore in subsidies for ethanol producers, further tilting the benefits of the E20 programme towards industry rather than consumers, Ramesh said. “E20 has deprived ordinary middle class Indians of choice, saddled them with an inflated fuel bill, and damaged the vehicle that they saved for years to purchase,” the Congress leader alleged. **MP0ST**

Rahul flags RSS-linked role in Sainik Schools

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE

NEW DELHI: A fierce exchange of words was reported during the parliamentary standing committee on defence on Tuesday following the apprehensions expressed by the leader of the opposition in the Lok Sabha, Rahul Gandhi, regarding the increasing involvement of organisations connected with the RSS in the management of the Sainik Schools in PPP format.

The high-level discussion, which was held at Parliament Annexe and presided over by BJP MP Radha Mohan Singh, was held for the consideration and adoption of the Action Taken Report on the review of Sainik Schools, Rashtriya Indian Military College (RIMC) and Rashtriya Military Schools. The committee



Rahul Gandhi during a protest at the Parliament

PTI

also considered the report in respect of DFG for the fiscal year 2026-27 and deliberated upon the matters related to the modernisation and self-reliance of Defence Public Sector Undertakings (DPSU).

It was only then that the meeting gained political importance when Gandhi made references to news reports which

apparently showed signs of RSS-affiliated institutions becoming involved in the management of the Sainik Schools that have come up under the PPP model. As per sources, Gandhi raised questions on how the institutions affiliated to RSS were given the job of taking care of the running of many schools under the PPP model.

Haryana CM reviews Saraswati project, orders faster execution

CHANDIGARH: Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Wednesday said the revival of the Saraswati River is among the state government’s top priorities, describing the river as a symbol of India’s ancient civilisation and cultural heritage.

Chairing a meeting of the Haryana Saraswati Heritage Development Board at the Civil Secretariat, Saini reviewed the progress of the project and released a report on the Board’s achievements. He directed officials to expedite all pending works, including those at Adi Badri, and ensure proper sanitation at religious sites in the Pehowa area.

Officials informed the Chief



Minister that a 350-acre Saraswati reservoir is under development and excavation of 10 lakh cusecs of earth has already been completed. Saini also asked the Irrigation Department to accelerate the construction of the barrage, warning that delays or technical lapses would not be tolerated. The meeting also reviewed plans worth around

Rs 56 crore for the beautification of the Prachi Saraswati tributary, construction of ghats, bridges, cultural facilities and riverfront infrastructure. Renovation of ancient temples, pond rejuvenation and a proposed museum and interpretation centre at Pehowa also formed part of the integrated development plan. **MP0ST**

L-G attends Ladakh Foundation Day celebrations



LEH: Lieutenant Governor Vinai Kumar Saxena on Thursday attended the “dPal rNgam Duston 2026” celebrations at the historic Leh Palace, commemorating the seventh anniversary of Ladakh’s attainment of Union Territory status. Amid the cultural fervour, the L-G congratulated the people of Ladakh saying this historic occasion marked the fulfilment of the long-standing aspirations of the people under the visionary leadership of Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Home Minister Amit Shah.

Addressing the gathering, the L-G described August 5 as a defining moment in Ladakh’s history, and said that “dPal rNgam Duston” has evolved into a celebration of Ladakh’s identity, culture, resilience and collective aspirations while symbolising unity among its people.

“The journey of Ladakh as a Union Territory has been one of transformation, resilience and collective progress. Our endeavour has been to build an inclusive, sustainable and future-ready Ladakh while preserving its unique cultural identity and fragile ecology. The remarkable achievements across governance, infrastructure, tourism, healthcare, education, environment and sports reflect the collective efforts of our people and the unwavering support of the government under the leadership of PM Modi. As we move towards the vision of Viksit Bharat 2047, we remain committed to building a prosperous, peaceful and self-reliant Ladakh.” **MP0ST**

BJP deliberately lost Bankipur, Datia to mislead people on EVM debate: Akhilesh

LUCKNOW: Samajwadi Party president Akhilesh Yadav on Wednesday alleged that the BJP had “deliberately” lost the recent assembly bypolls in Bihar’s Bankipur and Madhya Pradesh’s Datia to create a false impression that elections could not be questioned and to deflect criticism over the electoral process.

Addressing a Brahmin Sammelan organised at the party’s state headquarters here on the birth anniversary of veteran socialist leader Janeshwar Mishra, Yadav claimed that the ruling party had intentionally refrained from employing the “model” it had allegedly used in Uttar Pradesh and West Bengal elections. “The BJP deliber-



ately lost these bypolls because it wanted to check whether elections could be won without dishonesty. It did not adopt in Bankipur and Datia the model that it had adopted in Uttar Pradesh and West Bengal. The BJP has lost these byelections only to mislead the people,” Yadav alleged.

Claiming that the BJP wanted to weaken the opposition’s criticism of the electoral

process, he said, “Now they will say that opposition parties will no longer raise questions about EVMs. They have deliberately lost these bypolls.”

Meanwhile, Yadav launched a sharp attack on the ruling BJP over the alleged theft of offerings at the Ram temple in Ayodhya, claiming that those responsible for stealing “Ram Dhan” would be punished by Lord Ram himself and would not be allowed to win elections.

“BJP leaders are hiding their faces. The donation box is locked from the top but they have dug a tunnel underneath. If anyone has committed the biggest sin, it is the BJP because they have stolen the offerings made to Lord Ram.” **MP0ST**

Golden promise: Vijay’s maiden Budget allocates over Rs 1K crore for gold gifts

Allocation backs poll promise of gifting gold rings and coins to beneficiaries

OUR CORRESPONDENT

CHENNAI: Tamil Nadu Finance Minister N Marie Wilson on Wednesday presented the maiden budget of the TVK regime, earmarking over Rs 1,000 crore to provide gifts of gold coin, ring and milch cows to women beneficiaries and making a tight rope walk to ensure phased implementation of populist assurances made before the 2026 Assembly polls and at the same time attempting to stick to fiscal prudence.

The C Joseph Vijay-led government said it was undertaking various measures for additional revenue mobilisation, even as it said the states’ finances were in the red.

Main opposition party DMK, besides its Dravidian rival AIADMK, gave a ‘zero’ to the budget.

Additional privilege fee on liquor manufacturers, which is expected to mobilise an additional annual revenue of up to Rs 1,000 crore was among the initiatives cited by the govern-



TN CM C Joseph Vijay attends the proceedings

PTI

ment that also sought to reach out to Gen Z and Gen Alpha populations with branded bicycles and laptops.

Citing reforms, transparency and action against corruption, Wilson praised CM Vijay for completely halting the practice of “cut” (kickbacks) in tenders for some parties and individuals.

On the policy front, opposition to NEET and raising the water level of Mullaperiyar was among the stances reiterated by

the government. Wilson urged the Centre to scrap the qualifying test and revert to the old method of medical admissions based on class 12 marks.

Wilson said the Chief Minister always stands by every woman in Tamil Nadu as their elder and younger brother.

“Marriage is one of the most joyous occasions in a woman’s life. Our chief minister, who considers every woman in Tamil Nadu as a member of his own family, will present

Key Points

- » The C Joseph Vijay-led government said it was undertaking various measures for additional revenue mobilisation, even as it said the states’ finances were in the red
- » Under the “Thai Maaman Thanga Mothiram Thittam,” every newborn delivered in a Government hospital 12 will receive a 1 gram gold ring, at a cost of Rs 560 crore

an eight gram gold coin and a silk saree as ‘Annan Seer’ (elder brother’s gift) to them on their joyous wedding day. An amount of Rs 812 crore is allocated for this scheme in the revised budget estimates.”

Under the “Thai Maaman Thanga Mothiram Thittam,” every newborn delivered in a Government hospital 12 will receive a 1 gram gold ring, at a cost of Rs.560 crore.

Explaining the scheme, Wilson said maternal and

child healthcare is a core pillar of Tamil Nadu’s public health system.

Under the “Vetri Magalir Goat Rearing Scheme”, a 100 per cent subsidy for five goats or sheep will be provided to destitute widows, deserted women, transgender persons and persons with disabilities, benefiting about 30,000 persons, at a cost of Rs 110 crore.

The government unveiled a slew of targeted schemes like distribution of branded bicycles, providing AI skill training to youth and specialised urban housing

“The fiscal position of the State is in the red, and we have been handed a treasury box that is overburdened with debt and sub-optimal income with leaking holes,” Wilson said, adding the government would need at least two years to get the state back on rails of fiscal prudence.

The revenue deficit in the revised budget estimates for 2026-27 is estimated to rise to Rs 55,775 crore. **AGENCIES**

EC deletes over 43.61L names in Jharkhand draft electoral rolls

RANCHI: The names of over 43.61 lakh people were deleted from the voter list as the Election Commission on Wednesday published the draft electoral rolls in Jharkhand after the enumeration phase of the Special Intensive Revision (SIR).

Jharkhand Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) K Ravi Kumar said the state had 2.64 crore voters before the beginning of the enumeration phase of SIR in the state.

After the completion of the enumeration phase, the draft electoral roll features 2.21 voters, including 1.12 crore men, 1.08 crore women and 260 third gender voters, he said.

“As on July 29, out of 2,64,63,236 electors, 2,21,01,249 (83.51 per cent) electors have submitted their enumeration forms reflecting an overwhelming participation in the enumeration phase of SIR,” Kumar said.

The enumeration exercise for the SIR of electoral rolls began on June 30 and continued till July 29, during which BLOs conducted

door-to-door visits to distribute, collect and verify enumeration forms.

As many as 43,61,987 voters, falling under ASDD (Absent, Shifted, Dead, or Duplicate) list, have been removed from the draft rolls.

Of the 43.61 lakh voters, around 7.63 lakh died, 15.92 lakh permanently shifted, 14.50 lakh were untraceable or remained absent during the exercise and 4.38 lakh names were found registered as voters in multiple places, the CEO said.

Besides, around 1.16 lakh voters refused to sign enumeration forms and they did not return their forms to the booth-level officers (BLOs) during the enumeration phase, he added.

The CEO said, “An eligible elector, whose name existed in the 2026 electoral roll but failed to submit the enumeration form, can still be added to the electoral rolls during the Claims and Objection period from August 5 to September 4 by submitting Form-6 along with a declaration form.” **AGENCIES**

CM SAYS 'WOUNDS NOT YET HEALED'

J&K marks seventh anniversary of Article 370 abrogation

SPOKESPERSON ALLEGES HARASSMENT OUTSIDE HOME

CJP rules out electoral entry but continue as pressure group, backs J'khand students

HP: Jairam Thakur leads BJP protest to CM residence

OUR CORRESPONDENT

JAMMU/SRINAGAR: Protests and celebrations marked the seventh anniversary of the abrogation of Article 370 in Jammu and Kashmir on Wednesday, with Chief Minister Omar Abdullah saying the “wounds have not yet healed” and reiterating his resolve to continue seeking the restoration of the region’s special status and statehood.

The ruling National Conference and Opposition PDP held protests in all districts to mark the seventh anniversary of the abrogation of Article 370 and Article 35A, demanding the restoration of the special status of the erstwhile state of Jammu and Kashmir.

Scores of NC leaders, MLAs, and workers, led by minister Sakina Ito, assembled at the party headquarters, Nawa-i-Subah, here and held a protest march. The protesters, carrying placards in support of Article 370 and special status, tried to take the march out of the party office complex but were not allowed to by the police.

Similar protests were reported from other districts of the union territory.

Speaking to reporters, Ito, the Minister for Education and Social Welfare, said, “We demand that our special status and rights, which were snatched from us, be restored. Our party has been protesting peacefully for the restoration of our rights since then.”

PDP leader Iltija Mufti, along with party leaders, including MLA Pulwama Waheed Para, and spokesperson Mohit Bhan, took out a protest march



Participants carry a 200-meter-long Indian National Flag during a ‘Tiranga’ rally organised by the Jammu and Kashmir People’s Forum (JKPF), in Reasi, Jammu and Kashmir, Wednesday

Highlights

- » The ruling National Conference and Opposition PDP held protests in all districts to mark the seventh anniversary
- » Raising slogans demanding the restoration of Article 370, the PDP leaders tried to march towards the Dalgate area, but were stopped by the police

at Sonwar here.

Raising slogans demanding the restoration of Article 370, the PDP leaders tried to march towards the Dalgate area, but were stopped by the police.

Speaking to reporters, Iltija said the party wants to protest peacefully.

“I want to remind the prime minister and the home minister that we will fight for it. We want to protest peacefully for it. You are snatching even that right from us. The police here

are doing real terror,” she said.

She said the way Gen-Zs “brought down the government to their knees”, “we will compel them the same way”.

“We will make sure that you will have to restore our flag, our law, our constitution, and everything else,” she added.

Lieutenant Governor Manoj Sinha dismissed the protests held by NC and PDP, saying he “did not see” any demonstrations.

“I did not see any (protest). If I see, I will talk to you (about it),” the LG told a reporter when asked about protests by the National Conference (NC) and the People’s Democratic Party (PDP).

Sinha said August 5, 2019 -- the date marking the abrogation of Articles 370 and 35A -- ended the “discriminatory system” in Jammu and Kashmir.

However, Omar Abdullah said the “wounds” of the people had not yet healed seven years after the abrogation of Article 370, asserting that the Centre’s promise to restore statehood to the Union Territory remained unfulfilled.

AIMAN FATIMA

CHHATRAPATI SAMBHAJINAGAR: The Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) on Wednesday said it has no immediate plans to enter electoral politics and will instead continue functioning as a pressure group, while expanding its campaign on issues ranging from education and unemployment to rising prices and fuel policy. The announcement came during the party’s two-day core committee meeting in Maharashtra’s Chhatrapati Sambhajnagar, where its leadership is chalking out the organisation’s future strategy.

Addressing the media before the meeting, CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke said the organisation would continue mobilising public opinion rather than contesting elections.



CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke and others during their core team meeting, in Chhatrapati Sambhajnagar district, Wednesday

“For now, CJP will remain a pressure group because that is what the country needs at this stage,” Dipke said. He added that the organisation would continue raising concerns related to education, employment, inflation, the rising cost of living, the economy, the Centre’s ethanol-blended fuel policy and ongoing student movements, including the protests in Jharkhand over alleged

irregularities in recruitment examinations.

Dipke said CJP was in touch with protesting students in Ranchi and would soon send a delegation to express solidarity with them. He also described climate activist Sonam Wangchuk as the organisation’s mentor, saying his guidance would continue to shape the movement.

Referring to the political

Ambala: CM Saini honours more than 250 students

Utkrisht Shiksha Puraskar-2026 ceremony

MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH: Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini said that the state government is committed to ensuring that no talented student in Haryana is deprived of opportunities due to a lack of resources.

He said that providing equal opportunities in education, ensuring transparency and recognising merit are among the government’s highest priorities. Today, every young person in Haryana can confidently say that success depends on hard work rather than unfair practices of “kharchi-parchi”. Respect for

talent and transparency has become the identity of the new Haryana.

The Chief Minister was addressing the Utkrisht Shiksha Puraskar-2026 ceremony organised in Ambala on Wednesday.

He honoured more than 250 students from over 70 schools who excelled in Class 10, Class 12 and various competitive examinations.

Congratulating the students along with their parents and teachers, he said that the honour is not only a recognition of the students’ achievements but also a tribute to the sacrifices of parents and the dedication of teachers.

CHANDIPURA VIRUS OUTBREAK

Health Ministry deploys response teams to Gujarat and Rajasthan

NEW DELHI: The Union Health Ministry has deployed a National Joint Outbreak Response Team (NJORT) to Gujarat and Rajasthan to strengthen the response to the ongoing Chandipura Virus Disease (CHPV) outbreak.

The deployment comes against the backdrop of sustained and intensified scientific investigations by a nationwide network of research institutions, alongside continuous disease surveillance under the Integrated Disease Surveillance Programme (IDSP), coordinated by the National Centre for Disease Control (NCDC) in close collaboration with State

‘The NCDC Public Health Emergency Operations Centre has also been activated to support the NJORT’

Surveillance Units, the ministry said.

These coordinated efforts are aimed at advancing the understanding of the virus, including its transmission dynamics, clinical spectrum, epidemiology and potential treatment approaches, while guiding evidence-based public health interventions.

The NCDC Public Health

Emergency Operations Centre (PHEOC) has also been activated to support the NJORT, the ministry stated.

The multidisciplinary NJORT, comprising experts from the National Centre for Disease Control (NCDC), the Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR) and the Department of Animal Husbandry and Dairying (DAHD), will supplement the efforts of the two state governments in outbreak investigation, epidemiological assessment, clinical management, laboratory coordination, vector surveillance and implementation of public health measures, it said. **MPOST**

Chhattisgarh to spend Rs 500 cr on ‘AI Mission’ over next 5 years

OUR CORRESPONDENT

RAIPUR: The Chhattisgarh cabinet on Wednesday approved the Artificial Intelligence (AI) Mission under which Rs 500 crore will be spent over five years to promote good governance, new technologies, skill development and digital economy.

It also gave the nod for land allotment at a concessional rate to state-owned Bharat Earth Movers Limited (BEML) for setting up Chhattisgarh’s first Heavy Earth Moving Equipment manufacturing plant, Deputy Chief Minister Arun Sao said.

He was speaking to reporters after a cabinet meeting chaired by Chief Minister Vishnu Deo Sai at Mantralaya Mahanadi Bhavan.

The Chhattisgarh State AI Mission, aligned with the Government of India’s IndiaAI Mission, aims to position the state as a responsive, innovation-driven and future-ready digital state, Sao said.

Under the mission, the state will establish 100 AI Data Labs and five Centres of Excellence, support more than 300 AI startups, and provide AI training to six lakh students and 1.5 lakh government employees.

Besides, over 50 AI-enabled public services will be developed to improve governance and public service delivery, Sao added.

In other decisions, the Cabinet approved the first phase implementation of the Works and Account Management Information System (WAMIS) in the Public Works Department for digital management of construction projects.

Developed by the Centre for Development of Advanced Computing (C-DAC), Pune, the platform will integrate project approval, e-estimates, e-procurement, electronic measurement books (e-MB), bill payments, accounting and quality monitoring on a single digital platform. The system will later be extended to other construction and infrastructure departments, Sao said.

L-G Sinha hands over appointment letters to NoKs of terror victims

OUR CORRESPONDENT

SRINAGAR: The Lieutenant Governor Manoj Sinha on Wednesday handed over appointment letters to 37 Next of Kins (NoKs) of civilians who were brutally killed by terrorists.

He said it is a profound honour to stand with the families of terror victims on this historic day and it is not merely about appointment letters but it is about remembrance of martyrs, justice to terror victim families, and the reaffirmation of our national will.

“My heartfelt tribute to the innocent civilians martyred by terrorists and I salute the families who, after decades of anguish and wait, now hold appointment letters that restore dignity and livelihood. For several decades, the pain of terror victim families remained



unacknowledged, their wounds unseen. Terrorism tore apart homes and cast futures into uncertainty. No statistic can capture the anguish and suffering of the terror victim families. Today’s appointment letters are not just documents of employment but they are symbols of social justice, recognition and the nation’s solemn promise that its martyrs will never be forgotten, nor their families abandoned,” the Lieutenant Governor said.

He also stated that our commitment is reflected in decisive action. After 5 August 2019, we have dismantled the terror ecosystem to a large extent, strengthened the law and order, restored equal rights and created opportunities that allow families to rebuild their lives with confidence.

“The transformation we witness today in Jammu Kashmir is due to the historic changes of 5 August 2019. That day marked a constitutional correction and a new beginning for the UT. Discriminatory barriers were removed, equal rights were extended to those who were suffering due to discriminatory laws. The principle of one nation, one flag, one constitution was fully implemented and one standard of dignity, justice, and opportunity for all the Indian citizens was upheld,” the L-G said.

MP CM calls on youth to lead India’s journey to 2047

Yadav says AI should aid learning, not replace critical thinking; urges students to verify facts independently

SATYAPRAKASH SHARMA

BHOPAL: Madhya Pradesh Chief Minister Mohan Yadav on Wednesday urged students to use artificial intelligence (AI) responsibly, saying it should complement—not replace—critical thinking.

Interacting with students and teachers at the Kamla Nehru Sandipani Government Girls’ School in Bhopal, Yadav said hard work, discipline and self-confidence were the keys to success and described students as the driving force behind India’s goal of becoming a developed nation by 2047.

The interaction turned to technology when a student asked whether he used ChatGPT. Yadav said he uses AI tools to gather updated information for speeches and public programmes but stressed that such platforms should not be treated as the final authority.

“Whether it is ChatGPT, Grok or any other AI tool, use it, but also apply your own mind and always cross-check facts and data,” he said.

Asked about social media, the Chief Minister said he uses



Instagram as part of public outreach and follows Prime Minister Narendra Modi on the platform.

Calling the current generation the country’s ‘Amrit Peedhi’, Yadav urged students to dream big and work hard, assuring them that the state government would support their aspirations.

Recalling his own education in a government school, he said India’s progress depends

not only on economic growth but also on knowledge, values and discipline.

He also encouraged students to read beyond textbooks, pursue lifelong learning and maintain a balanced routine that includes sports, self-study and reflection.

Highlighting the state’s education initiatives, Yadav said 274 Sandipani schools under the School Education Department and 94 under the Tribal Affairs

Department are operational. The government plans to add 200 more Sandipani schools under the School Education Department and 205 under the Tribal Affairs Department in the next phase.

During the visit, the Chief Minister inspected classrooms, laboratories, the library and other facilities and interacted with members of the school’s student-run ‘Bal Cabinet’, which oversees activities

Key Points

- » 274 Sandipani schools operational; 405 more planned.
- » CM interacts with students, teachers in Bhopal school.
- » Student-run Bal Cabinet showcases leadership model.
- » Calls for employment-oriented education.

related to sports, culture and discipline.

In a separate interaction with teachers, Yadav said education should be employment-oriented and encourage students to pursue careers in agriculture, entrepreneurship, the armed forces and public service.

Concluding the programme, he urged students to contribute towards building a developed Madhya Pradesh and India by 2047, saying the generation marking the centenary of Independence would play a decisive role in shaping the nation’s future.

Closer Look

- » ‘Gau Shalas play a key role in addressing the issue of stray cattle across the state’
- » ‘It is the need of the hour to ensure proper management of Gau Shalas so that Gau Dhan is looked after properly, said Mann
- » ‘The Punjab government is fully sensitive to the concerns of every section of society’
- » There is also a need to transform Gau Shalas on



modern lines for efficient management and to effectively tackle the issue of stray animals, Mann said

Emphasising the importance of strengthening these institutions, Mann said, “It is the need of the hour to ensure proper management of Gau Shalas so that Gau Dhan is

looked after properly. My doors are always open for the Gau Shalas, which are rendering a great service to humanity by managing stray cattle that would otherwise be roaming

on the roads. The management committees deserve appreciation for dedicating their lives to serving Gau Mata, and Gau Sewa is the ultimate form of worship.”

Appreciating the efforts of the Gau Shala management committees, CM Mann said, “The various Gau Shalas are efficiently taking care of and maintaining Gau Dhan, which otherwise could pose a serious threat to human lives by roaming on the roads.”

The Chief Minister affirmed, “The Punjab government is fully sensitive to the concerns of every section of society and is committed to taking pro-people decisions. There is also a need to transform Gau Shalas on modern lines for efficient management and to effectively tackle the issue of stray animals. The state government will extend every possible support and cooperation for this cause.”

Nation Briefs

GOVERNMENT LAYS OUT STRATEGY TO TACKLE DRUG TRAFFICKING

NEW DELHI: The Central govt laid out its strategy on Tuesday to combat drug trafficking and abuse in the country, saying that the Vision Document on Narcotics Control (2026-2029) had been drafted which will guide the country’s anti-drug efforts in the next three years. The government said the document, which spells out time-bound targets for all agencies and promotes a “Whole-of-Government” and “Whole-of-Society” approach was released on June 26, 2026. “The Narcotics Control Bureau (NCB), State Police and other Drug Law Enforcement Agencies have been taking robust enforcement actions under NDPS Act and have been achieving commendable results in terms of seizures, arrests, destruction of illicit opium poppy gardens, financial intelligence and preventive detention under the PITNDPS Act,” the govt stated.

CBI SECURES DEPORTATION OF VISHAKHA RATHOD FROM UAE TO INDIA

NEW DELHI: The CBI, in cooperation with the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) and Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA), has succeeded in deporting the Red Notice fugitive Vishakha Rathod, wanted in a major financial fraud case from the United Arab Emirates (UAE) to India. As per the officials, the accused of financial fraud was deported back to India on August 3, 2026, after India’s efforts. She reached Pune on August 3, and the Maharashtra Police’s special team arrested her.





EDITORIAL
DEVELOPMENT
WITH DIALOGUE

Seven years have passed since the Union government revoked Article 370 and reorganised the erstwhile State of Jammu and Kashmir into two Union Territories. Few constitutional decisions in independent India have generated as much debate or carried such profound political, administrative and emotional consequences. On the seventh anniversary of the move, the familiar divide resurfaced. Prime Minister Narendra Modi described the past seven years as a period of “wide-ranging transformation”, pointing to expanded infrastructure, improved connectivity, stronger grass-roots institutions and the extension of Central welfare schemes across Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh. At the same time, regional political parties observed the anniversary as a day of protest, reiterating that the constitutional changes were carried out without the consent of the people and renewing demands for the restoration of statehood and constitutional safeguards. The anniversary, therefore, was not merely about looking back at a constitutional event. It highlighted the continuing challenge of reconciling two competing narratives about Kashmir’s present and future.

There is little doubt that the administrative and developmental landscape of Jammu and Kashmir has undergone visible change since 2019. Road and tunnel projects have improved connectivity to remote regions. Railway expansion has brought the Valley closer to the national transport network. Tourism has witnessed record arrivals in recent years, generating employment for thousands associated with hospitality, transport and local commerce. Several Central welfare programmes that were either partially implemented or unavailable earlier now cover beneficiaries in the region. Investments in education, healthcare, digital governance and local infrastructure have expanded, while Panchayati Raj institutions and urban local bodies have received greater attention. These developments are tangible and deserve acknowledgement because governance is ultimately judged by improvements in the quality of everyday life. Citizens expect better roads, reliable electricity, quality healthcare, educational opportunities and economic prospects regardless of the constitutional framework under which they live.

Yet development alone cannot answer every political question. Constitutional decisions reshape institutions, but public confidence evolves over time. The debate surrounding Article 370 today is no longer confined to legal arguments. The Supreme Court has already upheld the constitutional validity of the abrogation. What remains is a political conversation about representation, identity and democratic participation. The continued protests by regional parties demonstrate that a section of political opinion still seeks greater constitutional and political accommodation. Equally, the participation of people in elections after years of political uncertainty reflects an enduring faith in democratic processes. These are not contradictory realities. Mature democracies often accommodate competing political aspirations within the framework of constitutional institutions. The objective should not be to eliminate disagreement but to ensure that it is expressed peacefully, debated openly and resolved through democratic means.

One of the most significant questions that now remains is the restoration of full statehood. The Union government has repeatedly assured Parliament and the Supreme Court that statehood would be restored at an appropriate stage. Delivering on that commitment would mark an important milestone in the region’s democratic journey. Statehood is not merely an administrative arrangement; it enhances political accountability by placing greater responsibility in the hands of an elected government. It enables local leadership to respond more directly to public concerns while allowing democratic institutions to mature. Strengthening representative governance alongside developmental initiatives would reinforce the confidence that constitutional integration and democratic empowerment are complementary rather than competing objectives.

The region’s future also depends on sustaining the gains achieved in security and economic activity. Years of conflict imposed enormous social and economic costs on Jammu and Kashmir. A more stable security environment has enabled schools to function more regularly, businesses to expand, tourism to flourish and investment discussions to gather momentum. Young people today aspire to employment, entrepreneurship, higher education and global opportunities as much as they seek political participation. Their expectations are shaped increasingly by economic mobility and technological connectivity. Meeting these aspirations requires policies that create jobs, encourage private investment, improve skills and strengthen institutions. Economic progress, however, must be accompanied by continuous engagement with local communities so that development is perceived not as an external project but as a shared enterprise shaped by local participation.

Seven years after Article 370, the debate need not remain trapped between celebration and criticism. The constitutional decision has already become part of India’s legal and political history. The more pressing challenge now is to ensure that its long-term outcomes strengthen both governance and democracy. Lasting stability will depend not only on infrastructure projects or economic indicators but also on trust, institutional responsiveness and inclusive political processes. Jammu and Kashmir’s future should be measured by how effectively it combines peace with prosperity, constitutional certainty with democratic participation, and development with dignity. If the next phase succeeds in deepening these foundations, the anniversary will come to represent not simply a constitutional milestone but the beginning of a more confident and inclusive chapter in the region’s history.

NEXUS
OF GOOD



ANIL SWARUP

THE WRITER IS
AN AUTHOR AND
A FORMER
CIVIL SERVANT

The National Council for School Safety is attempting to shift the focus from reactive compliance to preventive safeguarding

Safety of School Children

As India seeks to strengthen child protection, NCSS is working with schools to build governance frameworks that ensure safeguarding is embedded in everyday functioning

It was an invitation from the National Council for School Safety (NCSS) to discuss my recently released book, *You Can Make It Happen*. I readily accepted. However, what I saw at their office in Noida amazed me. Here was a group of enthusiastic and energetic youngsters, under the inspired leadership of the founder of the organisation, Shikha Agnihotri, attempting to address a serious problem that exists in almost all schools across the country: the safety of children in schools. I spoke a lot, but I learnt a great deal as well.

It all began in 2019, when Shikha sat across from a school principal who had just spent three hours drafting a circular on “student safety” after a parent complaint. The language was strong, the tone was urgent, and every phrase reflected genuine concern. What the circular lacked, however, was an institutional mechanism to prevent a recurrence, investigate a complaint if it escalated, or withstand legal scrutiny if the matter reached a court of law. It was a statement of intent. It was not a system of accountability.

That distinction between intent and institution is the reason the National Council for School Safety (NCSS) was established.

Over the years, Shikha worked with schools across India on child safeguarding, POCSO compliance, institutional investigations and governance. During that time, one pattern remained remarkably consistent. The problem was rarely a lack of intent. School leaders overwhelmingly wanted to create safe environments for children. The gap lay elsewhere: in the absence of a governance framework capable of translating good intentions into consistent, legally defensible practice.

India today has one of the world’s strongest statutory frameworks for child protection. Yet legislation alone cannot safeguard a child. Pol-



NCSS is helping Indian schools build governance systems that strengthen child protection, POCSO compliance and institutional preparedness

icies must be understood, processes rehearsed, responsibilities clearly assigned, and systems tested before a crisis occurs. Too often, compliance in schools remains reactive. POCSO training is commissioned after a widely reported incident. Safeguarding committees exist on paper until they are suddenly required to function. Documentation is prepared to satisfy inspections rather than guide institutional decision-making.

NCSS was established to reverse that approach.

Constituted as an independent Section 8 institution, NCSS works with schools before an incident occurs, helping them build the governance architecture necessary for effective safeguarding. The framework is built around the four pillars of safety—Policy, Process, People and Practice. Together, these four elements create an ecosystem where safeguarding is not dependent on individuals but embedded within the institution itself.

The value of such a framework is measured not by documentation but by outcomes. Through a national personal safety and puberty education initiative delivered within

schools, structured, age-appropriate safety education has reached more than twenty lakh students, replacing silence and misinformation with informed conversations at a stage when children are especially vulnerable. Institutional safeguarding programmes have supported schools in strengthening statutory compliance, establishing legally compliant mechanisms, and building trained Internal Committees capable of responding appropriately when complaints arise. In parallel, safeguarding and POCSO training has equipped more than 8,000 educators, while institutional engagement now extends to over 2,000 schools across more than 40 cities in India.

These numbers matter, but they are not the achievement.

The real measure of progress is whether a school can respond effectively when confronted with a disclosure of abuse, an allegation of misconduct, or a statutory inspection. A certificate issued after a workshop provides little protection when a crisis unfolds. What matters is whether policies exist, escalation pathways are understood, committees know their responsibilities,

documentation is maintained, and leadership can demonstrate that safeguarding has been embedded into everyday institutional practice. Preparedness, not paperwork, is the true indicator of compliance.

This is also why NCSS has deliberately maintained a clear distinction between standards and implementation. As an independent Section 8 institution, its role is to strengthen governance, build institutional capacity, and promote nationally consistent safeguarding standards. Maintaining that separation reinforces credibility, preserves public trust, and ensures that safeguarding remains a matter of institutional accountability rather than commercial certification. In a sector where confidence is built on integrity, governance structures matter as much as the programmes themselves.

The next phase of this work will move the conversation into the public domain. On 19 November, NCSS will convene Conclave 1.0 with the theme Mission Safe Schools in New Delhi, bringing together policymakers, legal experts, educa-

tion leaders, law enforcement agencies, child rights practitioners, and the media. The objective is not simply dialogue but accountability, creating a platform where safeguarding challenges can be examined openly, practical solutions debated, and institutional responsibility strengthened through collective action.

The approach to school safety has always been guided by one simple principle: systems matter most when they are tested under pressure. If a safeguarding framework fails when a child needs protection, it was never truly a system; it was documentation. Every programme NCSS develops is designed against that standard. Policies must function under real conditions. Processes must withstand scrutiny. Institutions must be prepared long before an incident occurs.

India has already built the legal foundation for child protection. The challenge before us is no longer legislation; it is implementation. More than a million schools require practical systems that enable the law to function in classrooms, staff rooms and school leadership offices every single day. That demands governance, capacity building, training, audits and continuous institutional preparedness—not only after a crisis captures public attention, but long before it ever occurs.

Child protection cannot depend upon institutional goodwill alone. It must depend upon institutional capability. India has written the law. The next national imperative is ensuring that every school has the systems, people and processes to translate that law into everyday practice before, not after, a child needs its protection.

What is being done by NCSS is truly remarkable. The model they have put in place presents a wonderful example of the Nexus of Good. It can, and should, be replicated through public-private partnerships.

Views expressed are personal

GROUND
REALITY



DIPANKAR DEY

THE WRITER IS
A PROFESSOR
OF BUSINESS
ADMINISTRATION
WHO PRIMARILY
WRITES ON
POLITICAL
ECONOMY,
GLOBAL TRADE,
AND SUSTAINABLE
DEVELOPMENT

The project highlights the growing tension between infrastructure-led development and the constitutional promise of justice for India’s most vulnerable citizens

Whose Development, Whose Sacrifice?

As thousands of tribal families face displacement under the Ken-Betwa Link Project, questions over rehabilitation, environmental justice and the true cost of development have returned to the spotlight

On July 19, twenty-four hours after activist Sonam Wangchuk was forcibly removed by the Delhi Police from the Jantar Mantar protest site on the 21st day of his indefinite hunger strike, Amit Bhatnagar, a leader of people affected by the Ken-Betwa Link Project (KBLP) and founder of the Jai Kisan Organisation, was forcibly removed from the protest site on the bank of the Barana River in Kupi village, where hundreds of villagers, mostly tribals, had been demonstrating against the Union Government’s ₹44,600 crore Ken-Betwa Link Project (KBLP). Though he had been admitted to the intensive care unit (ICU) of a nearby government hospital by the Madhya Pradesh (M.P.) Police, he continued his protest and, after 18 days of fasting, ended his fast on July 23, when the administration ordered a fresh survey in the project-affected villages. According to the Jai Kisan Organisation, it was also agreed during the discussion that an authorised representative of the organisation would be present in each village during the verification process.

The 77-metre-high Daudhan Dam under the KBLP will displace 5,288 families in Chhatarpur district and 1,400 families in Panna district of Madhya Pradesh due to land submergence and dam-related land acquisition. The indigenous Gond and Kol tribes, who have lived along the forest edges for generations, depending on farming and forest produce for survival, will be displaced. The most shocking aspect of the KBLP is the disparity between the promised and actual compensation. Although the government declared compensation of ₹6 lakh for a 30-40-year-old house and ₹12.5 lakh per acre, the actual situation is very different. It is reported that the administration has offered affected families a cash package of ₹12.5 lakh, and this amount has been deposited for only about 40% of the affected families. The demands for ‘land instead of land’ and ‘village instead of village’, the fundamental principles of just rehabilitation, have apparently been ignored.



The demands for ‘land instead of land’ and ‘village instead of village’ remain central to the rehabilitation debate

On April 8, 2026, local tribal women staged the ‘chita andolan’—a symbolic funeral pyre protest—warning authorities that the conditions they face amid displacement are worse than death itself. Along with the ‘chita andolan’, ‘aamran anshan’ (‘fast unto death’) and the ‘mitti’ and ‘jal’ satyagrahas (protests of the soil and water) were organised. The protesters said they were not opposing development but were demanding that rehabilitation be completed lawfully and transparently before displacement. Their principal allegations include irregularities in compensation, faulty rehabilitation surveys, questionable Gram Sabha proceedings, payments to allegedly ineligible beneficiaries, and incomplete rehabilitation before construction.

Both the Ken and the Betwa are tributaries of the Yamuna, draining the Bundelkhand plateau that straddles Madhya Pradesh and Uttar Pradesh. The Ken-Betwa Link Project (KBLP) is the inaugural undertaking of India’s National Perspective Plan for Interlinking of Rivers, first articulated in 1980 by the Ministry of Irrigation. In 1995, the KBLP was given institutional form through the National Water Development Agency (NWDA) to conduct feasibility studies on inter-basin water transfers. After decades of controversy

and delay, on March 22, 2021, ahead of the Uttar Pradesh Assembly elections, the Union Ministry of Jal Shakti and the Chief Ministers of Madhya Pradesh and Uttar Pradesh signed the Ken-Betwa Link Project agreement in New Delhi, in the presence of Prime Minister Narendra Modi. The foundation stone for the project was later laid by Prime Minister Modi at Khajuraho on December 25, 2024, coinciding with the birth anniversary of former Prime Minister Atal Bihari Vajpayee, under whose tenure the interlinking programme gained political momentum.

The government claims that, once completed in 2030, the project will help irrigate 1.06 million hectares of land, provide drinking water to 6.2 million people, and generate 130 MW of hydro-power and solar energy. However, at least 10 villages will be submerged to build the dam’s reservoir, and 11 more villages will be displaced for constructing the canal, affecting more than 7,000 families. The dam will submerge 5,578 hectares of forest land and split the Panna Tiger Reserve. Nearly 98 square kilometres of the 543-square-kilometre sanctuary under the reserve, which successfully brought tigers back from the brink of local extinction in 2009, will be submerged.

River-linking projects suffer from long-term ecological risks. In 2019, a panel of experts constituted by India’s top court raised concerns about the KBLP, questioning its economic viability and its impact on the region’s wildlife. The panel said the government should explore alternative irrigation methods in the river basin. Independent studies on river-linking projects in India have made similar observations. A 2023 study published in the journal *Nature Communications* stated that such endeavours “may worsen the water stress across the country, making these projects ineffective or possibly even counterproductive”, reports the *BBC*. Alternate suggestions include restoring an estimated one lakh natural water bodies in Bundelkhand, which could provide greater water storage at a lower cost and without displacing thousands of people.

Amid all the development activities, the marginalised indigenous people are the worst sufferers because they have been facing displacement for generations. Various studies reveal that in India, the tribal population, which comprises 8.6% of the total population, constitutes more than 40% of the population displaced by developmental activities.

The KBLP has once again ignited the decades-old debate on development—for whom, and at what cost? The ₹44,600 crore KBLP aims to benefit farmers in Uttar Pradesh by irrigating 2.51 lakh hectares across districts, including Banda, Mahoba, Jhansi and Lalitpur. By contrast, the indigenous Gond and Kol tribes being displaced in the Chhatarpur and Panna districts of Madhya Pradesh are helpless and are not among its beneficiaries. This raises important questions of environmental justice and inter-state fairness. Should the marginalised people of one state bear the environmental and social costs for the irrigation benefits of farmers in another state? Second, how much longer will the indigenous people of India continue to sacrifice their ‘water, forest and land’ for the advancement of the colonisers?

Views expressed are personal

— ANY CONTROL OVER STRAIT WOULD BE MAJOR CONCESSION TO IRAN —

Proposed Hormuz deal expected to give Iran control of inbound traffic

DUBAI/RIYADH: A proposed deal between Iran and Oman would give Tehran control over ships entering the Gulf through the Strait of Hormuz, a senior Iranian source and two regional officials told Reuters on Wednesday.

Despite the apparent step towards yielding to Iranian demands, the sources pushed back against assertions by U.S. President Donald Trump that a deal reopening the strait was imminent, saying important details still had to be agreed.

Trump has said a deal to reopen the Strait of Hormuz could come as early as Wednesday, as Iran and Oman inched toward an agreement on the critical waterway that could ease pressure on the global economy and potentially help bring an end to the war.

The US, along with Israel, launched the war on February 28, citing various goals including toppling Tehran's government and ending its nuclear programme. But the conflict has devolved into a fight over the strait as Iranian threats and attacks on shipping ground traffic through the waterway to a halt.

Closure of the strait, through which a fifth of the world's oil and natural gas once passed, has driven up the price of fuel and basic goods far beyond the region, roiling the global economy. Trump is also under mounting pressure to end an unpopular war



REPRESENTATIONAL IMAGE

ahead of midterm congressional elections.

The US president was asked by reporters travelling with him in California about a report on the Axios news site that an announcement on the Strait of Hormuz could be made on Wednesday.

"It could happen. Tomorrow or the next day," he said,

speaking Tuesday evening California time. "A lot of progress has been made."

Oil prices initially eased on hopes of a deal that would allow shipping to resume but later inched upward. Brent crude, the international standard, was around USD 80 per barrel on Wednesday — still well below the levels it hit at the

Highlights

- » US President says important details still had to be agreed
- » Trump has said a deal to reopen the Strait of Hormuz could come as early as Wednesday
- » However, there was no immediate comment from Saudi Arabia
- » Oil prices initially eased on hopes of a deal that would allow shipping to resume but later inched upward

height of the conflict.

The US and Iran reached a deal to open the strait in June, only for attacks to resume. In recent days, Trump has again alternately threatened massive strikes and voiced support for diplomatic efforts.

Even as hopes increased that a deal on the Strait of Hormuz could be imminent, attacks on shipping in the region continued.

The Iranian-backed Houthis rebels claimed Wednesday they had fired ballistic missiles toward a Saudi oil tanker called the Wafa in the Red Sea. Brig Gen Yahya Saree, a military spokesman for the Houthis, said in a prerecorded statement that the vessel was targeted off the Saudi port city of Yanbu. He didn't provide evidence.

There was no immediate comment from Saudi Arabia.

The attack is part of a recent escalation between the rebels and Saudi Arabia that threatened to reignite Yemen's civil war, which pitted the Houthis against a Saudi-led coalition supporting the country's government.

In July, the Houthis announced they were closing the Bab el-Mandeb Strait that leads to the Red Sea for Saudi-linked shipping.

That puts additional pressure on international shipping since the Red Sea became a key alternative route for Saudi oil exports during the war.

On Tuesday, an Indian-flagged commercial ship sank in the Red Sea off Yemen after being struck by an explosive-laden boat, Yemeni and Indian authorities said. Yemen's coast guard rescued the crew, which included 13 Indians and a Yemeni. There was no immediate claim of responsibility.

Earlier Tuesday, a cargo ship reported being "hit by an unknown projectile" about 37 kilometres northeast of the Omani port city of Al Khasab in the Strait of Hormuz, according to the United Kingdom Maritime Trade Operations Centre.

The possible agreement emerging from talks between Iran and Oman calls for ships to enter the Persian Gulf through an Iranian-controlled route and exit through a route controlled by Oman. AGENCIES

Multiple explosions followed by fire heard in Dubai: Report

DUBAI: Multiple explosions followed by a significant fire were reported along the coast of the United Arab Emirates early Wednesday morning.

Iranian broadcaster Press TV, citing Arabic-language media and regional sources, reported that at least seven blasts were heard within a 20-minute span across the Jebel Ali industrial area in Dubai.

Press TV further reported that video footage depicted massive columns of thick smoke rising from the vicinity of Jebel Ali Port.

However, no individual or organisation has claimed responsibility for the incident, according to Press TV.

Meanwhile, Press TV cited media reports confirming that 'UAE authorities arrest two people for filming the fires' following the outbreak of smoke at the scene.

Situated in southwestern Dubai, Jebel Ali serves as a vital logistics, commercial, and industrial centre for the region.

The area encompasses Jebel Ali Port and the Jebel Ali Free Zone (Jafza), an



international trade hub founded in 1985 that currently houses over 11,000 companies representing more than 150 countries.

Linked to major highways, Jebel Ali Port, and Al Maktoum International Airport, the complex remains a crucial crossroads for global commerce, Press TV reported.

This comes as US President Donald Trump on Tuesday (local time) said that the Strait of Hormuz would be opened "very soon" as part of a deal with Iran and Oman, while warning that the Islamic Republic would be "hit really hard" if it fails to reach an agreement amid talks over an interim arrangement to ease tensions in the region. AGENCIES

Indian expat killed in blast in Dubai

DUBAI: An Indian expatriate from Kerala was killed in a gas cylinder explosion at a car showroom in Dubai, according to a media report. Shijin Paul, 27, from Kerala's Kollam district, died after an explosion on Monday at a car showroom at Sheikh Zayed Road, the Gulf News newspaper reported. The incident comes amid concerns over the safety of Indian workers in the Gulf, where nearly three Indians died every week in workplace accidents between 2023 and 2025, according to Indian government data.

According to the Dubai Media Office, one person was killed and five others were injured in Monday's explosion. AGENCIES

Russian drone factory director badly injured in car explosion

MOSCOW: The director of a factory supplying drones to the Russian military was badly wounded and his driver was killed when the car they were in exploded, news reports said Wednesday.

The state Tass and RIA Novosti agencies said that Vladimir Tkachuk was hospitalised

in grave condition following the explosion late Tuesday in Bolshoy Istok just outside Yekaterinburg, 1,400 km east of Moscow.

There was no immediate comment from the authorities. Tkachuk headed the Uraldronzavod factory that manufactures Upry

(Russian for Ghoul) drones.

Tkachuk, a small-scale entrepreneur, set up a team of engineers that developed the Upry and organized its production near Yekaterinburg, Russia's fourth-largest city and a key industrial hub in the Ural Mountains. AGENCIES

Bodies of climber Purja, 3 others brought to Broad Peak base camp

KATHMANDU: The bodies of veteran Nepalese-British mountaineer Nirmal Purja and three other climbers who were killed in an avalanche on Broad Peak, located in Pakistan-occupied Kashmir's Gilgit-Baltistan, were brought to the mountain's base camp on Wednesday following a challenging recovery operation.

Purja, popularly known as 'Nims Dai', and nine other climbers -- five from Nepal, one Pakistani, one Omani, one American and one Chinese -- were on Thursday last week swept away by the avalanche that struck Broad Peak, located in the Karakoram range near K2. On Saturday, Purja's expedition enterprise -- Elite Exped -- announced that all members of the group had died.

The bodies of Purja, Zhong Wang of China, and Nepali climbers Nima Sherpa and Kilu Sherpa were recovered from the mountain and transported to the base camp, Nepal Mountaineering Association (NMA) vice president Rajendra Bahadur Lama said.

"The mission was led by



Students at Banaras Hindu University (BHU) light candles to pay tribute to the mountaineers lost in the Broad Peak expedition PTI

Mingma G, with the support of Sirbaz Khan and the dedicated ground recovery team, whose courage and professionalism made the operation possible under extremely difficult conditions," he said.

Broad Peak (8,051 metres) is the world's 12th-highest mountain and is considered one of the most challenging peaks to climb.

Recovery operations at such

extreme altitudes are particularly hazardous because of unstable snow conditions, steep terrain and unpredictable weather, often requiring specialised high-altitude rescue teams.

The NMA expressed gratitude to the Pakistan government, the Pakistan Army, the Alpine Club of Pakistan and all others involved in the recovery operation. AGENCIES

'CLEAR ATTACK AGAINST CHRISTIANS' — US Congressman says proposed FCRA Bill could affect India-US ties

WASHINGTON: A US lawmaker has voiced concern over the amendments proposed by India to its laws governing foreign donations received by NGOs, trusts, educational institutions and religious organisations, and said the move could affect bilateral relations.

US Congressman Riley Moore on Tuesday said the amendments to the Foreign Contribution Regulation Act (FCRA) would permit the Indian government to takeover churches and religious charities and would amount to "clear attack against Christians".

"Christians have been in India since St Thomas the Apostle travelled to the Malabar Coast just decades after the resurrection of our Lord Jesus Christ.

But despite this long Christian history, India's Parliament is considering amending Foreign Contribution Regulation Amendment (FCRA) rules

Key Points

- » The proposed legislation also reduces the maximum penalty for violation of the Act from imprisonment of five years to one year
- » The bill also states that in case of assets that are a place of worship, the Authority must ensure that its religious character is maintained

to permit government takeovers of churches and religious charities," Moore, a Republican from West Virginia, said in a post on X.

"This is a clear attack against Christians. If this bill proceeds in this way, it would be a point of major concern in our bilateral relationship with India," said Moore, a first term Congressman.

The Foreign Contribu-

tion (Regulation) Amendment Bill, 2026 seeks to empower the government to create a "Designated Authority" to take over the management of foreign contributions and assets created using foreign contributions when an organisation's FCRA registration is cancelled, surrendered or ceases because it is not renewed.

The bill also states that in case of assets that are a place of worship, the Authority must ensure that its religious character is maintained.

The proposed legislation also reduces the maximum penalty for violation of the Act from imprisonment of five years to one year.

As per the Ministry of Home Affairs, 13,520 organisations received Rs 55,741 crore of foreign contribution between 2019 and 2022.

The FCRA portal indicates that, as of July 15, 2026, there are 14,449 active FCRA certificates, 22,498 cancelled and 15,212 deemed as expired. AGENCIES

Shri Thanedar loses Democrat primary from Michigan

WASHINGTON: Indian-American Congressman Shri Thanedar lost the Democratic primary from Michigan's 13th District to Donavan McKinney, a candidate backed by the socialist leaders of the party.

McKinney, who edged out two-term member Thanedar by a margin of 3.79 per cent, will now be the Democratic nominee from Michigan's 13th District in the November elections to the House of Representatives.

In a closely contested primary, Thanedar polled 48.1 per cent of the votes against McKinney's 51.9 per cent, signalling the rising influence of Democratic Socialists of America (DSA), a left-wing group within the Democratic party. The Associated Press called the race at 9:55 am EDT.

"I want to congratulate Representative Donavan McKinney on a hard-fought race. It was a tough election cycle and, in the end, the voters of the 13th District chose him to represent them moving forward," said Thanedar, conceding the election. AGENCIES

Bangladesh uprising was planned regime change, not peaceful student protest: Hasina

B'desh turns ousted Hasina's residence into museum; observes "July Mass Uprising Day"

NEW DELHI: Former Bangladesh Prime Minister Sheikh Hasina on Wednesday broke her silence on her 2024 deposition, alleging that the July-August unrest "was not a peaceful student movement", but an organised campaign that weaponised quota reform protests into a "violent political instrument" aimed at regime change.

Addressing a virtual media interaction organised by the Foreign Correspondents' Club of South Asia in New Delhi, the former Prime Minister reflected on the turmoil in Bangladesh, expressing anguish over the country's trajectory.

"For the last two years, I watched my beloved Bangladesh suffer... This is not the Bangladesh we built, this is not the Bangladesh for which 3 million people sacrificed their lives in 1971," Hasina said. Directly addressing the mid-2024 protests, Hasina stated that her administration had sought to resolve the quota reform agitation through dialogue, legal measures, and negotiations, but "organised groups" exploited



Bangladesh's ousted prime minister Sheikh Hasina

the movement to pursue political objectives. "Let me begin with the truth about July and August 2024. It was not a peaceful student movement. From the beginning, my government tried to resolve the issue peacefully through dialogue, legal process, and patience.

But behind the language of reform, organised groups were working to turn students demand into violent political instrument," she added.

"The quota reform movement was turned into a one-point demand for my resignation. False propaganda was spread in a planned way. Genu-

ine students were emotionally manipulated, while organised groups used their movement as cover for violence and regime change," Hasina said.

The former prime minister alleged that the demonstrations escalated from July 15, 2024, into widespread killings, arson, attacks on public infrastructure, and violence against law enforcement personnel.

She further claimed that following her removal, Awami League leaders and workers faced systematic political persecution, alleging that thousands had been killed, disappeared, or arrested, with hundreds of

'For the last two years, I watched my beloved Bangladesh suffer... This is not the Bangladesh we built, this is not the country for which 3 million people sacrificed their lives in 1971'

thousands named in criminal cases. She also accused the interim administration led by Muhammad Yunus of halting a judicial inquiry established by her government to investigate the violence.

Detailing the destruction, Hasina alleged that symbols associated with Bangladesh's 1971 Liberation War were vandalised, while members of minority communities and journalists were targeted. She added that the historic Dhanmondi 32 resi-

dence of Sheikh Mujibur Rahman was demolished in what she described as an effort to erase the legacy of the Liberation War. Hasina was making her first media address since fleeing to India on August

5, 2024. Her departure concluded a 15-year tenure in power following the nationwide anti-government movement that commenced in June 2024. Ahead of the address, the Indian government sought to distance itself from the press event, clarifying that New Delhi does not endorse any statements made during the session. Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal stated, "The government has no involvement whatsoever in it. Neither does it endorse any views that may be expressed at the forum."

The ministry recently informed a Parliamentary committee that while granting asylum to Hasina, India has strictly maintained its policy ensuring no political activity targeting another sovereign nation is conducted from Indian territory. AGENCIES

World Briefs

DRONE WITH EXPLOSIVE DEVICE FOUND AT GERMAN AIRPORT

BERLIN: A drone with an explosive device was found at Germany's Leipzig/Halle Airport and a detonator was removed from the object, authorities said Wednesday. Both the airport's runways were closed and several flights, including one passenger plane, were diverted to other airports after a flying object was sighted nearby shortly before midnight, police said, and an anti-explosives robot was deployed to check an object near the south runway. A statement later Wednesday from Saxony's state criminal police office and prosecutors in the state capital of Dresden said that an airport employee discovered a drone near the airport's south runway with "an unknown explosive device," and the object was examined by police.

IMRAN KHAN'S SUPPORTERS STAGE PROTESTS ACROSS PAKISTAN

LAHORE: More than 100 supporters of jailed former prime minister Imran Khan were arrested on Wednesday as rallies were held across Pakistan to mark the completion of three years of his imprisonment, with police cracking down on protesters in Punjab and Sindh provinces. The main rally was held in Peshawar, the capital of Khyber Pakhtunkhwa province, where Khan's Pakistan Tehreek-i-Insaf (PTI) party is in power. In Punjab, police baton-charged protesters and arrested scores of PTI workers in Lahore, Mianwali and Rawalpindi. In Lahore's Mall Road, police detained several demonstrators.

INFLATION PROJECTION LOWERED TO 5%

RBI marginally raises FY27 GDP growth forecast to 6.7%

MPOST BUREAU

MUMBAI: The Reserve Bank of India on Wednesday marginally raised the GDP forecast for the current fiscal to 6.7 per cent while slightly lowering the inflation projection to 5 per cent.

In the August bi-monthly monetary policy announced Wednesday, the central bank also cautioned that the turbulent global economic environment is likely to have some bearing on domestic economic activity. In the June policy, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) had projected the GDP growth for fiscal 2026-27 at 6.6 per cent and inflation at 5.1 per cent.

Although generalised inflation pressures continue to remain modest so far, the risks of higher food, fuel and other input prices translating into a broad-based increase in inflation persist, it said.

Announcing the decision of the Monetary Policy Committee, RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra said the supply-side



REPRESENTATIVE PIC

HIGHLIGHTS

- » The RBI cautioned that the turbulent global economic environment is likely to have some bearing on domestic economic activity
- » The real GDP growth for 2026-27 is projected at 6.7 per cent, with Q1 at 7.0 per cent; Q2 at 6.4 per cent; Q3 at 6.5 per cent; & Q4 at 6.8 per cent

pressures caused by the West Asia conflict have eased somewhat since June 2026, leading to withdrawal of temporary measures undertaken by the government and normalisation of key input supplies. "However, the re-escalation of the conflict since the first week of July has amplified volatility in energy prices and renewed uncertainty about supply chains," he said.

Amidst persistent global uncertainty, domestic economic activity has exhibited resilience as reflected by the high frequency indicators available for Q1:2026-27, he said. The real GDP growth for 2026-27 is projected at 6.7 per cent,

with Q1 at 7.0 per cent; Q2 at 6.4 per cent; Q3 at 6.5 per cent; and Q4 at 6.8 per cent, Malhotra said, adding that the risks are evenly balanced.

On inflation, he said the impact of El Nino on temporal and spatial rainfall distribution continues to remain a major risk, although proactive supply management and adequate stock of food grains should provide comfort.

Global oil prices have remained highly volatile with sharp two-way movements triggered by geopolitical developments, blurring the near-term outlook. "Although generalised inflation pressures

continue to remain modest so far, the risks of second-round impact of higher food, fuel and other input prices translating to broad-based inflation persist," the Governor added.

He said the Consumer Price Index (CPI) inflation for 2026-27 is projected at 5 per cent with Q2 at 4.7 per cent; Q3 at 5.9 per cent; and Q4 at 5.5 per cent. Inflation for Q1:2027-28 is projected at 5.3 per cent with risks being evenly balanced. Core inflation is projected at 4.3 per cent for 2026-27. Core inflation, excluding precious metals, is projected to be lower, though it is likely to align with core inflation from Q4.

Rural economy has become more resilient: RBI Governor

MPOST BUREAU

MUMBAI: RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra on Wednesday said the rural economy and the agriculture sector have become more resilient over the years, helped by the growth of allied activities, improved irrigation, farm mechanisation and better crop varieties, which have reduced the impact of rainfall deficiencies.

"I think Indian economy, especially the agriculture sector, has demonstrated great resilience. The monsoon is still evolving... but it has been very resilient because of various measures... that the government has taken," Malhotra said during the post-monetary policy press conference.

He added that allied activities have helped rural households cushion income losses when agriculture faces stress.

"We have seen that if agriculture is not doing well, then the allied activities do better. The households are able to themselves adjust their own activities to generate income and offset some of the loss in incomes that we have seen," he said.

RBI Deputy Governor Poo-



RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra addresses a press conference on the Post-Monetary Policy, in Mumbai, Wednesday

PTI

nam Gupta said data over the last 15 years show that the resilience of the rural economy has strengthened in multiple ways.

"We have seen that the overall economy has become very resilient, and that resilience extends to different sectors, particularly the agriculture sector and the rural economy," he said.

Gupta said agriculture and allied sectors have increasingly complemented each other, while a larger share of irrigated land has made the sector less vulnerable to rainfall deficiencies.

"If you look at some of the

measures by the government, the share of area that is irrigated now is much larger, and it's a secular increase, which means though the rainfall deficiency and vagaries matter, they matter less than they used to in the past," she said.

She added that access to farm credit, mechanisation and improvements in crop and seed varieties have also strengthened the sector. "All in all, all of these measures indicate towards a well-doing rural economy and a very resilient agriculture sector," she added.

On the monetary policy, Malhotra said the RBI's decisions are guided by prevailing growth and inflation conditions rather than any "dovish" or "hawkish" bias. "We are neither dovish nor are we hawkish. We feel that this is the right policy rate for the given growth-inflation dynamics that we are in today," he said.

The Governor reiterated that the RBI's inflation target remains headline inflation. "Our target is headline. It is the headline inflation which is the target which has been given to us, and we'll continue to be guided by the headline inflation," he said.

'RBI targeting polymer currency notes launch in early FY28'

MPOST BUREAU

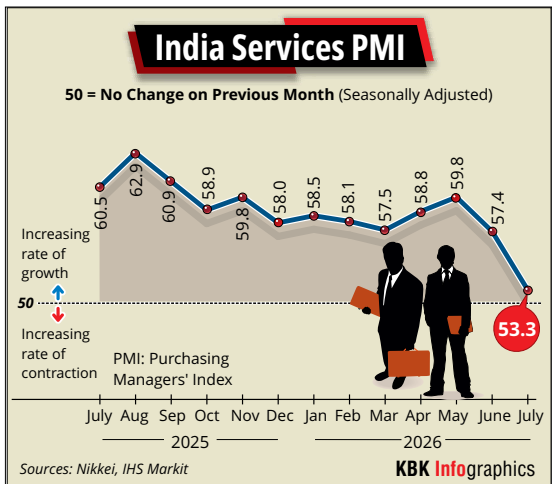
MUMBAI: Governor Sanjay Malhotra on Wednesday said the Reserve Bank of India is targeting to launch long-lasting polymer currency notes at the beginning of the next financial year.

Speaking to reporters at the customary briefing after the monetary policy review, Malhotra said the polymer currency notes have lasted for over 30 years in some jurisdictions and will come in handy, especially for the lower denomination notes which have high velocity.

"We are targeting that they are in circulation, if everything goes as per plan, in the beginning of the next financial year," Malhotra said.

He said the next move of the RBI on the crucial aspect of interest rates and also the stance of the policy will be data-dependent, and underlined that the prime focus of the central bank is to align the headline inflation with its target of 4 per cent over the medium term.

Services PMI hits 4.5-year low in July



NEW DELHI: India's services sector growth fell to a four-and-a-half-year low in July as new business orders eased in both domestic and export markets, constrained by fierce competition and fading demand, a monthly survey said on Wednesday.

Business activity rose at the weakest rate in 53 months, as new business inflows increased moderately amid reports of softer demand and competitive pressures. The seasonally adjusted HSBC India Services PMI Business Activity Index fell from 57.4 in June to 53.3 in July, registering the weakest growth rate in close to four-and-a-half years.

The seasonally adjusted HSBC India Services PMI Business Activity Index – based on a single question

asking how the level of business activity compares with the situation the month before – remained above the neutral mark of 50 and therefore signalled another expansion in output.

"India's services sector continued to expand in July, albeit at a slightly slower pace, as new business growth eased in both domestic and export markets after several months of strong performance," said Pranjal Bhandari, Chief India Economist at HSBC. New business inflows expanded at a moderate pace, the slowest since February 2022.

According to panel members, growth was constrained by fierce competition, fading demand, softer market conditions and order postponements.

Keventer Group CMD welcomes RBI's steady policy stance



NEW DELHI: Keventer Group Chairman and Managing Director Manoj Kumar on Wednesday said the Reserve Bank of India's decision to keep the repo rate unchanged at 5.25 per cent reflects a balanced approach to supporting economic growth while keeping inflation in check amid global uncertainty.

He said policy continuity provides much-needed predictability for the real estate sector, enabling developers, lenders and investors to take informed long-term decisions on investment, financing and capital deployment. Kumar noted that the sector continues to benefit from robust domestic consumption, sustained infrastructure development and steady credit availability.

He added that stable borrowing costs ahead of the festive season are expected to strengthen homebuyer confidence and sustain residential demand, while predictable policy will support disciplined expansion and long-term value creation in the sector.

Sensex closes 152 points higher

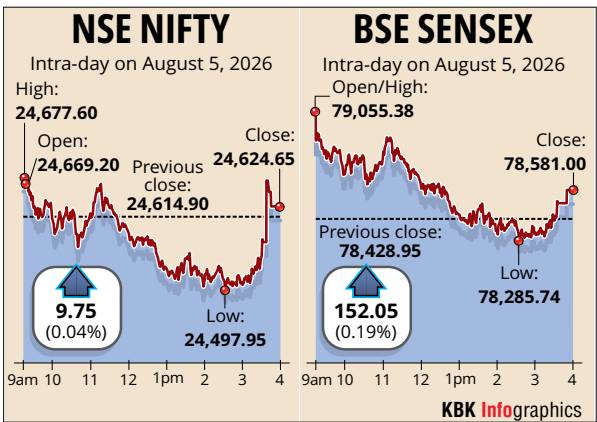
MPOST BUREAU

MUMBAI: Benchmark BSE Sensex closed higher by 152 points in a volatile session on Wednesday after the Reserve Bank of India kept its key policy rates unchanged for the fourth consecutive time.

The 30-share BSE Sensex rose by 152.05 points, or 0.19 per cent, to end at 78,581 with 17 of its constituents closing with gains, 12 with losses and one unchanged.

The index opened higher and hit a day's high of 79,055.38 in the first half of the session. However, the index slipped into the red in the late afternoon session, hitting a low of 78,285.74 by losing 769.64 points.

Gains in blue-chip banking, auto and capital goods shares in the pre-close session helped the barometer recover from losses. UltraTech Cement, NTPC, State Bank of India, Mahindra & Mahindra, InterGlobe Aviation



and Kotak Mahindra Bank were among the major winners in the Sensex pack.

Tata Consultancy Services, HCL Tech, Reliance Industries and Bharat Electronics were among the laggards.

The 50-share NSE Nifty edged up 9.75 points, or 0.04 per cent, to end at 24,624.65. It hit a high of 24,677.60 and a low of 24,497.95 during intra-day trade.

Broader markets also advanced as the BSE SmallCap Select index climbed 0.73 per cent and MidCap Select index went up by 0.45 per cent.

Foreign Institutional Investors (FIIs) bought equities worth Rs 2,446.47 crore on Tuesday, according to exchange data.

Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, climbed 1.75 per cent to USD 80.75 per barrel.

SIAM withdraws letter to govt on E2o fuel contamination

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: Auto industry body Society of Indian Automobile Manufacturers has withdrawn a letter written to the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas that had flagged concerns over contamination of E20 fuel that caused problems with vehicles citing the need for further authentication.

In a statement, Society of Indian Automobile Manufacturers (SIAM) said the "communication in question" was part of routine and ongoing

technical deliberations that take place between various stakeholders, including industry bodies, oil marketing companies, auto OEMs (Original Equipment Manufacturers) and testing agencies.

"Some numbers quoted in the communication need authentication through collection of elaborate data from various regions across the country followed by a comprehensive consultation with our member OEMs," it said.

It further said, "The referred numbers reported in the media

It said some numbers quoted in the communication need authentication

need authentication as mentioned above and therefore SIAM is withdrawing its earlier communication."

According to reports, in the now withdrawn letter, SIAM had noted that investigations revealed that there was corrosion or wear caused by high chloride presence traced to

the fuel used in vehicles that suffered issues with E20 fuel, while highlighting the highly detrimental effect of chloride to engine parts.

Besides, SIAM members had also flagged excessive moisture contents in E20 fuel dispensed at retail outlets stating that high moisture above 1 per cent causes separation of fuel and "paralyses the vehicle immediately after fuelling".

It had also stressed on the need for proper maintenance of storage tanks and pipelines at fuel retail outlets.

In its statement, SIAM said, "MoPNG (Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas) has also instituted 3 ppm guidelines for chloride/sulphur as a precautionary measure for all ethanol being blended into the petrol supply chain. All of these steps fully meet the needs of the automobile industry.

Further, it said, "We understand from OMCs that checks have been instituted, including water ingress testing about 8-12 times a day at over 87,000 outlets & after each instance of rain near petrol pumps."

Repco Bank pays ₹22.90 cr dividend to Centre

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: Union Home and Cooperation minister Amit Shah on Wednesday received a dividend cheque of Rs 22.90 crore from Repco Bank on behalf of the Central government, representing its share of the bank's profit for the financial year 2025-26.

The cheque was presented by Repco Bank Chairman E. Santhanam, Director and Repco Home Finance Ltd Chairman C. Thangaraju, and Managing Director O.M. Gokul in New Delhi.

Congratulating the bank on X, Shah lauded its management and staff for posting a record net profit of Rs 169 crore in FY26, describing it as the cooperative bank's best-ever performance.

The Union Home and Cooperation minister said the bank's professionalism and strong performance had benefited customers significantly and wished the institution continued success and prosperity in the years ahead.

Pawan Hans & Noemi Aerospace ink pact to explore next-gen tech

NARESH BISWANI

NEW DELHI: State-owned Pawan Hans Limited (PHL) on Wednesday signed a non-binding Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with Norway-based Noemi Aerospace (Elfly AS) to collaborate on next-generation sustainable aviation technologies, including electric seaplanes, in a move aimed at advancing India's green aviation ambitions.

The MoU was signed in the presence of Civil Aviation Minister Ram Mohan Naidu Kinjarapu and Civil Aviation Secretary Samir Kumar Sinha. The agreement was signed by Pawan Hans Chairman and Managing Director Sunil Kumar Nagdawe and Noemi Aerospace Chief Executive Officer Eric Francois Lithun.

Under the partnership, both organisations will explore cooperation in electric seaplane technology, human capacity building, knowledge management, workshops and feasibility studies.

The Civil Aviation Minister said the collaboration reflects



the government's commitment to strengthening domestic manufacturing while bringing cutting-edge technology to the country's civil aviation sector.

He said the government's objective is not only to introduce seaplane operations across India but also to manufacture seaplanes under the Make in India initiative. The Union Budget 2026 announced several incentives to promote indigenous seaplane manufacturing and also proposed a Seaplane Viability Gap Funding Scheme to accelerate commercial seaplane operations.

Noemi Aerospace, headquartered in Bergen, Norway, is a private aircraft manufacturer and lessor that is developing next-generation electric seaplanes with support from the Norwegian government.

Google emerges as India's 'most attractive' employer

Tata Group, Amazon, Samsung among top 10 brands

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: Google has emerged as India's most attractive employer brand, as revealed by the Randstad Employer Brand Research (REBR) 2026, followed by Tata Group and Amazon, according to findings of the Randstad Employer Brand Research (REBR) 2026 released on Wednesday.

The REBR 2026, which draws on insights from over 1.75 lakh respondents across 34 markets and close to 3,500 respondents in India, noted that 46 per cent of Indian talent plan to change jobs in the next six months, while 32 per cent changed their employer in the last six months.

The other companies that feature in the top 10 most attractive employer brands in India in REBR 2026 include -- Samsung India at the 4th position, Infosys (5th), Reliance Industries (6th), ITC Group (7th), Hindustan Unilever (8th), Mahindra & Mahindra (9th) and Dell Technologies

REBR 2026

- » The other companies that feature in the top 10 include -- Infosys (5th), Reliance Industries (6th), ITC Group (7th), Hindustan Unilever (8th), Mahindra & Mahindra (9th) and Dell Technologies Ltd (10th)
- » The findings of Randstad Employer Brand Research were released on Wednesday

Ltd (10th). As per the survey, work-life balance, equal opportunities, career progression, salary and benefits, and a very good reputation form the core Employee Value Proposition drivers for Indian workforce.

"With nearly half of the workforce contemplating a career move over the next six months, enterprise resilience depends on looking far beyond surface-level benefits. While many employees have made substantial progress, tal-

ent expectations are expanding faster than organisational structures can adapt," Narayan Iyer, MD, Randstad India, said. Iyer further noted that as India continues to attract global investment and expand its economic footprint, organisations that actively re-think their talent strategies will lead the market in talent attraction and retention.

"Ultimately, the future belongs to employers who master the art of making growth, flexibility, fairness, purpose, and reward coexist, rather than compete," he said.

This year's findings reveal that India's workforce is entering what can be described as the era of the "Balanced Employer" - organisations that can simultaneously deliver meaningful work, career growth, inclusivity, wellbeing, flexibility and competitive rewards.

The survey further noted that performance recognition and career continuity, alongside reliable pay and benefits, are the strongest foundations of job security in India.

Tewolde Gebremariam is Air India's new CEO

NEW DELHI/MUMBAI: Air India on Wednesday appointed former Ethiopian Airlines Group chief Tewolde Gebremariam as the Chief Executive Officer and Managing Director, marking another change of guard at the airline after the takeover by the Tata Group four years ago.

An Ethiopian national, Gebremariam will replace New Zealander Campbell Wilson, who announced his resignation from the loss-making airline in April this year. While announcing the appointment, Air India said Gebremariam is widely recognised as one of the most successful aviation chief executives.

The executive transition marks a pivotal juncture in the airline's transformation journey to become a world-class, leading global airline, the airline said in a release. Gebremariam, who will be the second foreign CEO at Air India, will be taking over the reins at a time when the airline is working on its ambitious expansion plans amid multiple external headwinds.

"During his decade-plus tenure as CEO of Ethiopian Airlines Group, he spearheaded a multi-billion-dollar expansion, transforming a regional carrier into Africa's largest, most profitable, and decorated airline group -- growing revenue by more than fourfold and fleet size nearly three-fold," Air India said in a release. According to the release, his unique strength lies in managing complex operational landscapes, driving cultural transformation, building competitive global hubs, and developing world-class MRO (Maintenance, Repair, and Overhaul) and aviation training infrastructure.

Tata Sons and Air India Chairman N Chandrababhan said that having completed the initial phase of stabilisation, integration, and fleet commitments under Campbell's guidance, the airline is now entering a critical execution and expansion era. "Tewolde's track record in building one of the world's most efficient and profitable airline groups makes him uniquely suited to lead Air India," he said.

Gebremariam is former chief of Ethiopian Airlines

sion, transforming a regional carrier into Africa's largest, most profitable, and decorated airline group -- growing revenue by more than fourfold and fleet size nearly three-fold," Air India said in a release.

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Testing times

'Last 10 months tested me in ways I never expected', claims Neeraj

NEW DELHI: Opening about the fitness issues that he has been battling for close to a year, Indian javelin throw ace Neeraj Chopra said the last 10 months have tested him in ways that he never expected.

The 28-year-old two-time Olympic medallist, who added a Commonwealth Games silver to his crowded cabinet last week, was primarily hampered by an adductor muscle injury and a few other niggles along with it.

His start to the season was delayed but he managed to find his rhythm at the CWG in Glasgow with a season's best of 85.83m.

"There are throws that travel far, and then there are moments that carry the weight of an entire journey. The past 10 months has tested me in ways I never expected," he posted on Instagram on Tuesday alongside a short clip of his CWG performance. "Recovering from multiple injuries, rebuilding my body, finding my rhythm again, and learning to be patient when all I wanted was to compete. I was training every day without knowing if I will even have a season to compete this year," he revealed.

Chopra, who won gold in the 2018 Games in Gold Coast in Australia with a throw of



Neeraj Chopra's next stop is the Lausanne Diamond League

PTI

86.47m, missed the 2022 edition due to an injury. He sustained a lower back injury just before the World Championships in September last year and he had competed in just one event before the CWG.

At the Games, Chopra was

bested by current world leader Ramesh Tharanga Pathirage of Sri Lanka (89.75m) amid difficult windy conditions. The former world champion expressed his gratitude towards his support staff for helping him make a comeback.

Gavit aims to set world records in 100m & 400m

NEW DELHI: After setting a record en route to winning the 100m gold medal on his Commonwealth Games debut in Glasgow, para athlete Dilip Gavit is aiming even higher -- he now hopes to break world records in both the 100m and 400m events at the upcoming Para Asian Games in Japan.

"I want to set world records in the 100m and 400m at the Asian Games. At the 2022 Asian Games in Hangzhou, I won gold in the 400m. It was my first time competing in the 100m at the Commonwealth Games in Glasgow, and I won the gold medal with a Games record," said Gavit, who competes in the T47 category, on the sidelines of a felicitation ceremony organised by Sports

Minister Mansukh Mandaviya to honour para athletes who won medals at the CWG.

"I want to run 10.28 seconds (close to India's able-bodied national record). Earlier, I competed in able-bodied events. I won gold medals at the national level among able-bodied athletes and at the Khelo India Games. Back then, I mainly competed in the 400m," he said.

The T47 category is for athletes with upper limb impairments, including unilateral arm amputation or reduced function in one arm, which can affect balance, coordination and running mechanics.

Gavit felt that the competition at the Asian Games would be much tougher. AGENCIES

"To be back competing at this level feels good. None of this would have been possible on my own. I'm deeply grateful for the people who never stopped believing in me. My physio, Ishaan (Marwaha) ji who has been by my side every step of the recovery, helping me

get back to doing what I love.

"My coach, Jai (Chaudhary), who has been with me since the very first time I picked up a javelin. My family, that always stand strong with me no matter what the circumstances are. The season continues, one step at a time," he said. AGENCIES

Ayush faces Shi Yuqi; Sindhu, Lakshya handed easy openers

NEW DELHI: Top Indian shuttlers were on Wednesday handed a mixed draw for the BWF World Championships here with Asian Championships silver medallist Ayush Shetty facing the toughest opening round test against defending champion Shi Yuqi of China, while PV Sindhu and Lakshya Sen received relatively favourable starts.

India is hosting the World Championships for the first time in 17 years, with the event to be held at the Indira Gandhi Indoor Stadium from August 17 to 23. Sindhu's quest for an unprecedented sixth medal will begin against world No. 141 Sophia Nobel of Ireland, while 2021 World Championships bronze medallist Lakshya

will take on Austria's Collins Valentine Filimon. Should he progress, Lakshya is likely to face second seed Kunlavut Vitidsarn of Thailand in the pre-quarterfinals.

Sindhu has managed to avoid the likes of world number one An Se Young of South Korea and defending champion Akane Yamaguchi of Japan before the medal rounds. Though placed in the same half as Young, Sindhu is likely to meet China's third seed Wang Zhi Yi in the pre-quarterfinals with a possible last eight clash against sixth seed Putri Wardani of Indonesia.

In men's doubles, Satwiksairaj Rankireddy and Chirag Shetty received a first-round bye being a seeded pair. AGENCIES

Tan worried over Satwik's shoulder ahead of World Championships

NEW DELHI: India's men's doubles coach Tan Kim Her on Tuesday said Satwiksairaj Rankireddy's recurring shoulder injury remains the biggest concern ahead of the BWF World Championships, even as he backed the former world No. 1 pair to challenge for the title if they remain mentally strong.

Satwik and Chirag, bronze medallists at the 2022 and 2025 World Championships, head into this year's edition after missing a few tournaments because of Satwik's shoulder injury. The Asian Games gold medallists, who returned to winning ways with the Singapore Open Super 750 title in June, have received a first-round bye as one of the seeded combinations.

"His shoulder is almost fully recovered now. He is ready



now," Tan told a select group of reporters on the sidelines of the draw ceremony for the World Championships, which begin here on August 17.

"He has gone under rehab. I think now he is improving a lot. Of course, the rehab is still there but he is getting much better. Chirag is fully 100 per cent fit."

However, the Malaysian coach admitted that Satwik's

shoulder, which has troubled him since suffering a tear several years ago, continues to be a worry. Last year they had 8 semifinals and 2 finals. I think the results were quite consistent. And this year, Singapore has been the best tournament. Game-wise they are getting better now. Confidence? Okay. But what's bothering them is the injury. That's what's bothering me." AGENCIES

LAXMAN TIPPED TO REPLACE AGARKAR

Change at top? Rohit row leaves Agarkar on shaky Ground

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Ajit Agarkar's tenure as chairman of the BCCI selection committee could end as early as next month, with reports suggesting the board is considering appointing VVS Laxman, the current head of the National Cricket Academy's Centre of Excellence in Bengaluru, as his successor.

Agarkar's contract was due to expire in June 2026 but was extended by three months. He was widely expected to receive another extension that would have kept him in the role until the 2027 ODI World Cup.

However, recent developments surrounding Rohit Sharma's ODI future have reportedly complicated matters.

According to a *Dainik Jagran* report, the Agarkar-led selection panel had discussed with head coach Gautam Gambhir and the team management the possibility of moving on from Rohit after the three-match ODI series against England.

Speculation intensified when reports claimed that the third ODI at Lord's would be Rohit's farewell appearance.

The veteran opener, however, responded with a century in the match, leaving both the selectors and team management in



Ajit Agarkar may be on his way out soon

PTI

Reports have also claimed that sections of the team management are not in favour of Rohit continuing until the ODI World Cup

an awkward position.

Soon after the reports surfaced, BCCI secretary Devajit Saikia publicly dismissed suggestions of Rohit's retirement, saying the India captain would continue to feature in the ODI side as long as he remained part of the team's plans.

"Rohit is a regular member

of the Indian ODI team, and he will continue to represent the country as long as he is in the scheme of things. In other words, the Lord's ODI won't be his last match," Saikia told PTI.

Reports have also claimed that sections of the team management are not in favour of Rohit continuing until the 2027 ODI World Cup.

Meanwhile, the BCCI is yet to hold its review meeting following India's disappointing run of eight defeats in 10 matches across the Ireland and England tours. The meeting was scheduled after the England series, but the squad has already left for Sri Lanka for a two-Test series without the review taking place.

FIH HOCKEY WORLD CUP

Accidental goalkeeper Mohith ready for WC run



Mohith HS has emerged as preferred choice in the goal

HI

NEW DELHI: At 24 years of age, accidental goalkeeper Mohith HS of Karnataka is set to realise his lifelong dream of representing India at the FIH Hockey World Cup, which will be jointly hosted by the Netherlands and Belgium from August 15 to 30.

Alongside the experienced Suraj Karkera, Mohith is one of the two goalkeepers in the Indian team, marking another significant milestone in his remarkable journey.

While Mohith may not have the same level of international experience as Suraj, the young custodian has impressed consistently in recent months, particularly during the final leg of the FIH Pro League season, where his performances reinforced the selectors' faith in his abilities.

Ironically, Mohith's hockey journey began by chance. He was drafted into his school's hockey team because there was no goalkeeper available, and his coach believed his height would be an advantage between the posts. What started as an unexpected opportunity soon evolved into a promising career. Since then, Mohith has represented India at the Junior World Cup before earning his senior national call-up, steadily

What started as an unexpected opportunity soon evolved into a promising career

progressing through the ranks.

"I always had a mindset to represent India in major tournaments because when I played in the Junior World Cup, we were not able to finish on the podium; we ended up fourth. So, from that time, it was my dream to do something big for India," Mohith said in a Hockey India release.

Mohith also acknowledged the learnings from legendary goalkeeper PR Sreejesh, who is an inspiration for the next generation of Indian custodians.

"We have learnt a lot from him (Sreejesh). But it's not that we are under pressure to fill those shoes because he has done so well for India. We will give 100 per cent on the ground, and then we will see what happens," said Mohith. India head into the FIH World Cup with renewed confidence following an encouraging finish to their recent Pro League campaign. AGENCIES

Salah arrives in Istanbul ahead of Trabzonspor move

MANCHESTER: Mohamed Salah was greeted by cheering Trabzonspor fans in Istanbul on Wednesday as he closed in on a move to the Turkish club.

The Liverpool icon wore the team's blue and burgundy striped shirt after flying in on a private jet to complete the deal. Earlier he was filmed aboard the jet pulling on his new jersey.

"Trabzon are you ready? I can hear you. See you very soon," Salah said in a video message posted on the club's official X channel.

Turkish TV showed still images of Salah wearing a shirt with No. 61 on it as he arrived in Istanbul, where hundreds of chanting fans waited to greet

him. NTV also broadcast the Egyptian signing a Trabzon shirt and said his official signing ceremony would be held Thursday in the Black Sea city. Salah is a free agent after leaving Liverpool at the end of last season.

There was speculation the 34-year-old Egypt international would end his career in Saudi Arabia, but it emerged this week that Trabzonspor was leading the race to sign him. "We've started transfer talks with Mohamed Salah, he's coming to Istanbul!" the club said.

The official announcement of negotiations to the Istanbul stock market saw Trabzonspor shares rise 6.5%. AGENCIES

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tender Notice no. MECH-ONF-PRYJ-FSA-26 Date: 04.08.2026

E-TENDER NOTICE

For & on behalf of President of India, Sr. Divisional Mechanical Engineer (O&F), North Central Railway, Prayagraj invites OPEN E-Tender in prescribed forms, from reputed contractors with adequate experience and financial capability for the under mentioned work up to 15:00 Hrs. of Date of closing of tender-

SN: 1|E-Tender Notice no. MECH-ONF-PRYJ-FSA-26

Name of work: Fire Safety Audit of NSG-II & NSG-III Railway Stations of Prayagraj Division.

Tender system: Single packet system Tender Value: ₹ 2855749.99

Bid Security: ₹ 57200 Cost of E-tender Form: NIL

Period of Work: 60 days Date of publishing on IREPS website: 04.08.2026

Date of closing of tender: 25.08.2026 at 15:00

Note: 1. The complete information along with tender booklet of above E-Tender will be available since Date of publishing on IREPS website. 2. The online E-Tender can be submitted online only on the IREPS website up to 15:00 hrs on the due date of Tender closing. 3. Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above tenders. 4. Minimum Eligibility Criteria: NOT APPLICABLE IN THIS TENDER. 5. In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the website of IREPS may be approached. 1795/26(AK)

North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

Government of Maharashtra

Directorate of Sports and Youth Services, Maharashtra State

Notice For E-Tender

Request for Proposal for Hiring of an Agency to Provide Sports Nutrition Supplements for Athletes under Mission Lakshyavedh Scheme. (Third Time)

Directorate of Sports and Youth Services, Maharashtra State, Pune is inviting Request For Proposals from interested Manufacturer through e-tender for Hiring of an Agency to Provide Sports Nutrition Supplements for Athletes under Mission Lakshyavedh at Shiv Chhatrapati Sports Complex, Mahalunge-Balewadi, Pune For the detailed Tender document, interested bidders should visit <http://mahatenders.gov.in> Tender submission would be online and the last date for submission of the proposals is 27th August 2026 up to 04.00 PM -sd-

(Dipak Singla) I.A.S. Commissioner Sports & Youth Services Maharashtra State

Dgipr/2118/2026-27

New Okhla Industrial Development Authority

MAIN ADMINISTRATIVE BUILDING, SECTOR-96, NOIDA, G.B. NAGAR (U.P.) Website : www.noidaauthorityonline.com

E-TENDER NOTICE

E-Tenders are invited from eligible firms/contractors for the following job against which bids can be uploaded and same shall be opened/downloaded as per schedule mentioned. The details and conditions of all tenders are available on Noida Authority's official website: www.noidaauthorityonline.com & <http://etender.up.nic.in> Please ensure to see these websites for any changes/amendments & corrigendum etc.

A) (Rs. 1.00 Lacs to 30.00 Lacs)

S. No.	Job No.	Sale Start Date	Sale End Date	Tender Opening Date and Time
1	Job No.-06/E-TENDER/SPO/2026-27 Name of Work -Procurement of winter uniform fabric Estimated Cost Rs. 19,19,522.00	06.08.2026	13.08.2026 upto 5:00 P.M.	14.08.2026 11:00A.M.

Office : Sector-39 Store Purchase Officer, NOIDA

CLEAN, GREEN, SAFE & SECURE NOIDA

JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE

DISTRICT PO (O), 0191-254780 (F), email-sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in

SDPO City East, Jammu has intimated that on 01.08.2026 one un-known male infant (New born) was found dead under suspicious circumstances at SMGS Hospital, Jammu Since, the death of the new born occurred in suspicious circumstances and to ascertain the actual cause of death, Inquest proceedings U/S 194 BNSS initiated at P/S Bahu Fort vide DDR No.22 dated 01.08.2026 and enquiry thereof started. During enquiry, E/O shifted the dead body of the infant to GMCH Jammu for identification.

For identification of said dead body wide publicity is required to be published on daily newspapers for identification / Public in general, having any clue related to the dead body. If any missing report is lodged, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact/Telephone numbers.

Description Roll-
Age : 2/3 months (Approx.)

Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-
1.DPO, Jammu : 0191-2547807, 0191-2561578
2. SSP Jammu Mail I.D : sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
3. PCR Jammu : 0191-2542000
4. SP City South : 0191-2430002
5. SDPO City East : 01912474700
6. SHO P/S Bahu Fort : 0191-2475133

Sd/-
Sr. Superintendent of Police, Jammu.

DIP No:DIP/J-7422/26

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

(See Section 82 Cr. PC/ 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Sunny Sharma S/o Rakesh Sharma R/o H.No. Waseem Ka Makaan Near Prakash Marble Paabi Pusta Pooja Colony, Loni Gzb** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 08/20 U/s 307 IPC/027/54/59 A.Act at PS: Karawal Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Sunny Sharma** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Sunny Sharma** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Sunny Sharma** of **FIR No. 08/20 U/s 307 IPC/027/54/59 A. Act of PS: Karawal Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **10.09.2026**.

Puneet Pahwa
Special Judge (NDPS)
Additional Session Judge
North East Room No.63, 4th Floor
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/10778/NE/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C./84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Parkasho, W/o Sh. Ajeet, R/o RZA-63, Saiyed Nangloi, Delhi-110087** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **Ct. Cases/864/2023, U/s 135 Electricity Act, PS Paschim Vihar West, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Parkasho** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Parkasho** has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Parkasho** accused of **Ct. Cases/864/2023, U/s 135 Electricity Act, PS Paschim Vihar West, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **30.09.2026**.

By Order- **Sh. Rakesh Kumar- IV ASJ/Electricity Court-01, (Center) Court No. 409 DP/10695/OD/2026**
Tis Hazari Court, New Delhi

European leagues pile pressure on FIFA chief Infantino

NYON: The association of European soccer leagues called for governance reform of FIFA on Wednesday, adding to the mounting pressure on president Gianni Infantino following his failed plan to sell stakes in the World Cup.

On the day that Infantino reportedly held a meeting with senior staff in Rabat, Morocco, European Leagues, which includes top competitions like the Premier League, La Liga and Serie A, described the proposal as “dangerous” and said it pointed to deeper concerns about how world soccer’s governing body operates.

It said it raised “serious questions about FIFA’s governance, internal culture and decision-making.” “Now more than ever, FIFA requires governance reform that ensures that all relevant stakeholders have a formal role in decisions that shape the future of our game.”

In the statement European Leagues hit out at the possibility of further expanding the World Cup to 64 teams and said “FIFA must not be allowed to continue taking unilaterally disruptive decisions.” It said that until there was reform it would reject the “expansion or creation” of FIFA competitions.

European Leagues is the latest to condemn Infantino’s plans after a tumultuous week, which has raised questions about his presidency of FIFA ahead of elections in March.



European soccer’s governing body UEFA has applied the most intense pressure by voting to boycott the World Cup if Infantino pressed ahead with the controversial plans to sell profits in its top competition through a commercial subsidiary called FIFA Forward Enterprise (FFE) that would run tournaments.

Even after Infantino’s climbdown UEFA said it had lost confidence in FIFA’s leadership — possibly paving the way for a challenge to his presidency. The governing body for North and Central American and Caribbean soccer (CONCACAF) also said FIFA leadership had “stopped putting football first.”

On Tuesday top FIFA officials Arsène Wenger and secretary-general Mattias Graström distanced themselves from the FFE plans, which emphasized divisions within the organization that were evident when Infantino’s senior adviser Carlos Cordeiro resigned last week.

M.P. URBAN DEVELOPMENT COMPANY LIMITED
(CIN : U75110MP2015SGC034139)
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M.P. Nagar, Zone-I, Bhopal-462011, Phone No. : +91-755-2763060
61, 62, Fax : +91-755 2763868, E-mail : mpusipbpl@mpurban.gov.in
No. 9055/MPUDC/PMU/2026 Dated : 05.08.2026

MPUDC INVITES APPLICATIONS FOR VARIOUS POSITIONS

Madhya Pradesh Urban Development Company Limited (MPUDC) is inviting applications for various positions on deputation/contract basis.

This recruitment is being undertaken as part of a comprehensive revamping and restructuring of the Company, including the creation of new specialized division to strengthen institutional capacity and enhance project implementation. Professionals having relevant experience are encouraged to apply, as per the detailed advertisement available on the MPUDC website.

Post Code	Name of the Vacant Position	No. of Vacancy
NM-I	Hydrologist/Ground water Management Specialist (Namami Narmada Division)	1
PE-1	Project Executives (Asset Management)	1
PE-2	Project Executive (Business Development)	1

- Application Details :-**
- Interested candidates may apply on or before **27th August 2026 at 05:00 PM**
 - Eligible candidates are required to **E-mail their filled applications in provided format alongwith detailed Curriculum Vitae (CV)** to the following email address: **vacancy.mpudc@gmail.com**
 - Applications not is prescribed format shall not be entertained.
 - For detailed information regarding **eligibility criteria, educational qualifications, and experience**, candidates are advised to visit the Company's official website : **www.mpudc.co.in**.
 - Any further information. Notice, addendum shall be issued on the website of the Company only.
 - MPUDCL reserves the right to cancel any or all vacancies without providing any reason to general public.

DEPUTY PROJECT DIRECTOR (ADMIN.)
M.P. Madhyam/127389/2026

Tanvi leads strong women’s show in S Korea

ASAN: Newly-crowned Taipei Open champion Tanvi Sharma led a strong Indian showing in the women’s singles, but former world championship silver medalist Kidambi Srikanth suffered an opening-round exit in men’s singles as India endured a mixed day at the Korea Masters Super 300 here on Wednesday.

Third seed Tanvi, who recently clinched her maiden BWF World Tour title at the Taipei Open, eased past China’s Yuan An Qi 21-16, 21-15 to progress to the second round.

Rakshitna Ramraj recovered from a game down to beat Korea’s Yoo A Yeon 22-24, 21-12, 21-13, while Mansi Singh fought back to defeat Kim Joo Eun 14-21, 21-19, 21-9.

Fifth seed Isharani Baruah also advanced to the next round after overcoming Korea’s Lee So Yul 21-18, 15-21, 21-7, while eighth seed Anmol Kharb rallied from a game down to beat Hong Kong’s Lo Sin Yan Happy 16-21, 21-17, 21-12.

Ashmita Chahliha defeated Japan’s Riko Hiramoto 22-20, 21-18 and Shriyanshi Valishetty brushed aside Chinese Taipei’s Pai Yu Po 21-15, 21-14 to book their places in the second round. The only Indian casualties in women’s singles were Tanya Hemanth, who went down 16-21, 20-22 to top seed Hina Akechi.

बेदखली सूचना

मैं, अजय कोशिक पुत्र श्री धर्म प्रकाश शर्मा निवासी मकान नंबर डी-29/1 प्रथम तल सेक्टर-85 फरीदाबाद-121002 हरियाणा। मेरी पत्नी भागीबी जो मेरे कले सुनने से बाहर है जिसे मैं अपनी समस्त चल अचल संपत्ति से बेदखल करता हूँ। इसके द्वारा किये गये कानूनी- गैर कानूनी कार्य व लेनदेन का वह स्वयं जिम्मेवार होगा, मेरा व मेरे परिवार का इससे कोई बरतना नहीं होगा।

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C./84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused persons Namely **Murli @ Raju S/o Sh. Jugal Kishore R/o H.No. 611, Pocket 4, Sector A-6, Narela, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 420/2018 U/s 411/34 IPC & 25/54/59 Arms Act PS: Alipur, Outer North District, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Murli @ Raju** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Murli @ Raju** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Murli @ Raju** accused of **FIR No. 420/2018 U/s 411/34 IPC & 25/54/59 Arms Act PS: Alipur, Outer North District, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **22.09.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Priyanka Rajpoot
Ld. CJM/North, Room No. 115
Rohini Court, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 (ii) Cr. P.C.

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Sunny S/o Ashwani R/o Jhuggi No. 56, Shyam Nagar, Tilak Nagar, New Delhi** have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under **FIR No. 207/2019 U/s 454/380/411/34 IPC.**, has been registered at **PS: Tilak Nagar, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, **Sunny** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **Sunny** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, **Sunny** of under **FIR No. 207/2019 U/s 454/380/411/34 IPC.**, Registered at **PS: Tilak Nagar, New Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **11.09.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Vikas Madaan
JMFC-03 (West District)
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

← KIND ATTENTION RAIL PASSENGERS! →

IMPORTANT NOTICE

RUN OF SPECIAL TRAIN BETWEEN NEW DELHI-SUPAUL-NEW DELHI

For the convenience of rail passengers Northern Railways has decided to run a Special Train between New Delhi-Supaul-New Delhi as per details mentioned below:-

04072/04071 New Delhi-Supaul-New Delhi Reserved Special Express (Daily)				112 Trips
Train No. 04072		STATIONS	Train No. 04071	
ARR.	DEP.		ARR.	DEP.
---	21:35	New Delhi	15:00	---
22:10	22:12	Ghaziabad	13:57	13:59
01:18	01:20	Aligarh Jn.	11:30	11:32
03:20	03:22	Tundla Jn	10:20	10:22
04:38	04:40	Etawah Jn.	08:10	08:12
06:50	06:55	Govindpuri	06:10	06:15
11:50	11:55	Prayagraj Jn.	01:35	01:45
14:35	14:45	Varanasi	22:30	22:40
15:25	15:27	Aunrihar Jn.	21:03	21:05
16:15	16:25	Ghazipur City	20:05	20:15
17:23	17:25	Ballia	18:37	18:39
18:03	18:05	Suraimanpur	17:55	17:57
19:20	19:30	Chhapra	17:10	17:20
20:53	20:55	Sonpur	15:05	15:07
21:05	21:10	Hajipur Jn.	14:50	14:55
22:10	22:12	Shahpur Patoree	13:30	13:32
00:35	00:45	Barauni Jn.	12:20	12:30
01:03	01:05	Begusarai	11:38	11:40
02:18	02:20	Khagaria Jn.	11:05	11:07
02:40	02:42	Mansi Jn.	10:53	10:55
03:10	03:12	Simri Bhakhtiyarpur	10:08	10:10
03:45	03:55	Saharsa Jn.	09:35	09:45
06:35	---	Supaul	---	07:45

Days of run : 04072 Ex. New Delhi from 06.08.2026 to 30.09.2026 (Daily) and **04071 Ex. Supaul** from 08.08.2026 to 02.10.2026 (Daily).

Composition: 3 Tier AC, Sleeper & General.

For detailed information, please call RailMadad Helpline No. 139 or visit enquiry website: www.enquiry.indianrail.gov.in

RailMadad Helpline No. 139

Visit RailMadad website:- www.railmadad.indianrailways.gov.in

Download RailMadad app.

NORTHERN RAILWAY

Your Convenience-Our Concern

Visit us at: www.nr.indianrailways.gov.in

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

JHARKHAND RENEWABLE ENERGY DEVELOPMENT AGENCY (JREDA)

3rd Floor, SLDC Building, Kusai, Doranda, Ranchi- 834002. Ph. No: 2491161, Fax No: 0651-2491165

Web site: www.jreda.com, E-mail: info@jreda.com

e-Procurement Notice

Tender Reference No.: 14/JREDA/Misc. Services/26-27

Dated: 03.08.2026

Jharkhand Renewable Energy Development Agency (JREDA) is an autonomous body registered under the Societies Act, 1860, and is under the administrative control of the Department of Energy, Govt. of Jharkhand, for promoting the use of renewable energy sources, with its registered office at Kusai Colony, Doranda, Ranchi, Jharkhand-834002. JREDA requires a Rate Contract for Supply of Office Stationery Items, Cleaning Materials, IT Consumables, Computer Accessories, Printing Materials, Office Utility Items & Allied Services, Repair & Maintenance of Electrical & Electronics Items for its office operations and official requirements at its headquarters and other project locations in the State of Jharkhand.

Sl. No.	Particulars	Details
1	Name of the Work	Rate Contract for Supply of Miscellaneous Office Stationery Items, Cleaning Materials, IT Consumables, Computer Accessories, Printing Materials, Office Utility Items & Allied Miscellaneous Services, Repair & Maintenance of Electrical & Electronics Items to Jharkhand Renewable Energy Development Agency (JREDA).
2	Approx. for 1 Year Estimated Cost (in Rs.)	₹ 5,00,000/- (Five Lakhs Rupees Only) Inclusive of GST*
3	Earnest Money Deposit (Refundable) (In Rs.)	₹ 10,000/- (Ten Thousand Rupees Only)
4	Cost of Tender Document (Bid Fee) Non-Refundable (In Rs.)	₹ 1,475/- (Rupees One Thousand Four Hundred Seventy-Five Only) Inclusive of GST
5	Contract Period	12 (Twelve) Months
6	Date of Publication of NIT on website:	05.08.2026 (Wednesday)
7	Date & Time of Pre-Bid Queries at JREDA Office	10.08.2026 (Thursday) up to 02:00 PM
8	Last Date & Time for Receipt of Online Bids	27.08.2026 (Monday) up to 05:00 PM
9	Submission of Bid Fee & EMD (Online via SBI Payment Gateway of Jharkhand Tenders)	27.08.2026 (Thursday) up to 05:00 PM
10	Technical Bid Opening Date	01.09.2026 (Tuesday) at 03:00 PM
11	Name & Address of Office Inviting Tender	Director, Jharkhand Renewable Energy Development Agency (JREDA), 3rd Floor, SLDC Building, Kusai Colony, Doranda, Ranchi-834002.
12	Contact No. of Procurement Officer	0651-2491161 / 63 / 67
13	Helpline No. of e-Procurement	0651-2491161 / 63 / 67

Any corrigendum/addendum can be seen on the website: <http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in> & www.jreda.com. Further details can be seen on the website: <http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in> & www.jreda.com.

Sd/ Director, JREDA, Ranchi

PR.NO.386673 Energy(26-27):D

JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE

DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU

0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F),

email:-sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in

Hue and Cry Notice

Rule No. 712/191

SHO P/S Jhajjar Kotli, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Anil Kumar S/O Hari Ram R/O Bagla Doda P/S Doda is evading his arrest/wanted in case FIR No. 139/2019 U/S 279/337/304-A RPC of P/S Jhajjar Kotli, Jammu, since the commission of crime. Despite repeated raids/efforts the accused could not be traced/still absconded.

It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.

Description Roll :-

Name	: Anil Kumar
S/o	: Hari Ram
Address	: Bagla Doda P/S Doda
Age	: 40 years
Height	: 5'6"
Complexion	: Wheatish
Eyes	: Black

Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-

1.DPO, Jammu	:0191-2547807,0191-2561578
2. SSP Jammu Mail I.D	: sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
3.PCR Jammu	:0191-2605949
4.SP Rural Jammu	: 0191-2605949
5. SDPO Nagrota	:00191-2673666
6.SHO P/S Jhajjar Kotli	:0191-2668008

Sd/- Sr. Superintendent of Police Jammu

DIP No:DIP/J-7359/26

Chhattisgarh State Industrial Development Corporation Limited
(A Government of Chhattisgarh Undertaking)
(ISO 9001 : 2015 Certified)
1st Floor, Udyog Bhawan, Ring Road No.1, Tolibandha, Raipur (C.G.) - 492006
CIN : U45203CT18RISG001833, PAN : AAIJCM288N, GST Regn No:22AAIJC288N52Y
Phone : 0771-6621000, Fax : 0771-2383794
Website : www.csidc.in, Email address: csidc_cg@nic.in, csidc_raipur@yahoo.com

NOTICE INVITING TENDER (3rd call)
(Through e-Procurement Portal Only)

No.: 24/CSIDC/E E -I/Division-I/2026-27/196796 Raipur, dated 04/08/2026

Online (Percentage Basis) tenders in Form-A are invited from contractors registered in Class-C & Above in New Unified Registration System (E-Registration) website <https://eproc.csidc.gov.in> at appropriate class, for the following works:-

S.No.	Name of Work	Registered Contractor in CGPWD or in appropriate class in other dep't.	Time allowed including rainy season	Estimated Cost (INR Lacs)	EMD (INR Rs.)	Cost of Tender Doc. (INR) including GST 18%
1.	Up gradation of Existing 30m & 24m wide BT roads including Street Light at I/A Silpahari, Distt. Bilaspur (C.G.)	C& Above	03 Months i/c rainy season	195.59 Lacs	1,47,000/-	3540/-

The tender document and other details can be downloaded from the web portal (website) <https://eproc.csidc.gov.in> from 04/08/2026 and shall be submitted online only. Amendment in tender, if any, will only be uploaded on the website and shall not be published in any newspaper.

NOTE:

- The interested tenderers for online submission of tender may contact CG eProc Helpdesk Operated by Junction Services Limited, they may reach Helpdesk using 18002582502 (from 9 AM to 11 PM) (Helpline press 2 for CG e-Proc) or you can email them at helpdesk_eproc@csidc.gov.in
- Tenderer may contact to E.E. Div-I, CSIDC, Udyog Bhawan in working hours to clear their doubt if any before online submission of the tender

samvad 48672/2

Executive Engineer, Division-I

NORTHERN RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE

E-Tender No.: 09C-TRD-NDLS-2026-27 Dated 05.08.2026

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/Traction Distribution, DRM's Office, State Entry Road, New Delhi for & on behalf of President of India, invites open e-tender for the under noted work:

1 Name of work with its location	Augmentation/Replacement of Catenary wire over Delhi (7th Phase)
2 Approx cost of work	Rs. 1,80,29,018.38/-
3 Earnest Money Deposit	Rs. 3,60,600/-
4 E-Tender Bid Online Submission Period	17.08.2026 (00.00 Hrs.) to 31.08.2026 (15.00 Hrs.)
5 E-Tender Bid Submission End Date & E-Tender Open Date & Time	31.08.2026 (15.00 Hrs.)
6 Website particulars where complete details of tender document can be seen	www.ireps.gov.in

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 2698/26

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Milan Roy S/o Budhru Roy R/o Village Baman Haat, PS -Dinhata Block-Khand Bazar, Distt. New Kuch Bihar, West Bengal** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 196/2023 U/s 25/54/59 A, Act PS: Welcome, Delhi**, and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Milan Roy** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Milan Roy** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Milan Roy** accused of **FIR No. 196/2023 U/s 25/54/59 A, Act PS: Welcome, Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **08.10.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Deepakshi Rana
JMFC-03, Room No. 19
Karkardooma Court, Delhi

DP/10718/NE/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that that accused **Veena, W/o Sh. Naresh Kumar, R/o H. No. C-81, Yadav Nagar, Samaypur, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 151/2021 & FIR No. 798/2023, U/S 135 Electricity Act, P.S. Samaypur Badli, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Veena**, can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Veena**, has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Veena**, of **FIR No. 151/2021 & FIR No. 798/2023, U/S 135 Electricity Act, P.S. Samaypur Badli, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **09.09.2026 at 10:00 am**.

By Order,
Sh. Kuljeewan Sidharth
Addl. Sessions Judge (Electricity)
North-West Distt., Room No. 316
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/10792/ON/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 (2)(ii)Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person namely **Sunny S/o Sh. Anoop, R/o: H. No. 66, Double Story, Harijan Colony, Tilak Nagar, New Delhi** (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 253/2018, U/s 498A/406/34 IPC**, registered at P.S.: Rajouri Garden, Delhi and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused **Sunny** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Sunny** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Sunny** accused **FIR No. 253/2018, U/s 498A/406/34 IPC**, registered at P.S.: Rajouri Garden, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **21.09.2026**.

By Order
Chhavi Bansal
Judicial Magistrate First Class (West)
(Mahila Court)-04, Room No. 252
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/10489/WD/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

See Section 82 Cr. P.C./ 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Mohd. Hasan @ Sonu @ Babu @ Ahsan S/o Suresh @ Mohd. Shahid R/o H. No. 28/12, K Block, Gali No. 1, Bhajanpura, Delhi** also at Gali No. 3, Garg Enclave, Burari, Delhi has Committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 453/2025 U/s 304(2)/317(2) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023, & 106 Bhartiya Nagrik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023, P.S. IP Estate, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Mohd. Hasan @ Sonu @ Babu @ Ahsan** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Mohd. Hasan @ Sonu @ Babu @ Ahsan** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Mohd. Hasan @ Sonu @ Babu @ Ahsan** of case **FIR No. 453/2025 U/s 304(2)/317(2) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023, & 106 Bhartiya Nagrik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023, P.S. IP Estate, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **16.11.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Preeti
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
Central District, Room No. 150
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/10673/CD/2026 (Court Matter)



‘Don’t need anyone’s permission to speak’

Siddharth said he never sought anyone’s approval before expressing his opinions

While promoting his upcoming web series ‘Operation Safed Sagar’, Siddharth opened up about his relatively limited body of work in Hindi cinema despite earning acclaim for his performance in ‘Rang De Basanti’ two decades ago. The actor said he isn’t offered the kind of Hindi films he would like to do, but has made peace with it, adding that he would rather wait years for the right project than sign films just to stay visible.

In an interview with ‘Showsha’, Siddharth was asked why audiences don’t get to see him more often in Hindi films. The actor admitted that the opportunities haven’t come his way. He clarified that actors can only choose from the projects that are offered to them. “I can only say yes or no to something that’s offered to me.”

When asked if he wasn’t being offered enough Hindi films, he replied: “Oh, absolutely not. Absolutely not. Not the kind of work I’d like to do.”

The actor said he would rather wait for meaningful roles than work



The actor earlier admitted that the opportunities haven’t come his way

for the sake of staying busy. Looking back at his Hindi film journey, Siddharth pointed out that although he hasn’t done many Bollywood films, he has been fortunate enough to be part of projects that truly matter to him.

The actor stressed that he has continued working consistently across industries. He added that language has never been a barrier for him. “If Hindi gives me work, I do it. In the absence of that, somebody else will give me work that I’d like to do - Tamil, Telugu, Malayalam, Kannada, Bengali, Punjabi, America or England. I can go wherever my work calls me.”

Siddharth, who has often made headlines for expressing his views on social and political issues, was also asked whether speaking up has come at the cost of losing work. Rather than giving a direct answer, he turned the question back on the media. “In 2026, if there’s anybody in the world who I would like to ask, ‘Does being vocal come at a cost?’ It would be the Indian media. So, I think you have the answer to your question.”

The actor added that he has never sought anyone’s approval before expressing his opinions. “I didn’t need anyone’s permission when I started speaking. I don’t need anyone’s permission to continue speaking.” AGENCIES

Pradeep Rawat passes away at 74



He was known for his performance in ‘Sarfarosh’, ‘Lagaan’ and ‘Ghajini’

Last rites of actor Pradeep Rawat, who died at the age of 74 after a battle with cancer, took place on Wednesday evening in Mumbai. Known for his performance in popular Hindi films such as ‘Sarfarosh’, ‘Lagaan’ and ‘Ghajini’ as well as many South Indian movies and television shows, Rawat passed away at a hospital here on Tuesday.

“He was like Amrish Puri in the South film industry and had done more than 400 films. Pradeep had a strong personality. Now we have lost three members of ‘Lagaan Team’, the actor’s friend Daya Shankar Pandey told PTI.

Pandey was referring to the death of actors Rajesh Vivek Upadhyay, Shrivallabh Vyas and Javed Khan Amrohi, who all played key roles in the period cricket drama, fronted by Aamir Khan.

Filmmaker Ashoke Pandit shared Rawat’s funeral details in a social media post where he also condoled the actor’s death. “Sad and shocked to know about the demise of our dear friend Pradeep Rawat, a brilliant actor and a wonderful human being due to cancer. A great loss to the industry. My heartfelt condolences to the family

Rawat rose to stardom with his portrayal of Ashwatthama in ‘Mahabharat’ and later featured in popular TV shows

and near ones. His mortal remains will be kept for final ‘darshan’ today from 2 pm to 4 pm at Bwing P3 Imperial Heights, Goregaon West. After 4 pm, he will be taken for the final rites and cremation near the Oshiwara Bridge on SV Road, Jogeshwari West,” Pandit shared.

Rawat rose to stardom with his portrayal of Ashwatthama in ‘Mahabharat’ and later featured in popular TV shows such as ‘Tehkikaat’, ‘Chandrakanta’ and ‘Yug’. His other Hindi movie credits include ‘Agnepath’, ‘Meri Jung’, ‘Sarfarosh’, ‘The Hero: Story of a Spy’ and ‘Chhava’.

In South cinema, he was often awarded for his portrayal of villains, most notably in ‘Sye’, ‘Mangala’ and ‘Nayak’. He reprised his negative role in the Hindi remake of Aamir Khan-starrer ‘Ghajini’ after starring in the Tamil version, led by Suriya. PTI

Preity Zinta says she didn’t miss acting

Preity Zinta is all set to make her long-awaited return to the silver screen with ‘Batwara 1947’, ending an eight-year break from films. Once among Bollywood’s most bankable actresses in the 2000s, Preity gradually stepped away from acting after getting married and embracing motherhood, choosing to focus on her family rather than pursuing projects regularly.

Speaking to the media recently ahead of the film’s release, Preity reflected on returning to film sets after such a long gap. When asked if she was nervous, she admitted that stepping back in front of the camera came with its share of anxiety.

“There were nerves,” she said in an interview with ‘Hindustan Times’. The actress revealed that director Rajkumar Santoshi made

The actress is set to make a comeback with ‘Batwara 1947’

things even more challenging by scheduling one of the film’s toughest scenes on her very first day. She credited co-star Sunny Deol for helping her stay calm through the experience.

“He (director Santoshi) tortured me on day one by putting the most difficult scene of the film on the first day. So, I was just looking at Sunny Deol and I was shaking ki what do I do now? He is a wonderful, big-hearted, kind, decent, good human being to work with because he really was like, ‘Don’t worry, he loves retakes. Will you eat something?’” AGENCIES



AVIKA GOR ON ‘KHATRON KE KHILADI’

‘A show I can’t say no to’

Balika Vadhu’ star Avika Gor said her stint on the upcoming reality show ‘Khatron Ke Khiladi’ is a departure from her past work. Still, it is not an attempt to change her girl-next-door image on television.

Best known for her role of a child bride in ‘Balika Vadhu’, Gor later went on to appear in ‘Sasural Simar Ka’ and Telugu, Kannada and Hindi movies like ‘Uyyala Jampala’, ‘Care of Footpath 2’, ‘1920: Horrors of the Heart’ and others.

“I’ve done two reality shows, ‘Khatron Ke Khiladi’ and ‘Pati Patni Aur Panga’. With my experience, the idea of breaking a pattern or an image is not something I operate from. I love people seeing me as a girl-next-door and having people remem-

ber me as one of their own, so that is not something that I’m chasing. But this is a show (‘KKK’) where people get to see a side of me, which is courageous and daring, which was a surprise for myself. I got to know what I was capable of,” Gor told PTI in an interview.

For the 29-year-old actress, participating in ‘Khatron Ke Khiladi’ was more of a personal milestone than a calculated career move. “It is a show I can’t say no to.” PTI



‘THE ODYSSEY’ BECOMES INDIA’S HIGHEST-GROSSING IMAX RELEASE

Christopher Nolan’s ‘The Odyssey’ has become India’s highest-grossing IMAX release, earning Rs 63 crore across 34 IMAX screens in just 17 days and overtaking the lifetime IMAX collections of the filmmaker’s previous movie ‘Oppenheimer’

Christopher Nolan’s ‘The Odyssey’ has become India’s highest-grossing IMAX release, earning Rs 63 crore across 34 IMAX screens in just 17 days and overtaking the lifetime IMAX collections of the filmmaker’s previous movie ‘Oppenheimer’.

The record came after ‘Warner Bros. Discovery’, ‘Universal Pictures International’, IMAX Corporation and exhibition partners mounted a week-long campaign featuring exclusive merchandise, fan experiences and exhibitor-led initiatives that kept audience interest alive throughout the film’s theatrical run.

According to ‘Warner Bros. Discovery’, ‘The Odyssey’ surpassed ‘Oppenheimer’, which grossed Rs 50 crore during its entire IMAX run in India, making Nolan the only filmmaker whose films occupy the top two spots among the country’s highest-grossing IMAX releases.

“Christopher Nolan came to Mumbai in July and told us Indian audiences are among the most enthusiastic and knowledgeable in the world. This is the proof. The top two highest-grossing IMAX releases in India’s history are both his films. Not one, but two films by the same director are made the same way for the same reason, because he believes cinema is meant to be seen at the scale only IMAX can give it. India agreed with ‘Oppenheimer’. India has now agreed twice and this time it took 17 days, not an entire run. When a filmmaker builds his entire career around convincing audiences that the biggest screen is the only screen worth choosing and an audience answers him this decisively and this quickly, that is not a box office record. That is a promise on both sides,” Denzil Dias, Vice President and Managing Director, India Theatrical, ‘Warner Bros. Discovery’, said.



Based on Homer’s epic poem, ‘The Odyssey’ chronicles the decade-long journey of Odysseus, the King of Ithaca, as he struggles to return home after the Trojan War while battling mythical creatures, divine interventions and impossible odds.

The film, which was released in theatres worldwide on July 17, stars Matt Damon as Odysseus alongside Tom Holland, Anne Hathaway, Zendaya, Lupita Nyong’o, Robert Pattinson, Charlize Theron, Jon Bernthal, Mia Goth, Elliot Page, Benny Safdie, Himesh Patel, Samantha Morton, Corey Hawkins, Cosmo Jarvis and John Leguizamo.

The studio said the campaign began with Nolan and members of the ensemble cast attending the film’s India premiere in Mumbai, with digital content from the event generating over 50 million views.

A stop for tea by Nolan and the cast ahead of the premiere also went viral, garnering more than 20 million views on Universal Pictures India’s ‘Instagram’ page alone. The

‘The Odyssey’ makes Nolan the only filmmaker whose films occupy the top two spots among the country’s highest-grossing IMAX releases

promotional campaign continued well after release through fan reaction videos, creator collaborations and a series of in-cinema initiatives designed to encourage repeat viewing.

Beginning in the opening week, audiences at participating IMAX locations received one of four limited-edition character pins and exclusive IMAX T-shirts. In the second week, selected theatres distributed framed IMAX 70mm film strips from the movie in limited quantities, celebrating ‘The Odys-

sey’ as the first feature film shot entirely with IMAX film cameras.

As the theatrical run entered its third and fourth weeks, exhibitors introduced exclusive artwork posters, while a nationwide IMAX initiative marking Nolan’s birthday featured advance bookings and special ticket pricing.

“The Odyssey’s record-breaking run in India is a testament to Christopher Nolan’s bold vision and the incredible enthusiasm that audiences across the country have shown for experiencing the film in IMAX,” said Preetham Daniel, Vice President, Theatre Development, India, Korea, South East Asia and Australasia at IMAX.

He added, “We’re grateful to ‘Warner Bros. Discovery’, ‘Universal Pictures International’ and our exhibition partners for their partnership throughout this historic run.”

PVR INOX Chief Strategy Officer Kamal Gianchandani said audiences embraced the film as more than just another theatrical

release. “PVR INOX is pleased to have played a role in The Odyssey’s historic IMAX journey in India. From hosting Christopher Nolan and the film’s cast at its landmark premiere at PVR ICON Mumbai to partnering with IMAX, ‘Warner Bros.’ and ‘Universal Pictures International’ to sustain audience excitement throughout its theatrical run, the journey has been truly remarkable. What stood out most was the extraordinary audience response. Across generations, moviegoers embraced ‘The Odyssey’ not merely as a film to watch, but as a cinematic experience to revisit and share with friends and family,” he added.

Devang Sampat, Managing Director, Cinepolis India, said the film’s success was driven by sustained audience interest beyond the opening weekend. “What stands out about ‘The Odyssey’ is how the film kept building. Audiences came back, brought others with them and kept IMAX houses busy deep into the run. Word of mouth has carried the strongest films of the last

two years well past their opening weekends and this one sits at the top of that list. Our job as exhibitors was to make every visit worth repeating and this milestone shows what studios and exhibitors can achieve when they build a film’s run together,” Sampat said.

Miraj Entertainment COO Sameer Munshi said audiences from several cities travelled specifically to experience the film at the company’s Wadala IMAX screen. “The response to Christopher Nolan’s ‘The Odyssey’ at Miraj IMAX Wadala has been truly extraordinary... Fans are not only returning for a second and even a third IMAX viewing, but many have also travelled from cities such as Hyderabad, Indore and Nagpur just to experience ‘The Odyssey’ at Miraj IMAX Wadala. ‘The Odyssey’ has reaffirmed that audiences are willing to go the extra mile for an unparalleled cinematic experience and we are proud that this historic IMAX screen continues to be at the heart of those unforgettable movie moments,” he said. AGENCIES

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

E-Tender No.: PRYJ-Sig-029-2026-27

Dated: 04.08.2026

E-TENDER NOTICE

Senior Divisional Signal & Telecommunication Engineer/Coordination/North Central Railway/Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invite **E-TENDER** on prescribed form for the following works up to **12.00 hrs.** on **31.08.2026**. The detail of the Tender is as under:-

Tender No.: PRYJ-Sig-029-2026-27	Approx. Cost of Work : ₹ 1,73,06,901/-
Name of Work: Provision of CCTV Cameras at Goods Shed at Aligarh, Hathras Fort, Chunar, Shakteshgarh and Shankargarh Stations.	
Bid Security : ₹ 3,46,100/-	Cost of Tender form: ₹ 0.00
Completion Period : 12 Months	Date of Closing of Tender : 31.08.2026

Availability of tender form: Tender forms shall be available on www.ireps.gov.in 21 days prior to date of opening of the tender. **Earnest Money to be deposited:** The prescribed amount of Bid Security as mentioned above must be deposited along with the tender form Online through Internet Banking or Online Payment gateway only. The tenderer(s) should note that, in any case, the Bid Security in any other form specified in GCC shall be acceptable. If the Bid Security deposited by the bidder is in shape of Bank Guarantee, it should be supported by proper stamp duty, rate prescribed as per section 13 & 24 of the UP Stamp Act, 2008 and amended from time to time at the time of submission of Bank Guarantee. Tenders without Bid Security shall be summarily rejected. **Time, Date & Place of opening of Tender:** Tender will be opened through E-tender at office of Divisional Railway Manager, Prayagraj on or after Pre-determined date at **12.30 hours**. In case tender opening date happens to be holiday, Tenders will be opened on the next working day. **Validity of offer:** 60 days from the date of opening. **Right of Railway to deal with Tender:** Railway administration reserves the rights to postpone/modify or to cancel the tender without assigning any reasons. **Definition of similar work:** Any work involving supply, installation, testing and commissioning of Integrated Security System/Video surveillance system/Access Control, Personal & Baggage Screening system, Explosive Detection & Disposal System and their integration. **180126(A)**

 North central railways

 @CPRONCR

 www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC / 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Prem Raj S/o Mahipal R/o G-10, Kadi Vihar, Village-Kadipur, Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 337/2020, U/S 279/338 IPC, PS Swaroop Nagar, Outer North Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Prem Raj** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Prem Raj** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant);
Proclamation is hereby made that **Prem Raj** the said accused of **FIR No. 337/2020, U/S 279/338 IPC, PS Swaroop Nagar, Outer North Distt., Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **24.09.2026**.

By Order

Ms. Jyoti Nain
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07,
DP/10884/ON/2026
(Court Matter)

North Distt., 1st Floor
Rohini Court, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Nadim Khan, S/o: Sameer Khan, R/o: H.No 161, Sunlight Colony, New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 494/2022 U/s 279/304A IPC, P.S.: Sun Light Colony, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Nadim Khan** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Nadim Khan** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Nadim Khan** accused of offence in case **FIR No. 494/2022 U/s 279/304A IPC, P.S.: Sun Light Colony, New Delhi** and is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **29.09.2026**.

By Order

Sh. Divyam Lila
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07
DP/10528/SE/2026
(Court Matter)

Room No. 508, Saket Court Complex, New Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Mohd. Mehtab Husain, S/o: Mohd. Tafujul Husain, R/o: 16/581, Bapa Nagar, Karol Bagh, Delhi**; also at: 16/265-E, Bapa Nagar, Karol Bagh, Delhi; also at: 287/A-16, Gali No. 19, Prem Nagar, Patel Nagar, Delhi also at: Govindpur, Dhanbad, Jharkhand has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 260/22 U/s 376/506 IPC and 6 PCSO Act, P.S.: Nabi Karim, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Mohd. Mehtab Husain** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Mohd. Mehtab Husain** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Mohd. Mehtab Husain** accused of offence in case **FIR No. 260/22 U/s 376/506 IPC and 6 PCSO Act, P.S.: Nabi Karim, Delhi** and is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **21.09.2026**.

By Order

Sh. Rana Deepak Singh,
DP/10768/CD/2026 Additional Sessions Judge, (FTSC) (PCSO)-2,
(Court Matter)

Room No.142, Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

**GOVERNMENT OF PUNJAB**

GREATER MOHALI AREA DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY

PUDA BHAWAN, SECTOR 62, SAS NAGAR

Tender Notice No.1396-1401 dated 05-08-2026

Divisional Engineer (H-1), GMADA, SAS Nagar invites online bids for the following works:
1. Development of horticulture works with 3 years maintenance at sector dividing roads from 76/77-88/89 junction to Railway line at SAS Nagar.
2. Development and maintenance of horticulture works from Phase 7/8 light point to Phase 8/9 light point, green belts and internal roads of Sector-62 at SAS Nagar.
3. Development of horticulture works with maintenance for 3 years of 164 feet wide road from Bawa White House to 300' wide Airport road, SAS Nagar
4. Plantation on Internal roads of IT City, SAS Nagar with 3 years maintenance.
5. Development of horticulture works in N-choe of Sector 67 with 3 years maintenance at SAS Nagar.
6. Development of horticulture works with 1 year maintenance at junction Gurdwara Sohana Sahib, 68/69/78/79 & 67/68/79/80 on PR-7 road.
Closing Date & Time: For Sr. no. 1-4: 24.08.2026 at 12:00 Noon
For Sr. no. 5-6: 19.08.2026 at 12:00 Noon
For details log on to <https://eproc.punjab.gov.in/nicepg/app>
RO NO PR-Advt. No :- 1324/12/2026-27/13969

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Boby S/o Basi Ahmed R/o A-148, Gali No.-3, Kardampuri, Welcome, Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 196/2022 U/S 323/452/305/34 IPC, PS Welcome, North-East Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Boby** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Boby** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant);
Proclamation is hereby made that **Boby** the said accused of **FIR No 196/2022 U/S 323/452/305/34 IPC, PS Welcome, North-East Distt., Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **29.09.2026**.

By Order

Ms. Deepakshi Rana
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03,
DP/10740/NE/2026
(Court Matter)

Room No.-19, 1st Floor, Shahdara Distt., Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

E-TENDERING TENDER NOTICE

Date: 04.08.2026

For & on behalf of President of India, Sr. Divisional Mechanical Engineer (Coaching), Prayagraj North Central Railway, Prayagraj invites OPEN E-Tenders in prescribed forms, from reputed contractors with adequate experience and financial capability for the under mentioned work up to Date & time of closing of tender on GeM website-

GEM BID NO.: GEM/2026/B/7875961, Dated: 04.08.2026

Name of work: Work of water filling in the Coaches of trains passing through SFG Station for the period of Two years.

Tender system: Two packet system	Tender Value: ₹ 36981216/-
EMD: ₹ 334910/-	Cost of Tender Form: Nil
Period of work: 02 years	Date of publishing on GeM website: 04.08.2026
Bid End Date/Time: 27.08.2026 at 15:00 Hrs.	

Note:- 1. The complete information along with tender booklet of above E-Tenders are available on GeM Website www.Gem.gov.in. 2. Online E-Tender can be submitted on GeM Website up to Date & time of closing of tender. 3. In case of any difficulty in submission of tender on GeM, helpdesk available on the GeM Website may be approached. 4. JV firms all allowed to participate in the tender. **1799/26 (PH)**

 North central railways

 @CPRONCR

 www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C. / 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Yousuf Khan S/o Mohd. Khaili Khan R/o H. No. 73/224, Double Storey, First Floor, New Seelampur, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence case **FIR No. 157/2025 u/s 420/506/34 IPC at P.S. Seelampur, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Yousuf Khan** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Yousuf Khan** has absconded (or is concealing hisself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding u/s 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Yousuf Khan** accused of **FIR No. 157/2025 u/s 420/506/34 IPC at P.S. Seelampur, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on **22.09.2026**.

By Order: **Sh. Anmol Nohria,**

Judicial Magistrate First Class-02, (North-East)
Room No. 17, 1st Floor,
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/10859/NE/2026

**MODERN COACH FACTORY, RAEBARELI**

On behalf of the President of India, Dy. Chief Mechanical Engineer/Fur/Co., Modern Coach Factory, Raebareli is inviting open e-tender (No.-M-200/MCF/RBL/FUR-ACTIVITIES/LWSCZAC&MEMU/F-88, Date: 30.07.2026) based on single packet system online through Indian Railways portal www.ireps.gov.in for following work:-
Description of work: Works contract of complete interior Mechanical and electrical Furnishings & Fittings Activities in LWSCZAC Coaches and interior Mechanical Furnishings & Fittings Activities in MEMU coaches as per scope of work. **Approx. Value (Rs.):** ₹ 4,14,12,260.08, **Bid Security (Rs.):** ₹ 8,28,300.00, **Quantity of Work:** Schdule-A&B-83 LWSCZAC coaches, Schdule-C-18 DMC/DMC-2 coaches, Schdule-D-09 NDMC coaches, Schdule-E-81 TC coaches. **Work Completion Period:** 09 Months or earlier. • E-Tender submitted through online up to 15:00 hrs. on 21.08.2026. Manual offer will not be considered. • E-Tender shall be opened on 21.08.2026 after 15:00 Hrs. through online on <http://www.ireps.gov.in>. • Detailed Tender E-Notice and Terms & Conditions are available at Indian Railways IREPS website-<http://www.ireps.gov.in>.

Dy. Chief Mech. Engr. /Furnishing/Co.

E-Advertised Tender Notice No. 24 ET/2026 Dated: 31.07.2026

S.N.	Tender No.	Short Description	Qty.	Due Date
01	03261615	Supply and Installation of Nose Cone Outer Body Arrangement for Train Set Ver.2	6 Nos.	25/08/2026

Corrigendum

01	Tender Notice No.16 ET/2026 Dated: 01.07.2026	Tender No. 05261181	Due date may be read as 12/08/2026 Instead of 28/07/2026
02	Tender Notice No.23 ET/2026 Dated: 25.07.2026	Tender No. 03261490	Due date may be read as 07/08/2026 Instead of 31/07/2026

Website Address: www.ireps.gov.in & www.mcf.indianrailways.gov.in

Open tender based on Two packet system Tender Notice No.- MCF/ RBL/ Tender/ Robotic UF line/2026-27/ C53J2 dtd. 30.07.2026 is invited by Dy. Chief Mechanical Engineer/Shell, MCF/RBL through IREPS portal www.ireps.gov.in for and on behalf of the President of India for the following work:- **Description of work:** Fabrication of complete underframe with supporting member on robotic underframe line as per scope of work. **Approx. Value (Rs.):** ₹ 3,46,82,500.00, **Cost of Tender Document (₹):** Zero, **EMD (Rs.):** ₹ 6,93,300.00 (Rs. Six Lakh Ninety Three Thousand Three Hundred) only, **Quantity of Work:** As per schedule. **Completion Period of Work:** 08 Months. **Date & time of closing of Tender:** 21.08.2026 at 11:00 hrs. Detailed Tender Notice, Eligibility Criteria, Terms & Conditions are available at IREPS website: www.ireps.gov.in in tender document.

Dy. Chief Mechanical Engineer/Shell

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Ajay @ Munna, S/o Naresh Gupta, R/o A-1753, JJ Colony, Madanpur Khadar, New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 119/2022, U/s 324/341/34 IPC, P.S. Kalindi Kunj, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Ajay @ Munna** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Ajay @ Munna** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Ajay @ Munna** accused of **FIR No. 119/2022, U/s 324/341/34 IPC, P.S. Kalindi Kunj, New Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **07.09.2026**.

By Order - **Sh. Kawal Singh**

Judicial Magistrate First Class-10
South-East District, Room No. 307
Saket Courts, New Delhi

DP/10854/SE/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Rajiv Khandelwal, S/o J.C. Khandelwal, R/o Mayur Vihar Phase-I, Delhi**, also at: VRK Infratech Pvt.Ltd., Plot No. 38, Main Kotla Market, Mayur Vihar Phase-I, Delhi-91, **also at:** C-Wing, 4th Floor, Amar Chand Mansion, 16 Madam Cama Road, Mumbai, **also at:** C-1/133, Safdarjung Development Area, New Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence **CT No. 514142/2016 u/s NI Act at P.S. Prasad Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **accused** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding u/s **82 Cr.P.C.** has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Rajiv Khandelwal** accused of **CT No. 514142/2016 u/s NI Act at P.S. Prasad Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on **09.09.2026**.

By Order: **Shri Karanbir Singh,**

Judicial Magistrate, First Class-02,
Central Distt., Room No.-26,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi.

DP/10795/CD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Yusuf, S/o: Iqbal, R/o.H.No.824, Gali No.4, B-Block, Babunagar, Mustafabad, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in a case vide **FIR No.219/2012 U/S 356/379/511 IPC** registered at **P.S Welcome, North East District, Delhi** and it has been returned on a warrant of arrest there upon issued stating that the said accused **Yusuf** could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Yusuf** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Yusuf**, accused of **FIR No.219/2012 U/S 356/379/511 IPC, P.S Welcome, North East District, Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **01.10.2026**.

By Order **Ms. Deepakshi Rana**

Judicial Magistrate First Class-03,
Shahdara District, Room No.19,
First Floor, Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/10722/NE/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC / 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Ravinder Pal** Previously **Ahmad** in the Court of **Ms. Charu Aswal, Ld MM-04, Central Distt., Court Room No.-37, Tis Hazari, Court, Delhi-64**, Currently Posted as **Ahmad** in the Court of **Ms. Sarita Birbal, LD Principal Judge, Family Courts, Karkardooma Courts, Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 334/2023 U/S 200 R/W 195 CrPC, PS Subzi Mandi, North Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant);
Proclamation is hereby made that **Ravinder Pal** Previously **Ahmad** in the Court of **Ms. Charu Aswal, Ld MM-04, Central Distt., Court Room No.-37, Tis Hazari, Court, Delhi-64**, Currently Posted as **Ahmad** in the Court of **Ms. Sarita Birbal, LD Principal Judge, Family Courts, Karkardooma Courts, Delhi**, the said accused of **FIR No. 334/2023 U/S 200 R/W 195 CrPC, PS Subzi Mandi, North Distt., Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **10.09.2026**.

By Order

Ms. Preeti Rajoria
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07, (Central),
DP/10836/N/2026
(Court Matter)

North Distt., 1st Floor
Rohini Court, Delhi

COURT NOTICE
(U/o S Rule 20 CPC)
IN THE COURT OF MS. Meeta Kohli
Additional Civil Judge (Senior Division), Bhiwani
M/S ADITYA NAO WOVEN FABRICS PVT LTD
Vs.
M/S DRISHTI MANUFACTURE
Execution petition
Case no. Exe-251-2025
CNR No. HRB02-002981-2025
Next Date- 10-08-2026

PUBLIC NOTICE
To be known to all that I, Amrit Lal, S/O Late Shri Gulab Chand, House no.3489, First Floor, Gali Kartar Singh, Sindhi Gurdwara, Arya pura, Subji Mandi, Roshan Ara Road, Delhi-110007 joint owner of SHOP No.418/D, NEW SABZI MANDI(AZADPUR DELHI)has applied for conversion of the aforesaid shop form leasehold that the original document of ALLOTMENT LETTER, POSITION LETTER, DEMAND LETTER, PAYMENT RECEIPT, C FORM & D FORM have been lost An FIR Vide LR No.491888/2026 against this effect has been lodged in Crime Branch Police Station Delhi. Any person claiming any right, interest, having any objection of found in possession of original documents may write contact with above named person at above address/phone No. 9811077418 within 15 days from the date of publication of this notice. The person claiming any right, interest, objection with respect to the property can personally inform or write to Dy. Director (CL) or Director (CL), A-Block, 2nd Floor, Vikas Sadan, INA, New Delhi-110023

PUBLICATION ISSUED TO:
M/S DRISHTI MANUFACTURE
PLOT NO. 44, PHASE-II, SECTOR-15, INDUSTRIAL ESTATE, GC BAWAL, REWARI, HARYANA THROUGH ITS PROP./PARTNER/AUTHORIZED Signatory
In above titled case, the defendant (s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on **10-08-2026 at 10:00 am**.
For details login to https://highscourtcdh.gov.in/?mod=district_notice & district = Bhiwani
Sd/- Ms. Meeta Kohli
Additional Civil Judge (Senior Division)
dated 05.08.2026
Bhiwani

DP/10604/NW/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Sumit @ Tahani @ Dani, S/o:Jodha Ram, R/o: Ram Kumar ki Jhuggi, CD Park, Jahangir Puri, Delhi** also at Village Sawroop Vihar, IP Colony, Delhi and Village Ghatan, Distt Muzaffarnagar, Uttar Pradesh, North, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **SC No.: 662/2019, P.S. Mahendra Park/216/2019, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Sumit @ Tahani @ Dani** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Sumit @ Tahani @ Dani** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Sumit @ Tahani @ Dani of P.S. Mahendra Park, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **05.10.2026**.

By Order

Sh. Sushil Kumar
ASJ-04, North Room No. 26,
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/10604/NW/2026

**ICICI Bank**

Regd. Office: ICICI Bank Limited, Landmark, Race Course Circle, Vadodra- 390007
Corporate Office: ICICI Bank Towers, Bandra-Kurla Complex, Bandra (E), Mumbai- 400051.
Branch Office: ICICI Bank Ltd., Shal Tower, Plot No 23, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, Delhi 110005
Notice for Disclosure of Legal Heirs of Deceased Borrower
PUBLIC NOTICE
Notice is hereby given that Home Loan LBDEL00001530345 (Credit facility) was granted to PREETI KALRA along with the deceased DINESH KALRA by ICICI Bank Ltd. (The Bank). We would like to inform you that the demise of DINESH KALRA has come to our knowledge during field visits conducted by the Bank officials and by telephonic communications on the registered contact numbers. In this regard, letter dated AUGUST 03, 2026, was previously sent to the registered addresses of the Borrowers and the Deceased DINESH KALRA, for providing information about the Legal Heirs of the Deceased Borrower.
Therefore, this Notice is hereby given for sharing details of the Legal Heirs of the deceased DINESH KALRA with supporting documents for updating the Bank's records, within 15 days of publication of this Notice.
You may submit the above-mentioned details to Mr. GOVIND SINGH by visiting ICICI BANK LTD PLOT NO. 7, COMMUNITY CENTRE S.D. TOWER, SECTOR 8, ROHINI DELHI 110085.
Date: August 06, 2026
Place: Delhi NCR
<SD> Authorised Officer
For ICICI Bank Ltd.

**ICICI Bank**

Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited, 3rd Floor Shal Tower, Plot No. 23, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, Delhi- 110005

PUBLIC NOTICE-TENDER CUM E-AUCTION FOR SALE OF SECURED ASSET
(See proviso to Rule 8(6))
Notice for sale of immovable asset(s)

E-Auction Sale Notice for the sale of immovable asset(s) under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8 (6) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.
This notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) that the below described immovable property mortgaged/ charged to the Secured Creditor, the physical possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of ICICI Bank Limited will be sold on 'As is where is', 'As is what is' and 'Whatever there is' as per the brief particulars given hereunder;

Sr. No.	Name of Borrower(s)/ Co-Borrowers/ Guarantors/ Loan Account No.	Details of the Secured asset(s) with known encumbrances, if any	Amount Outstanding	Reserve Price Earnest Money Deposit	Date and Time of Property Inspection	Date & Time of E-Auction
(A)	(B)	(C)	(D)	(E)	(F)	(G)
1.	Anand Prakash Naithani (Applicant), Chintan Naithani (Co-Applicant) Loan No. LBGHZ00002941703	Flat No. D-503 5th Floor, Block D, Raj Hans Premier Apartment Built on Plot No. 4/4, Situated At Ahinsa Khand-I, Indraprastha Ghaziabad (Admeasuring An Area of 1485 Sq Ft	Rs. 21,96,494/- As on July 30, 2026	Rs. 1,08,20,000/- To Rs. 10,82,000/-	August 19, 2026 From 03:00 PM To 04:00 PM	September 15, 2026 From 11:00 AM To 12:00 Noon

The online auction will be conducted on the website (URL Link- <https://BidDeal.in/>) of our auction agency Value Trust Capital Services Private Limited The Mortgagors/ noticees are given a last chance to pay the total dues with further interest by September 14, 2026 before 05:00 P.M else the secured asset(s) will be sold as per schedule.
The prospective bidder(s) must submit the Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) Demand Draft (DD) (Refer Column E) at ICICI Bank Limited, 3rd Floor Shal Tower, Plot No. 23, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, Delhi-110005 on or before September 14, 2026 before 05:00 P.M. Thereafter, they have to submit their offer through the website mentioned above on or before September 14, 2026 before 05:00 P.M along with the scanned image of the Bank acknowledged DD towards proof of payment of EMD. In case the prospective bidder(s) is/ are unable to submit his/ her/ their offer through the website, then the signed copy of tender documents may be submitted at ICICI Bank Limited, 3rd Floor Shal Tower, Plot No. 23, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, Delhi-110005 on or before September 14, 2026 before 05:00 P.M Earnest Money Deposit DD/PO should be from a Nationalised/ Scheduled Bank in favour of 'ICICI Bank Limited' payable at 'Delhi'
For any further clarifications in terms of inspection, Terms and Conditions of the E-Auction or submission of tenders, contact ICICI Bank Employee Phone No. 8928935040/ 7304914763.
Please note that Marketing agencies 1. Augeo Assets Management Private Limited, 2. Matex Net Pvt. Ltd. 3. Finvin Estate Deal Technologies Pvt Ltd. 4. Gimirsoft Pvt Ltd. 5. Hecta Prop Tech Pvt Ltd. 6. Arca Emort Pvt Ltd. 7. Novel Asset Service Pvt Ltd. 8. Nobroker Technologies Solutions Pvt Ltd. 9. Value Trust Capital Services Pvt Ltd. 10. Navodayan Proptech Pvt Ltd (XpertARC), have also been engaged for facilitating the sale of this property. The Authorised Officer reserves the right to reject any or all the bids without furnishing any further reasons. For detailed Terms and Conditions of the sale, please visit www.icicibank.com/n4p45
Date : August 06, 2026
Place: Delhi & Ghaziabad

Authorized Officer
ICICI Bank Limited

**ICICI Bank**

Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited, 3rd Floor Shal Tower, Plot No. 23, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, Delhi-110005

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(A)	(B)	(C)	(D)	(E)	(F)	(G)
1.	Mohit Singhal (Applicant), Suman Singhal (Co Applicant) Lan No. LBGHZ00002865033	H.No M-146, Ground Floor, Sec-23 Sanjay Nagar, Ghaziabad (Admeasuring an area of 42.69 Sq. Mtr	Rs. 13,90,899/- as on July 30, 2026	Rs. 14,00,000/- To Rs.14,00,000/-	Aug 21, 2026 From 04:00 PM To 05:00 PM	Sept 15, 2026 From 11:00 am to 12:00 Noon

The online auction will take place on the website (URL Link-<https://BidDeal.in/>) of e-auction agency Value Trust Capital Services Private Limited. The Mortgagors/ noticee are given a last chance to pay the total dues with further interest till Sept 14, 2026 before 05:00 P.M failing which, this secured asset will be sold as per schedule.
The Prospective Bidder(s) must submit the Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) Demand Draft (DD) (Refer Column E) at ICICI Bank Limited, 3rd Floor Shal Tower, Plot No. 23, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, Delhi-110005 on or before Sept 14, 2026 before 05:00 P.M and thereafter they need to submit their offer through the above mentioned website only on or before Sept 14, 2026 before 05:00 P.M along with scan image of Bank acknowledged DD towards proof of payment of EMD. Kindly note, in case prospective bidder(s) are unable to submit their offer through the website then signed copy of tender documents may be submitted at ICICI Bank Limited, 3rd Floor Shal Tower, Plot No. 23, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, Delhi-110005 on or before Sept 14, 2026 before 05:00 P.M. Earnest Money Deposit DD/PO should be from a Nationalised/Scheduled Bank in favour of 'ICICI Bank Limited' payable at 'Delhi'
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AROUND THE WORLD

» Delhi govt announces free JEE, NEET coaching for Class 12 students

» IIM Kozhikode's BMS batch sees 59% women representation

» IGNOU's re-registration deadline extended till August 16

» IIT-Bangalore team qualifies for ICPC World Finals 2026 - Olympics of Computer Programming



BUZZER ROUND

Q) Who is the first Indian judoka to win a gold medal at the Commonwealth Games?

Send us your replies to careersmp22@gmail.com. We shall publish the names of the first 3 correct entries in next week's edition

Answer to our July 30 edition question:
Milkha Singh

Correct answers were sent by: **Writ Ray, Manisha Mitra, Bratati Dey**



NEWS & VIEWS

Goa Institute of Management researcher has demonstrated that incorporating blockchain technology to enhance transparency and reduce information asymmetry can benefit all stakeholders, including producers, exporters, importers, and processors, involved in the international tomato trade.

Coursera in collaboration with the United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization (UNESCO) launched UNESCO's first free course, the Global MOOC on the Ethics of AI, developed in collaboration with LG AI Research.

HOW AI IS CHANGING HR & HIRING

Most MNCs now rely on automated screening, which can reduce resume screening time by up to 75%

ANINDITA ACHARYA

Until a few years ago, jobs such as resume and CV writers were in circulation. These professionals were responsible for carefully scrutinising client documents, rewriting and structuring CVs according to companies' preferred formats and creating professionally designed resumes suited to different opportunities. Today, however, anyone can create a polished CV by using the right prompts on AI tools. The same transformation has taken place in human resources. There was a time when HR professionals drafted job descriptions, screened applications, analysed compensation data, answered policy-related queries and shortlisted the best candidates for management. In the age of AI, however, these roles have changed too.

HR professionals are no longer confined to their traditional responsibilities. Today, AI has streamlined HR operations, with AI agents, AI assistants, and generative AI automating repetitive tasks. As a result, the role of HR professionals in the recruitment process has undergone a major transformation. If HR professionals fail to upskill themselves, they risk being left behind.

In fact, AI is changing how India Inc. evaluates talent. According to Sachin Alug, CEO, NLB Services, AI is now deeply integrated into the recruitment process. It primarily handles routine, repetitive tasks while streamlining both the candidate and recruiter experience. "Skill evaluation after AI has had a major transformation," he said.

Kartik Narayan, CEO, Apna, believes AI is fundamentally changing how companies evaluate talent,

particularly at the top of the hiring funnel. "One of the biggest problems in recruitment has always been recruiter bandwidth. A large percentage of applicants were never spoken to simply because recruiters didn't have the capacity. AI changes that. For the first time, organisations can move towards near-100% screening of applicants and, where appropriate, even 100% outreach," he said. Narayan added that the biggest impact of AI in hiring has been improved productivity and efficiency. "Recruiters can now spend less time on repetitive screening and more time engaging with the most relevant candidates. This is especially transformative for entry-level and high-volume hiring,"

he said.

According to HireVue survey, 73% of HR professionals trust AI to recommend candidates for hiring. AI is now being used across multiple stages of recruitment, from screening resumes to scheduling interviews. If you think employers cannot assess whether candidates are using AI effectively rather than simply outsourcing their thinking, think again. Viram Shah, Founder & CEO, Vested Finance, explained that the difference becomes evident when candidates are encouraged to use AI openly and explain their decision-making process. "Someone using AI effectively can articulate why they framed a prompt in a particular way,

what context they provided, which suggestions they rejected, and where the model's response may be incomplete or incorrect. We have, therefore, started experimenting with AI-assisted interview rounds, including the use of ColarUp AI, where candidates solve problems with AI in front of the interview panel. This allows us to evaluate not only what they produce, but how they question, validate and refine the output. In 2026, generating an answer will be easy. Knowing what

to ask, what to challenge and what to discard will be the real skill," he said.

In the AI era, where news of job losses due to this revolutionary technology emerges almost every other day, companies are dealing with an overwhelming number of resumes and very little time. In such a scenario, the best candidates can easily slip through the cracks. Most MNCs now rely on automated screening, which can reduce resume screening time by up to 75%. These systems extract structured information from resumes and identify inconsistencies or misrepresentations more effectively than manual screening. According to Forbes, citing a Gallup survey, 93% of Fortune 500 Chief Human Resource Officers (CHROs) have already begun integrating AI tools and technologies to improve business practices. "AI has high penetration across the entire recruitment process. From developing job descriptions to screening resumes, conducting skill assessments and using chatbots to answer candidate queries, companies are leveraging AI throughout the hiring cycle," said Alug.

Narayan echoed similar views and said AI is embedded across multiple stages of hiring. According to him, AI is first used to match candidates with suitable jobs. "AI can also conduct first-level interactions with candidates, helping employers assess fit before a recruiter steps in. So, AI supports the entire hiring journey, from matching to screening to initial evaluation," he said.

TODAY, AI HAS STREAMLINED HR OPERATIONS, WITH AI AGENTS, AI ASSISTANTS, AND GENERATIVE AI AUTOMATING REPETITIVE TASKS. IF HR PROFESSIONALS FAIL TO UPSKILL THEMSELVES, THEY RISK BEING LEFT BEHIND

UNSW SYDNEY OPENS CAMPUS IN BENGALURU

Classes are scheduled to commence on August 10

OUR CORRESPONDENT

For decades, Australia has been a preferred destination for Indian students seeking a world-class education and globally relevant career opportunities. And now, Indian students can experience a taste of Australia in Bengaluru. UNSW Sydney, Australia's premier university, has officially launched its first international campus in India and is set to start academic operations in August 2026.

Located at Manyata Business Park in Bengaluru, the campus will offer students access to an internationally recognised UNSW education in one of India's most dynamic technology and innovation ecosystems. By combining Australian academic excellence with Bengaluru's thriving industry landscape, the university aims to create stronger opportunities for interdisciplinary learning, applied research and industry engagement. The launch follows another milestone for UNSW, which was recently ranked again in the world's top 20 universities in the 2027 QS World University Rankings.

Prof Attila Brungs, Vice-Chancellor and President, UNSW Sydney, said, "The opening of our Bengaluru campus reflects both our confidence in India's extraordinary

THE BENGALURU CAMPUS WILL INITIALLY FOCUS ON AREAS ALIGNED WITH THE NEP 2020 AND ADDRESSING GLOBAL RESEARCH PRIORITIES INCLUDING AI AND CYBERSECURITY

talent ecosystem and our long-term commitment to strengthening the Australia-India education partnership through our 'Progress for All' strategy."

The Bengaluru campus will initially focus on areas aligned with the NEP 2020, skills and future workforce demand while addressing global research priorities – including AI, cybersecurity, digital technologies, advanced manufacturing and sustainability. Beyond academics, the campus is expected to serve as a platform for deeper collaboration between Australia and India across research, innovation and enterprise.

INDONESIA TO PARTNER WITH IIT MADRAS FOR RESEARCH MoU to accelerate deep-tech commercialisation

OUR CORRESPONDENT

The Ministry of Higher Education, Science & Technology, Republic of Indonesia is partnering with IIT Madras Global Research Foundation (IITM Global) to strengthen strategic cooperation in higher education, research, innovation, deep technology, entrepreneurship and talent development.

On Wednesday, IIT Madras hosted Prof Brian Yuliarto, Minister of Higher Education, Science & Technology, Republic of Indonesia, during which a MoU was signed between IIT Madras Global Research Foundation and the Ministry of Higher Education, Science & Technology, Republic of Indonesia. "Indonesia has set an ambitious vision to become a globally competitive, innovation-driven economy. Achieving this requires strong partnerships that empower our universities, researchers, students and entrepreneurs to work together with

world-class institutions. I believe this partnership will strengthen Indonesia's innovation ecosystem while reflecting the growing strategic relationship between Indonesia and India," said Yuliarto.

Prof V. Kamakoti, Chairman, IIT Madras Global Research Foundation and Director, IIT Madras, added, "We are delighted to partner with the Government of Indonesia in building globally competitive research, innovation and entrepreneurship ecosystems that contribute

THE PARTNERSHIP EMERGED DIRECTLY FROM THE RECENT BILATERAL DISCUSSIONS BETWEEN PM NARENDRA MODI AND HE PRABOWO SUBIANTO, PRESIDENT OF THE REPUBLIC OF INDONESIA

to sustainable economic development and strengthen the enduring friendship between our two countries."

The partnership emerged directly from the recent bilateral discussions between PM Narendra Modi and HE Prabowo Subianto, President of the Republic of Indonesia, during which both leaders reaffirmed their commitment to significantly expanding cooperation in higher education, science, technology, innovation and entrepreneurship.

BEYOND CLASSROOMS



Sister Nivedita University (SNU) in Kolkata in collaboration with the Indian Chemical Council (ICC), recently organized the Acharya Prafulla Chandra Ray Memorial – Chemistry Olympiad at the campus. The two-day Olympiad brought together aspiring chemists, researchers, and young innovators to celebrate scientific excellence, critical thinking, and the enduring legacy of Acharya Prafulla Chandra Ray. The event served as a platform to inspire curiosity, encourage innovation, and foster a spirit of healthy academic competition among participants.

ST XAVIER'S UNIVERSITY, KOLKATA STARTS ENGINEERING & TECH COURSES

The inaugural batch has more than 250 students across four BTech programmes

OUR CORRESPONDENT

St Xavier's University, Kolkata inaugurated the undergraduate programmes of the Xavier School of Engineering and Technology (XSET) on Tuesday, marking a significant milestone in the University's expansion into engineering and technology education.

Vice-Chancellor, Rev Dr John Felix Raj, S.J., welcomed the gathering and felicitated the chief guest, Dr Suman Chakraborty, Director, IIT Kharagpur. In his inaugural address, Rev Dr Raj reaffirmed "the university's commitment to nurturing technically competent, ethically grounded, and socially responsible engineers capable of contributing meaningfully to national development."

Dr Chakraborty encouraged the newly admitted students to embrace innovation, interdisciplinary learning, and research-driven education while cultivating integrity, creativity, and a lifelong passion for learning. He highlighted the transformative role of engineering in addressing contemporary global challenges and urged students to become responsible professionals committed to technological advancement and societal well-being.

The inauguration marks the beginning of a new chapter for the Xavier School of

THE UNIVERSITY HAS STARTED ITS FIRST ACADEMIC SESSION WITH UG PROGRAMMES IN COMPUTER SCIENCE AND ENGINEERING, ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE AND MACHINE LEARNING, ELECTRONICS AND COMMUNICATION ENGINEERING AND IT

Engineering and Technology, which has commenced its first academic session with undergraduate programmes in Computer Science and Engineering (CSE), Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning (AI-ML), Electronics and Communication Engineering (ECE), and Information Technology (IT). The inaugural batch has received an encouraging response, with more than 250 students admitted across four BTech programmes.

SCHOLARSHIP CHEVENING SCHOLARSHIPS TO STUDY IN UK

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Indian students will be able to apply for the UK government's flagship international scholarships programme. Chevening Scholarships offer full financial support to pursue a one-year master's degree at any UK university and are open to Indian citizens with a minimum of two years' work experience, acquired after the completion of their undergraduate degree. The application window remains open till October 6, 2026.

The Chevening programme in India is the largest in the world, benefiting 4,000 awardees since 1983. Ben Mellor, Acting British High Commissioner to India, said, "Education is one of the key pillars of UK-India Vision 2035 and Chevening is our flagship programme. It develops future leaders and offers a unique opportunity for some of the best and brightest in India to study in the UK.

KNOW MORE

- » Chevening began in 1983 and has developed into a prestigious international awards scheme
- » Chevening awardees come from over 160 countries and territories worldwide
- » Over 75% of scholars from the 2026 Chevening cohort hail from tier 2 and 3 cities, with many being first-generation learners. Women comprise 68% of the cohort

Chevening awards are highly competitive and extremely rewarding. India has millions of exceptionally talented young people and I encourage aspiring leaders from every corner of the country to apply."

Chevening Scholarships are a vital part of the UK-India education and skills partnership and a practical expression of the two countries' shared Vision 2035.



Trending

COURSES

OUR CORRESPONDENT

The two-week Online Short-Term Internship Programme (OSTI) organised by the National Human Rights Commission (NHRC), India for university-level students started at Manav Adhikar Bhawan, New Delhi recently. 100 students from diverse academic backgrounds, selected from 2,036 applicants, are participating in the programme. NHRC Chairperson,

100 UNIVERSITY-LEVEL STUDENTS FROM DIVERSE ACADEMIC BACKGROUNDS SHORTLISTED OUT OF 2,036 APPLICANTS

Justice V Ramasubramanian inaugurated the programme in the presence of Member, Justice (Dr) Bidyut Ranjan Sarangi; Secretary General, Piyush Goyal; Joint Secretaries, Samir Kumar,

Saidingpuii Chhakchhuak and Director Satovisha Samajdar. The programme will feature around 30 lectures on important human rights topics and involve 20 eminent guest speakers, including senior government officials, academicians, civil society representatives, human rights defenders, NHRC officers, representatives from international institutions working for the protection of human rights and subject experts.